

ENTERTAINER

PREMIUM PROFILE



16 Personalities

What's in This Profile?

This profile is designed to cover the main aspects of Entertainer personality as it affects different areas of their life, including Entertainers' key strengths and weaknesses, relationships, academic path, career and professional development, as well as their communication and friend-making skills, parenting tips and advice, and much, much more. It combines personality-type theory with practical, real-world advice from other people who share the Entertainer personality type.

Personality type has been the focus of many discussions, some of them dating back to ancient times. It's wise to draw from this source of knowledge and experience, especially when unsure of how to handle a specific situation. This kind of knowledge offers the power to control and understand oneself. As Aristotle said millennia ago, "The hardest victory is the victory over self." Consider this profile a plan for success.

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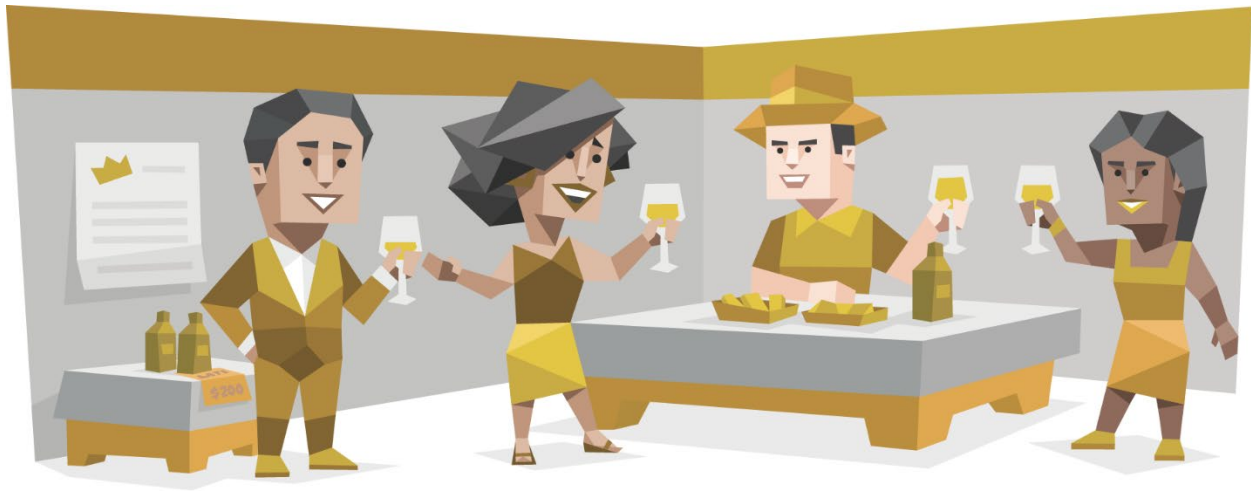
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Who Is “The Entertainer?”



This book explores how Entertainers’ traits influence their personalities – and their lives. We’ll explain how these qualities produce a unique set of tendencies and behaviors that shape personal growth, relationships, and academic and professional development. Let’s embark on a quick overview of the Entertainer personality type, venturing into topics we’ll explore more deeply in later chapters.

Personal Growth

For Entertainers, life is something to experience, enjoy, and share. Like other members of the Explorer group, people with this personality type seize the moment and create a sense of fun and adventure. Spontaneous and action-oriented, Entertainers know how to have a good time. People with this personality type don’t keep all the merriment to themselves, though; instead, they use their infectious enthusiasm and energy to draw others into the fun.

Gregarious and passionate, Entertainers have a definite flair. They thrive on novelty, aesthetic beauty, and physical pleasures. However, their pursuit of enjoyment can consume Entertainers, leading them to neglect such important practical matters as

car maintenance and credit card payments. Entertainers can let things slide in an unbalanced manner, relying on luck or hoping their friends will bail them out when problems arise. They'll hide unopened bills in the microwave and ignore the “check engine” lights on their cars. Ironically, this unbalanced failure to take responsibility often robs Entertainers of the freedom they so crave.

Entertainers who approach such tasks in a balanced manner know that to indulge in their carefree spirit – which is one of their most charming traits – they must strive to establish just enough structure to stay on top of practical necessities and maintain personal and financial well-being. This opens the doors for them to satisfy their lust for life and their high-flying style, sharing the beauties and pleasures of the world with the people around them.

Relationships

As Extraverts, Entertainers love interacting with others. They light up a room, drawing the spotlight with their fun, lively, and occasionally wild conversations. People with this personality type love to be the center of attention and don't mind breaking the ice by leading the way onto the dance floor or picking up the mic for some impromptu karaoke. Whether it's a hip party or a family reunion, group gatherings energize Entertainers, showing them at their best: warm, passionate, and magnetic.

Beneath their sparkling exteriors, Entertainers care about the people around them. They're both generous and curious, showering their time and attention on those who catch their interest. Thanks to their observational skills and emotional intelligence, Entertainers can often detect how other people feel. When they see someone is having a hard time, Entertainers don't hold back or pretend not to notice. Instead, they ask what's wrong and how they can help.

Some Entertainers don't extend this same consideration to themselves, however. When they find themselves personally embroiled in conflict or difficult situations, they may enter a state of denial, refusing to talk about their issues – particularly if these issues would paint them in an unflattering light. Although they generally love the spotlight, they're sensitive to criticism and conflict and avoid both whenever possible.

On the romance front, Entertainers are affectionate and spontaneous – two traits that can make them irresistible. They tend to sweep their partners off their feet, introducing them to new experiences and pleasures.

Commitment doesn't come easily to this type, though, especially to those Entertainers who don't find balance in their lives. These Entertainers tend to be unpredictable and may even leave relationships when the newness and excitement wane, despite having expressed love and devotion. To establish true intimacy and cultivate longstanding connections, Entertainers must try to find new delights in their everyday lives with their partners by taking advantage of their innate adaptability, curiosity, and emotional intelligence.

Fortunately, Entertainers bring many strengths to their relationships. They invigorate their partners, help their friends feel seen and cared for, and – if they become parents – teach their children just how glorious the world can be.

Academic and Professional Development

Entertainers are bored by theories and abstractions, which can cause them to underperform in traditional academic settings. This may affect their self-esteem, particularly regarding their intelligence. Fortunately, most Entertainers begin to discover and harness their unique gifts by adolescence. Once they find activities and

pursuits that excite them – whether it’s theater or sales – Entertainers unleash their energy and passion, growing to their full potential.

When they’re fascinated by something, Entertainers plunge right in. A common mantra for them is, “Act first, ask questions later.” However, some Entertainers may indulge their impulsivity to the extreme, which can be problematic with complex, long-term projects in the workplace or classroom. Unsurprisingly, these types have little patience for routine tasks or administrative planning and may wish to seek situations where these responsibilities can be avoided or delegated to others.

Entertainers do best in supportive, positive environments, regardless of their academic or professional development status. They’re emotional sponges who tend to be overwhelmed by critical or hyper-competitive settings and, instead, are drawn to pursuits that leverage their strengths. Such activities typically allow Entertainers to satisfy their cravings for interpersonal engagement, variety, unpredictability, and aesthetic appreciation.

Many Entertainers excel as event planners, sales representatives, trip planners, or tour guides. Their eye for trends and aesthetics might land them positions in fashion, design, or the arts. Their social intelligence and emotional prowess may draw Entertainers toward medical or healing professions, from social work to emergency medicine. Wherever they end up, Entertainers brighten their classrooms and workplaces, contributing style, spirit, and *joie de vivre*.

On That Note...

This section explored the key traits inherent to the Entertainer personality type, but a brief introduction can’t do justice to the full scope of their strengths and gifts, let alone how Entertainers can counterbalance their weaknesses. The following

chapters provide a more in-depth examination of those areas, highlighting insights, suggestions, and resources for improvement. Understanding one’s personality type is valuable, and we hope this information proves useful.

Theory Overview

Five Personality Aspects

Introverted (I) vs. Extraverted (E)

People have long noted that some among them are more outgoing and comfortable interacting with their surroundings, and others are more at ease remaining in quiet solitude with their thoughts. You can see the two types in almost any home, office, or classroom. In our first scale, we focus on the difference between Introversion and Extraversion, which we call the Energy scale.

The Energy scale describes how we see and approach the outside world, including people, objects, and activities within it. There are significant links between this scale and things like willingness to volunteer, boredom, thrill seeking, motivation, and romantic assertiveness, to name just a few. The links may not prove one causes the other. However, it does hint at a relationship.

Introverted People: Attuned Inwards

More Internal: Introverts ground themselves more easily in solitude and derive energy from their own thoughts.

More Selective: Introverts are careful when choosing the people with whom they spend time and prefer a quieter environment when they have a choice.

Slow to Offer Opinions: Within reason, Introverts like a little time to process their thoughts and ideas and are slow to offer opinions, fearing they may be too rash.

Extraverted People: Outwardly Engaged

More Outgoing: Extraverts tend to be outgoing both socially and in their willingness to interact with new and interesting environments.

Energetic: Extraverts have an energy that is almost replenished by its expression. They are energized by being energetic and putting themselves in stimulating situations.

Quick with Opinions: Extraverts are generally more comfortable with a flurry of opinions that typically are a part of casual conversations. It's almost like brainstorming ideas on the spot while saving the editing for later.

Intuitive (N) vs. Observant (S)

The second scale in our model is called Mind and addresses Intuitive and Observant styles. Each trait determines what kind of information we focus on and how it is used. It's the foundation on which all the other approaches are built.

All personality types include either those who favor the Intuitive style or those who prefer the Observant style. But before we start, it's important to say that this has nothing to do with how they take in information. The word "Observant" might suggest it does. But Intuitive and Observant types use their five senses in the same way. Rather than how they absorb information, these qualities show how each of these traits manages it once it's received.

Intuitive People: Living in the World of Ideas

Focus on Ideas: Intuitive people are fascinated by the world of ideas and love to discover the connections between various concepts and realities.

Are Deeply Curious: Within the realm of ideas, Intuitive individuals have a strong curiosity that leads them to somewhat adventurous discoveries.

Highly Imaginative: Those who prefer this trait typically stretch concepts to include possibilities beyond the obvious. “What if this not only means... but what if it could also mean...”

Observant People: Feet On the Ground

A Practical Focus: Observant people are more in touch with the concrete world and work within it. They favor consistent actions and measurable results.

Facts Over Theory: These individuals leave theorizing and brainstorming to others, preferring to effectively apply established facts.

More in the Moment: While Observant individuals have a respect for the past and the future, they see them through the lens of what they can do now. The task at hand is always the most important.

Thinking (T) vs. Feeling (F)

The Thinking and Feeling traits determine how we decide matters and cope with emotions. While we all have feelings, there are significant differences in how we react to them and what role those feelings play in our lives. This then influences several other areas, mostly related to our interactions with other people. This is what our third trait, Nature, focuses on.

Thinking People: Where Reason Rules

Rational and Objective: Thinking individuals are most comfortable dealing with things that come from rational thought and involve proven principles.

Logic Over Feelings: While these types often feel quite deeply, they typically place their rationality and logic above any emotional responses.

Constantly Assessing: Thinking people constantly scan ideas and actions to decide whether they make sense or not. They can be valuable in any process that requires any level of critical thinking.

Feeling People: Those Who Follow Their Feelings

Lead from the Heart: Feeling types listen to their feelings, care about how others feel, and are unafraid of sharing this perspective.

Focus on Morals and Ethics: People and their welfare are usually prioritized above any other consideration with the individuals who exhibit the Feeling trait.

A Different Kind of Rationality: While the Feeling type's way of choosing a direction may not always be totally objective, that doesn't mean that they lack rationality. There is practical wisdom in including feelings and consideration for the well-being of oneself and others in the decisions one makes.

Judging (J) vs. Prospecting (P)

The Tactics scale – Judging and Prospecting – is about how people plan and deal with the options they have. But this definition doesn't just concern what individuals write in their day planners. It's much broader. These traits answer questions like, "Do you

prefer spontaneity or certainty?" "Do you feel more comfortable acting only with all your ducks lined neatly in a row? Or does a certain amount of flexibility or chaos excite you and prove motivating?" "Do you need more choices or fewer?"

At its core, this scale determines our attitude toward certainty and structure in our lives, both at mental and physical levels.

Judging People: A Steady Hand

Predictability Rules: Judging types are most at home when there is a clear-cut, well-considered plan that provides sure steps and promotes certain outcomes.

Work Hard: Judging individuals tend to work hard, perhaps seeing strong effort as a way of ensuring predictability.

By the Book: Individuals with this trait usually like to do things by the book and respect reasonable protocols, established techniques, and duties. They sometimes see doing things any other way as "reinventing the wheel."

Prospecting People: Possibilities in the Moment

Relaxed Spontaneity: Prospecting types tend to deal with life and all its opportunities as it comes at them.

Creative: This trait can promote "coloring outside the lines." This can lead to discovering new creative solutions.

Serial Passions: Prospecting individuals may find themselves passing quickly through many interests in their lives. Because of these experiences, they can possess a broad array of knowledge and ideas.

Assertive (-A) vs. Turbulent (-T)

Assertive and Turbulent – the Identity scale – measures how confident one is and how that confidence influences all other traits. The degree that people move more boldly or more timidly affects the way they make choices. It determines how they express their skills. Whether one is too confident to accept criticism or puts too much weight on the criticism of others because they lack self-confidence can make a major difference. The caution or lack of caution people apply to the things they do can color everything.

Assertive People: A Confident Approach

Confident Style: People with the Assertive identity are self-confident and resist stress.

Often Success-Oriented: Because these individuals don't spend hours fretting, it might be assumed they aren't interested in results. For many of them, nothing could be further from the truth.

Responsive and Proactive: Assertive people may jump into a task quickly, not being as burdened with the need to think endlessly about what may go wrong.

Turbulent People: Always Improving

Useful Worry: Turbulent people often worry and engage in self-doubt. While that might sound negative, the flipside of the coin is that it fuels much of their drive and productivity.

Driven to Succeed and Improve: Turbulent individuals are constantly seeking to do better and be better. This pushes them to put great effort into life.

Problem Spotters: Because of their cautious nature and tendency to worry, those with the Turbulent trait often spot problems early and are able to contain them quickly.

Type Groups

Now you know what each type consists of. But how do they fit together?

In our system, we group personality types in two different ways:

- **Roles** determine our goals, interests, and preferred activities.
- **Strategies** reflect our preferred ways of doing things and achieving our goals.

You can think of Roles and Strategies as two ways of organizing personality types into categories. These two categorization methods each highlight different facets of the types. For examples, Roles can show us why certain types share similar interests, and Strategies can explain why certain types approach socializing the way they do.

We discuss Strategies in depth at the end of this e-book, in *The Puzzle of Personality*. With that in mind, let's explore the importance of Roles.

Roles

There are four Roles, each of which groups together four personality types.

- The **Analyst Role** includes Architects (INTJ), Logicians (INTP), Commanders (ENTJ), and Debaters (ENTP).

- The **Diplomat Role** includes Advocates (INFJ), Mediators (INFP), Protagonists (ENFJ), and Campaigners (ENFP).
- The **Sentinel Role** includes Logisticians (ISTJ), Defenders (ISFJ), Executives (ESTJ), and Consuls (ESFJ).
- The **Explorer Role** includes Virtuosos (ISTP), Adventurers (ISFP), Entrepreneurs (ESTP), and Entertainers (ESFP).

So, why do we organize the types in this way? To put it simply, Roles help us to recognize important common ground between personality types.

The types within each Role all share the same Mind trait – either Intuitive or Observant. As you might remember, this trait is incredibly important because it determines how we view the world. As a result, the types within a given Role are alike in a very important respect: they share similar ways of understanding the world and their place within it.

In addition to the Mind trait, the types within a given Role also share the same Nature trait (Thinking or Feeling) or the same Tactics trait (Judging or Prospecting).

Does this seem like information overload? If so, don't worry. To help you get a better grasp of the Roles, let's go through them one by one and find out what makes them tick.

Analysts: Intuitive (N) and Thinking (T)

The personality types in the Analyst Role – Architects, Logicians, Commanders, and Debaters – are known for their irreverent curiosity. Thanks to the Intuitive trait, these types are rarely satisfied with the status quo. Instead, they'll go deep in their search

for ways to make things better, more efficient, and more effective. Meanwhile, the Thinking trait means that they value rationality over emotionality.

Analysts' greatest strengths include:

Driven to learn. Analysts want to know how the world works. In their quest for knowledge, they push the boundaries of their understanding. The result? Their expertise in certain areas can be remarkable.

Questioning natures. Analysts rarely accept things at face value. Ever questioning, they look beyond superficial appearances. This enables them to come up with deep, unexpected insights.

Intellectual energy. Full of fresh, counterintuitive ideas, Analysts know how to spark a lively debate. Conversations with these candid, sharp-witted types can be a breath of fresh air.

Born to improve. Analysts are relentless self-improvers. Once they've recognized a flaw, they apply all their rationality, imagination, and ambition to make it right.

Analysts' forceful imaginations, when trained and focused, enable them to achieve incredible results. But, like anyone, these types can have their Achilles heels, such as:

Lost in thought. Thinking up great ideas gives Analysts a rush. As a result, they're at risk of staying in the realm of thought, never acting out their ideas.

Ever the critic. In the same vein, some Analysts are more comfortable thinking about and critiquing other people's work than jumping into the fray themselves. In time, these types may be frustrated to find themselves outpaced by people with real-world experience.

Hunting for flaws. If taken too far, Analysts desire for improvement can have them hunting down the flaws in everything. As a result, they may undervalue the people and opportunities they encounter.

Emoti-what? Analysts feel more comfortable in the realm of thought than the messy world of emotions. But like anyone, they need to develop emotional literacy in order to deepen their relationships and fully understand themselves.

Fortunately, Analysts have enough creativity and ambition to move beyond these stumbling blocks. When they take action, look for the positive, and train their curiosity on the realm of emotions, these types can grow into their full potential.

Diplomats: Intuitive (N) and Feeling (F)

Diplomats – Advocates, Mediators, Protagonists, and Campaigners – tend to be warm, caring, and generous. Bringing together the Intuitive and Feeling traits, they shine in their understanding of emotions – both their own and other people’s. This ability helps them shine when it comes to diplomacy, counseling others, and communication in general.

Diplomats’ gifts and talents include:

Emotional literacy. Even when it’s far from obvious, Diplomats can often perceive how others are feeling. From the outside, this might look like mind-reading. But in truth, it’s a combination of self-reflection and radical compassion that helps Diplomats understand others’ emotional states.

Only connect. Diplomats don’t use their people skills to manipulate others. Instead, they aim to nurture genuine connections with the people they encounter. Moreover, many Diplomats feel called to serve others however they can.

Do no harm. Deep down, Diplomats want what's best for everyone. For them, causing someone else distress would feel like a wound to their own psyche. As a result, these types aim to promote cooperation and harmony rather than conflict.

Creators at work. Profoundly creative, Diplomats are always on the hunt for inspiration. Whether or not they take up artistic pursuits, these types tend to enjoy self-exploration and self-expression.

Diplomats have high ideals. For them, kindness and altruism burn as brightly as a fire on a chilly winter's night. But if left unchecked, this idealism can have its downsides, including:

Impractical magic. Tempering passion with cold practicality is a challenge for Diplomats. These types are often reluctant to make tough decisions – especially if those decisions require them to compromise on their ideals or hurt someone's feelings.

Beautiful ideas. Diplomats have the best of intentions, and they have countless ideas about ways to help people. They're at risk, however, of staying stuck in the realm of ideas instead of taking action and sticking to a plan.

Taking on too much. In their efforts to make a difference, Diplomats may overcommit themselves – emotionally, physically, or even financially. If they don't deliver everything they'd hoped, they may feel overwhelmed or disappointed in themselves.

Easily hurt. Sensitive to criticism and rejection, these types may react strongly if other people question the value of their ideals. Disagreement and conflict can leave Diplomats feeling discouraged and hurt.

In all their actions, Diplomats crave a sense of meaning and purpose. Specifically, they feel called to cultivate positive change and gentle beauty in the world around them. Motivated by intangible rewards felt in the heart and soul, these types have a conviction to serve the greater good.

Sentinels: Observant (S) and Judging (J)

Sentinels – Logisticians, Defenders, Executives, and Consuls – are cooperative and practical. This grounded approach helps them feel comfortable with themselves just as they are. Steadfast and hardworking, these types pride themselves on their character and competence.

Here are some of the ways that Sentinels contribute to their homes, workplaces, social circles, and beyond:

Loving duty. These types feel a deep responsibility for those they care about. Specifically, Sentinels feel duty-bound to keep their loved ones safe and to help them lead good lives.

Always on time. Sure, Sentinels might occasionally fall behind schedule. But most of the time, they pride themselves on being unfailingly reliable. As a result, friends, loved ones, and coworkers can trust that Sentinels won't flake on their commitments.

Keepers of tradition. Sentinels work hard to maintain the ways things are done. In their home life, this means they love to continue family traditions. At the workplace, these types keep track of and defend best practices.

Unwavering diligence. Sentinels aren't afraid of hard work. On a daily basis, they practice their virtues of consistency and persistence, refusing to take shortcuts or

stop before their work is done. And in situations where someone needs to step up and take responsibility, Sentinels can be counted on to come through.

Sentinels feel bolstered by having reliable people in their lives, and they make it a priority to hold up their end of the bargain. But even these dependable types can have their challenges, including:

Resistance to change. For Sentinels, trying new ways of doing things can feel wrong – almost like breaking an unwritten set of rules. These types can be skeptical of change, and they may stick with suboptimal choices on the grounds of “that’s how it’s always been done.”

Stubbornness toward others. Similarly, Sentinels may feel personally affronted when other people upset the status quo. What someone else might describe as “experimenting with new ideas” may seem reckless or disrespectful to Sentinels. As a result, these types might dig in their heels, even if that means forestalling progress.

Imposing their values. Sentinels love to give advice and shepherd people toward better lives – at least, what Sentinels consider better lives. It may be hard for these types to accept that not everyone holds stability, tradition, and respectability among their core values. And when other people don’t follow their advice, Sentinels may want to judge them harshly.

Sentinels’ loyalty and steadfastness shine in many situations. When they balance their firm convictions with curiosity and openness, these types can become nothing short of inspirations to the people in their lives.

Explorers: Observant (S) and Prospecting (P)

Explorers – Virtuosos, Adventurers, Entrepreneurs, and Entertainers – are self-reliant and quick-thinking. They're always ready to tackle a challenge or act on the spur of the moment. This spontaneity doesn't only help them solve problems – it also enables them to find opportunities for enjoyment in their everyday lives.

Here are a few of Explorers' notable strengths:

Surfing the waves. Many people struggle with change, but not Explorers. These types can adapt to new situations with minimal regret or second-guessing. In fact, they often enjoy change and appreciate breaks from routine.

Socially dynamic. Because of their openness, many Explorers enjoy meeting new people and trying out new social experiences. This helps them to build a network of diverse and interesting friends and acquaintances.

Getting things done. Explorers don't overthink things. Instead, they leap into action and get the job done. These types spend their energy on taking concrete steps, only pausing to consider abstract ideas or nitty-gritty details when it's absolutely necessary.

Picking up techniques. Utilitarian in their way, Explorers love to master new tools and techniques. Whatever their hobbies and passions, these types enjoy the challenge of building their skills and picking up new ways of doing things.

Explorers enjoy being free of obligations, where they can indulge themselves or their interests on their own time. Like most traits, this has its upsides and its downsides. Here are some tendencies that Explorers may need to counteract:

Losing interest. We all lose interest in our activities from time to time. But Explorers often run out of motivation as soon as a project no longer feels fun, novel, or exciting.

What planning? Explorers prefer to deal with challenges on the fly rather than plan ahead. Alas, sometimes an ounce of planning really is worth a pound of cure.

Risky business. Explorers are drawn to pleasure, risk, and – sometimes – risky pleasures. As they grow and mature, however, they often learn that some risks simply aren't worth taking.

Explorers connect with the world in a way that's almost childlike in its wonder and sheer fun. It can be a challenge for them to work for things with a distant or unexciting payoff, but when they harness their passion and administer just enough self-discipline, they can move heaven and earth.

Now, let's talk about you.

Personal Growth



By its very nature, personal growth isn't the one-size-fits-all affair that some self-help books would have readers believe. For Entertainers, personal growth is always about balancing spontaneity with responsibility, independence with intimacy, and novelty with status quo. The goal isn't to change their intrinsic traits, but rather to help them gain a greater array of tools for getting through their lives more skillfully.

For Entertainers to grow, they must first develop self-awareness by assessing their current behaviors. It takes careful consideration, but they should try to determine whether their actions have positive long-term effects or just feel good in the moment. Replacing unhealthy behaviors with new ones that can reveal new, more fulfilling possibilities and bring Entertainers closer to what they want in life.

However, not all growth is the product of deliberate effort. Sometimes it emerges gently from the subtle shifts caused by age and maturity, and occasionally life harshly demands immediate growth in the face of hard times and crises. No matter the method, as the saying goes, "You're either getting better, or you're getting worse. There is no staying the same."

Motivation and Development

Entertainers tend to find motivation from three closely related, but distinct, motivational aspects.

- **Self-esteem** speaks to how much Entertainers like themselves. Accepting both their flaws and strengths creates a base of internal appreciation that enables change motivated by desire instead of shame.
- **Self-respect** speaks to their sense of worth. People with this personality type value empathy and harmony, and when they live their beliefs and values, a balanced sense of pride in who they are follows.
- **Self-confidence** is the energy source that moves Entertainers forward in life. When belief in their abilities is confirmed using their skills, Entertainers are driven to make steady progress.

If these three core aspects are properly balanced, they can promote a successful, fulfilling lifestyle. If these elements become unbalanced, however, they become a source of overwhelming difficulty. For example, when Entertainers feel a lack of self-confidence, they might try to offset such feelings with behaviors that give them assurance. Such overcompensation can throw their entire lives out of balance.

In this section, we'll first examine Entertainers' characteristics in their ideal, balanced, and developed form. Using these motivational aspects in a harmonious way helps these types lead fulfilling, productive, and happy lives.

Next, we'll describe the tendencies that emerge if these aspects become unbalanced. These propensities represent departures from healthy, productive motivational strategies and explain adverse effects Entertainers experience when disconnected from their true selves.

Finally, we'll discuss what can be done to improve balance in each of the motivational aspects. Exercises, tips, and concrete actions are provided to aid the process of personal growth and development.

Self-Esteem

For Entertainers, their self-esteem is a sense of competency at whatever they choose to pursue. Since they're Extraverts with the Feeling trait, much of that competency has to do with other people.

Balanced Self-Esteem

For these types, balanced self-esteem is enhanced by – but not dependent on – knowing they have the freedom to experience life as they please and having the adequate competence to bring others into the fold with them. In endeavors that matter to them, Entertainers aim to hone their skills, be innovative, and, above all, find joy.

As their name suggests, Entertainers love to put on a good show and tend to self-improve to the point of personal satisfaction. However, it's important to remember that although these types may work hard, they aren't perfectionists. If anything, they may consider the flaws in their work to be important defining factors and, in true Entertainer fashion, the very things that set them apart from the rest.

Unbalanced Self-Esteem

When their self-esteem drops, Entertainers are likely to hope that acquiring others' approval can restore their self-worth. At times, they may concentrate almost exclusively on how to win other people over and seek their acceptance. This intense,

narrow focus may result in collateral damage, however, resulting in Entertainers' sacrificing important aspects of their lives and finding they must choose between caring for their own needs and catering to others' desires. Alas, the love of others is a fleeting thing and never measures up to self-approval.

When their self-worth takes a dive, Entertainers may begin a fruitless search for answers in other people – and in an odd twist, the less they know a person, the more they may want to please them. That's why, when their self-esteem is unbalanced, Entertainers may stop listening to the praise of friends and family, and instead turn their ears toward the criticism of acquaintances and the public, giving their opinions and values far more credit than they should.

Rebalancing Self-Esteem

When their quest for love and acceptance becomes an obsession, Entertainers must step back and see the big picture – specifically, how they're fulfilling their personal needs. To do so, they can grab a piece of paper and try to clarify their personal values, or what makes them happy. They should try to imagine themselves existing in a vacuum, with no other soul around, and consider these questions:

- When were they happiest?
- What times were they proud of themselves?
- When did they feel most true to themselves?

Entertainers can extrapolate their values from their answers. For example, if they answered, "I was the happiest when I was with my family telling a story," then perhaps "family" would be one of their values. The further Entertainers break down their personal values, the easier it is to determine if they're living their lives in ways that

reflect those beliefs. Are they shortchanging their health and happiness for the approval of others?

As they change their lives, Entertainers can take heart by reminding themselves that self-esteem built on a single area of accomplishment isn't sustainable. By focusing on their personal values – and on those who love them – Entertainers can accept themselves, and stop fretting over the acceptance of others.

Self-Respect

For Entertainers, self-respect comes from their ability to think on their feet and solve problems on an almost improvisational level. Their self-respect doesn't involve deep deliberation. They prefer the action encompassed in assessing a situation and providing a hands-on solution. It doesn't matter which discipline they master – the dynamic is the same. They like to think of themselves as able to manipulate the different parts of their specialty to provide results.

Balanced Self-Respect

Entertainers like themselves when they see they're flexible and able to deal skillfully with unexpected things that come at them. "Steady as she goes" brings no sense of fulfillment to these types. They assess themselves by how well they solve problems. In striving for self-respect, Entertainers exercise and hone their skill at handling sudden predicaments.

Although many personality types like some measure of stability, Entertainers find no satisfaction in staying on metaphorical "solid ground." They feel better about themselves after they've navigated choppy waters and figured out how to keep the boat upright. Successfully negotiating twisting trails beats driving down the straight

and narrow highway every time. There's no sense of accomplishment for them in sitting around being content.

Because of this, there's nothing like having Entertainers around during a crisis, and these individuals never feel better about themselves than when they're effectively dealing with one. If there's an emergency, find an Entertainer. They'll take care of the situation – and be happy in the process. They must constantly prove they have the skill and flexibility to take care of such matters in order to respect themselves.

Unbalanced Self-Respect

The problem Entertainers face is that everybody else in the world isn't an Entertainer. To feel more self-respect, some Entertainers may resort to seeking out difficulties to conquer or take risks just to prove themselves to themselves. While they continue to look for problems to solve and things to master, family, friends, and coworkers may not be so interested in constantly facing down difficulties to show their skills (or see how fun Entertainers can be). Most other people like to avoid problems and aren't as stimulated by overcoming difficulties as Entertainers are.

Others may come to see Entertainers as careless, unstable, undependable, or even, at times, dangerous. In a social or work setting, this can cause a lot of disharmony. To make these conflicts even worse, Entertainers who find themselves “on a mission” may not care very much about the opinions of others.

Think of Don Draper on the TV series *Mad Men*, and the unpopular, bold risks he frequently took to solve problems at his ad agency. This disregard for friends, business associates, and loved ones can be damaging. When their motivational engine is out of balance, Entertainers might get a shot of self-worth as they solve problems – only to learn that others aren't so enamored with them. Entertainers

should try to understand boosting self-respect at the expense of others may make their lives less than satisfying when all is said and done.

Rebalancing Self-Respect

Reframing is a psychological trick we play on ourselves to create a new attitude or encourage new behavior. When we reframe, we shift our perspective. This helps us respond to things differently.

Entertainers who are likely to run over other people while overzealously trying to solve problems, create solutions, or master skills, might do well to reframe the way they look at their social or business networks as puzzles they need to solve. Each unhappy person in their social constellation is a challenge. If spouses or friends are upset, then what can Entertainers do to make them feel better? If their bosses are unhappy with Entertainers' narrow focus on a procedural headache, what can be done to solve the "boss problem?"

These are all worthy challenges for those who think about them that way. Therapists or counselors might help sometimes, but Entertainers are most likely inclined to develop these people skills in their own way.

Self-Confidence

While it might sound circular, Entertainers gain confidence when they act in confident ways. By taking bold actions, they send a message to themselves that they're on the right track and can move forward even more confidently. That such actions are bold is often the only sign of success they need. Trying new and different things drives the Entertainers' self-confidence.

Balanced Self-Confidence

Many credit German writer and statesman Goethe with saying, “Boldness has genius, power and magic in it. Begin it now.” This quotation is music to Entertainers’ ears. A sense of brashness gives Entertainers the thrust they need to move forward in life. They have little regard for traditional standards or rules. These are too confining and limit the Entertainers’ creative imagination. Boldly finding new places to be (metaphorically or literally) and new ways to do things pull Entertainers confidently into the future. The “next new thing” energizes them. They love change where others dread it. Their attraction to daring innovation and problem-solving gives them energy and confidence.

Unbalanced Self-Confidence

Our culture admires boldness. Our heroes are those who are daring and act in larger-than-life ways. However, when the need to feel confident becomes so strong that Entertainers act boldly simply for the sake of being bold, it can be damaging. Such action can disconnect them from their social or career network by putting anything that’s meaningful at risk – like business plans, security, and the things that make others feel safe. They move forward with great bluster, but those around them might just shake their heads at what they only see as erratic behavior.

Rebalancing Self-Confidence

Mission statements that describe the vision of an organization or a person have become a staple for goal-setting and self-improvement. Entertainers would do well to spend a little time expanding their comfort zone and creating a mission statement. Or, they may want to review the mission statement of any organization to which they belong. They may consider putting their own bold spin on it, but such a statement

can help them stay in touch with what's relevant and important. A map like that could help Entertainers stay on the road to meaningful outcomes, even when their need to express their boldness is urging them to veer off in a different direction. This counterbalance to their Prospecting nature may help them stay in touch with the bigger picture – and the needs and goals of others.

Areas for Personal Growth

Entertainers embody a curious paradox. Gregarious and charismatic, they draw people to them. At a party, others tend to flock around them, trying to edge in on their conversations – which, more likely than not, are fascinating. Romantic partners may fall head over heels for Entertainers, attracted to their adventuresome, passionate spirits. These influences can come with some pitfalls, however. Although Entertainers tend to be the life of the party, they're also sensitive to others and prone to bursts of moodiness.

Another area where Entertainers may struggle is planning and consistency. Spontaneous to the point of thrill seeking, Entertainers like to live in the moment and leave their options open. This mindset can create problems, however, preventing them from reaching their full potential in their careers, their relationships, and their daily lives.

Let's explore these areas further, considering how Entertainers can make use of their strengths while counterbalancing their weaknesses.

Interpersonal Effectiveness

Balanced Interpersonal Effectiveness

Entertainers are known for their cleverness, ingenuity, and artistic skills. The term “artist” can mean many things when talking about these types – some are artists in the truest sense of the word. But often, they’ll use their creative skills to experience everything to the fullest and entertain other people. There is no other personality type as adept at this, and it’s a trait that contributes greatly to their popularity – especially once they get enough freedom to follow their own paths.

Because of this trait, Entertainers tend to have a sensation-seeking personality and are fascinated by things they can experience with their five senses. Abstract, theoretical matters don’t interest them as much – people with the Entertainer personality type seek sensual rather than mental stimulation.

Unbalanced Interpersonal Effectiveness

Entertainers are powerful when it comes to emotions. Great power comes with great responsibility – and, to add another cliché, power often corrupts. Entertainers may become so used to getting what they want through subtle manipulation that the line of what’s acceptable can blur quickly.

Deeply utilitarian at heart, Entertainers are unlikely to worry too much about this; but, if they’re not careful, people with this personality type could become exploitative or hurtful and find themselves in danger of drifting toward entirely selfish or even antisocial activities. Entertainers have the potential of becoming outstanding entrepreneurs or brilliant con artists, and everything in between – it’s up to them to decide where to draw the line.

Also, the Entertainer personality type is one of the most impulsive and hot-blooded, cherishing novelty and unpredictability. They may engineer dramas or convince other people to do something simply for the sake of shaking things up – Entertainers cannot stand boredom and routine.

It's important to keep this trait in check, though, or these types may begin a downward spiral, where they keep taking ever greater risks and seeking ever stronger sensations, all in the name of thrills and variety. This can be especially destructive in romantic relationships – their lovers may either get stressed out by their increasing instability or join in, encouraging such adrenaline-seeking behavior.

It doesn't help that Entertainers often avoid committing to anything, knowing full well that life is unpredictable and choosing to live in the present instead of planning for the future. Many Entertainers are happy with this approach – after all, "Seize the day!" is their motto. However, other people in their lives may expect Entertainers to commit to relationships relatively early, and they may feel hurt if this expectation isn't met.

Rebalancing Interpersonal Effectiveness

People with this personality type need not worry too much about attracting significant others – probably their partners will find them instead. Entertainers may need to work on recognizing (and, if necessary, managing) their partners' expectations, though, if they want to have strong, lasting relationships.

The same principles apply to non-romantic relationships as well. Entertainers are unlikely to have any difficulties making friends and should leverage that strength wherever possible, but their intrinsic unwillingness to settle down and stop wandering may surprise other people.

Entertainers can rebalance their spontaneity when it comes to their personal relationships by finding close, dependable friends they can use as sounding boards for decision making. These by no means have to be restrictive relationships, but rather friendships based on honesty and mutual benefit. Entertainers can add spice to their dependable friends' lives in exchange for hearing the occasional "Hey, maybe that isn't a good idea."

Quick Thinkers

Balanced Quick Thinking

The most impressive trait of all Entertainers is their ability to "think on their feet" – people with this personality type are able to make snap decisions, always able to escape even the most challenging situations. This makes them excellent troubleshooters and improvisers, especially where there is a need to act quickly and ignore the established procedures, if necessary. Although Entertainers are fiercely utilitarian, willing to do what it takes to get the job done, even if it means breaking the existing traditions, they also have an exceptionally kind attitude toward other people.

Unbalanced Quick Thinking

Entertainers should be aware of their tendency to focus on the main goal and leave all other tasks aside. This attitude allows them to move quickly but poses a danger to their legacy once the main task is finished. Other people, especially those opposed to Entertainers' "Let's get this done!" attitude, may ignore the main achievement in favor of pointing fingers at all the little things left unfinished or the established procedures that have been overlooked.

Unfortunately, this amazing trait is often misunderstood and drowned out by other people's suggestions to be methodical, to not disturb the waters, to follow the well-established paths, and so on. This is especially apparent in highly-structured environments, such as schools or public institutions. Entertainer children can be chastised for being restless and impatient, and then asked why they can't be more like the "good" pupils (likely belonging to one of the Sentinel types). Younger Entertainers may feel as if their strengths are undervalued, and may even repress their spontaneity and desire for excitement to fit in.

Rebalancing Quick Thinking

Entertainers tend to be brilliant frontline executors, but mediocre administrators or logisticians. People with this personality type are at their best when accompanied by others who can sort out the logistics behind the operation.

It often takes a crisis for other people to recognize the true value of Entertainers' skills; however, this doesn't mean Entertainers should be reluctant to capitalize on their strengths or feel ashamed of them. These types should do their best to find a niche that's right for them, and then follow their instincts instead of listening to critics and naysayers.

To paraphrase Irish playwright George Bernard Shaw, "The careful man adapts himself to the world; the reckless one persists in trying to adapt the world to himself. Therefore, all progress depends on the reckless man." Entertainers should know their limitations but shouldn't be afraid to capitalize on their strengths – no other personality type knows how to enjoy the present moment as much as they do, and no one should underestimate the importance of the joy and excitement Entertainers bring to other people's lives.

Emotionality

Balanced Emotionality

Another major strength that all Entertainers share is excellent social skills. These types instinctively know what makes other people tick and what arguments they're likely to listen to. Very few personality types could be kinder than Entertainers – people with this type are masters of their observational and improvisational skills, instinctively knowing how they should react to what others say or do. This usually leads to Entertainers being popular in many circles, both professionally and personally.

Also, Entertainers are bold and able to both notice and act on opportunities where other types can't or don't want to. This boldness and thirst for adrenaline are also likely to be very attractive to other people, including potential romantic partners. Just like many other things in their lives, Entertainers' relationships are full of both excitement and unpredictability. They're always finding something interesting to do and keeping the flame of their love affairs burning brightly.

Unbalanced Emotionality

This emotionality unavoidably has a dark side, giving Entertainers the ability to exploit other people's weaknesses, manipulating or convincing them to do something that goes against their best interests. Ultimately, it's up to these individuals to learn to channel their energy in positive directions, creating and delivering value instead of acting like con artists.

Rebalancing Emotionality

People with this personality type should be aware of this danger and keep an eye out for potential attempts at manipulation. As already mentioned, Entertainers tend to be very kind and friendly, but their good nature may be abused by less scrupulous individuals. Awareness of this tendency is perhaps the strongest way of handling both the benefits and downsides of emotionality.

Conclusion

Entertainers find acting in ways that bring about effective, immediate results gives them meaning and purpose, and they always seek to develop on that level. They hone their very lives to be fine and effective tools. As artisans in all senses of the word, such self-refinement is the Entertainers' preferred way to grow.

The harder way Entertainers can grow involves stopping long enough to thoughtfully plan and create consistency in their lives. Taking the time to see how other people are doing in the midst of their flurry of activity can bring them more satisfaction. Most people need others to comfortably fit into their lives – and Entertainers, perhaps more than any other type, find joy in having others close by. However, the same thing that gives them joy – if treated haphazardly and devoid of good judgement – can also bring them pain. Thoughtfully balancing their activities and their relationships help them grow in significant ways.

There are courses available called “life skills classes,” verifying what everyone already knows. Life is a skill. It involves skill building. It's something to tinker with. It's something to polish. Developing their lives and attaining personal growth can fit Entertainers' foundational skill set perfectly.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your personal growth? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Locus of Control Test

Dig deeper into who or what you feel is responsible for your life satisfaction, happiness, and level of fulfillment.

Emotional Intelligence Test

Find out how good you are at understanding your own emotions as well as paying attention to the emotions of others with this test.

Confidence Test

How much do you believe in your competence and ability to successfully follow through on the choices you make? Let's find out.

Dark and Light Side Test

Your moral choices may not be as simple as you think. This test asks you to go deep and take an honest look at your attitudes.

Resilience and Grit Test

Some people are hard to knock down; some find it easy to get back up; and some are both or neither. Which group do you belong to?

Coping Styles Test

There are four primary ways to cope with crisis. This test explores the dominant and secondary techniques you're likely to turn to.

Optimism and Pessimism Test

This simple test measures your levels of both optimism and pessimism in a novel way. Find out where you fall in each of these areas.

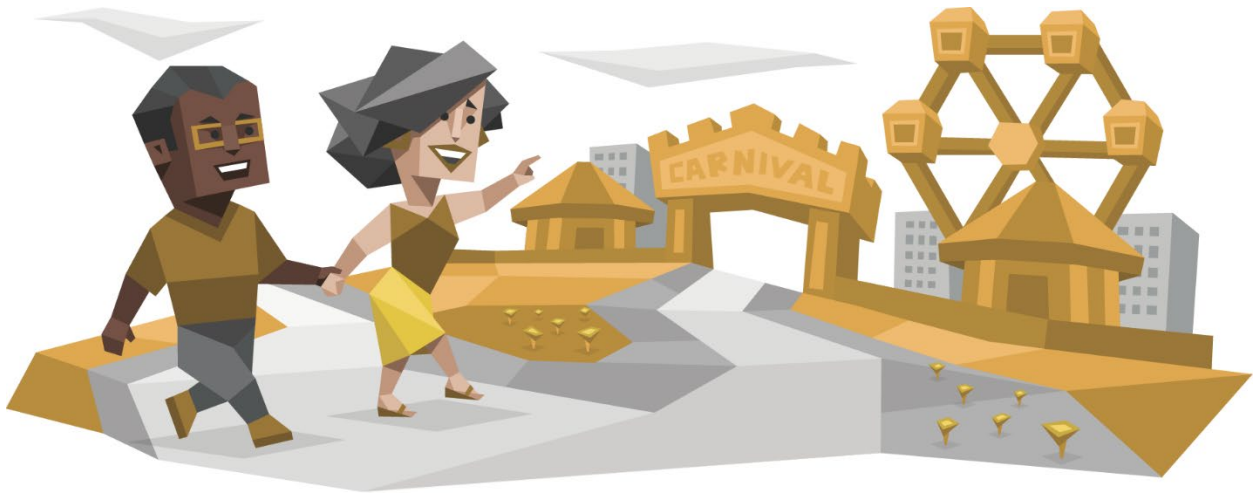
Imagination and Magic Beliefs Test

How does your imagination work? What is your belief about magic? Explore the role of imagination, magic, and belief in your life.

Traveling Preferences Test

This simple test delves into your preferred choices during those times when you leave home to explore the world.

Romantic Relationships



In relationships, few personality types are as enthralling and unpredictable as Entertainers. Whether platonic or romantic, people with this personality seek fun and pleasure in each moment of their relationships. Entertainers sweep their partners off their feet, lavish them with affection, and devise exciting things to do together such as hanging out in new social scenes or exploring the latest hot spots. Caring, charismatic, and emotionally attuned, Entertainers don't just make their lovers feel like the center of the world – they make the center of the world a happening place to be.

Their intense focus on the present makes it easy for these types to be in the moment and at the center of everyone's attention; however, it has its downsides. For some Entertainers, this often means they haven't learned as much from their past relationships as they could. In addition, their inability to tolerate discomfort in the present moment may make them bail when their relationships face challenges, stumbling blocks, or lulls. When it's time to change old patterns, negotiate tricky situations, and make long-term plans and commitments, Entertainers with an

unbalanced approach to romance may be tempted to cut and run. From the outside, it looks as if they're devoted one moment and then disconnected the next.

Entertainers sometimes face another major challenge in their relationships: feelings. As any Entertainer may tell you, the world of feelings can be gloriously all-consuming, from desire to joy to love itself. People with this personality type give themselves over to their emotions, experiencing their full range and potency. At times, however, emotional regulation is necessary, whether it means taking a moment to cool down during an argument or considering a criticism before defending themselves against it. This skill doesn't come easily to Entertainers, and unless they consciously develop it, they may overreact to reproaches or snags in their relationships, taking every slight – real and imagined – personally.

When they bring these traits into balance, Entertainers are generous and enthusiastic with other people. Always seeking fresh ways to express their affection and enrich their relationships, they delight in making their partners feel special. For Entertainers, ideal romance is founded on true love, simple pleasures, and plenty of romantic sparks.

Dating and the Single Entertainer

Entertainers are sociable, outgoing individuals who love to branch out and meet new people. At bars, parties, and group gatherings, they draw focus from the spotlight, making it easy to catch the eyes of potential partners. Open-minded and curious, Entertainers rarely stick to a "type." They might date a free-spirited artist, a sharp-witted scholar, or a warm-hearted doctor – all in one week.

Some Entertainers, however, are swayed by social status and outward appearances when choosing lovers. These individuals are acutely sensitive to others' opinions and

find it difficult to date someone their peers might not consider a “catch.” As a result, they may gravitate toward people who appear to be attractive and successful, rather than search for someone who fulfills them on a deeper level.

Fortunately, Entertainers excel at venturing into new terrain and breaking through old limits; they’re perfectly capable of pushing past conventions and expectations in their search for soul mates. When they’re on dates, Entertainers can tune into their true feelings by using their acute sensory awareness and observational skills. By noticing how potential partners make them feel on emotional and physical levels, these types can learn to distinguish between a relationship they truly want and a relationship that just looks good from the outside.

Entertainers in the Bedroom

Entertainers are emotionally intelligent people who also are very much in touch with the physical world. These combined qualities make them great sexual partners. Affectionate and sensual, Entertainers cultivate an easygoing, almost automatic intimacy in their romantic relationships. They appreciate what their lovers do for them, and they genuinely enjoy discovering what brings their partners’ pleasure. This heightened open-mindedness extends to the bedroom, leaving Entertainers with relatively few hang-ups or insecurities regarding their sexuality.

As in other areas of their lives, Entertainers seek pleasure in the present moment, and they may feel less devoted to their partners if their sex lives plateau or fall into a rut. Novelty-seeking Entertainers may be tempted to stray or end their relationships if the spark fades. If their relationships are meaningful, however, Entertainers are more than capable of reigniting the flame. They can use their creativity to look for new ways to please themselves and their significant others,

introducing novelty, play, and experimentation into even the longest standing of relationships.

Potential Personality Pairings

The Right Approach

Entertainers are typically affectionate and caring toward their partners. They know how to have a good time and delight in the moment. But they also contribute to the relationship in practical and consistent ways, proving to their sweethearts they're trustworthy and reliable. Despite their cravings for novelty, Entertainers at their best recognize when a relationship is too precious to lose.

Although romance is far from an exact science, most people with the Entertainer personality type understand that putting their best foot forward achieves the best results. With so many personality variables in play, relationships can highlight their many strengths, including their innate open-mindedness and adaptability. Relationships can also provide Entertainers with invaluable chances to learn, develop, and grow into the individuals they want to be.

The information presented in this section is designed to help Entertainers build and navigate successful romantic relationships. With that in mind, we'll offer a look at some of the ways they're likely to interact with other personality types. Additionally, we'll look at ways Entertainers can maximize their chances for happiness by creating fulfilling, balanced relationships with those types.

Entertainer-Analyst Relationships



In romance, opposites often attract to make their other halves complete. That potential is there when Entertainers and Analysts fall in love. More in touch with the concrete and aesthetic world, Entertainers tend to decide matters through a more emotional filter. Analysts, however, dwell in a world of ideas and theories and prefer a more rational filter. If they avoid making their differences points of contention, they're likely to find something unique and interesting with the potential for powerful lives together that neither would experience alone.

Balanced Entertainer-Analyst Relationships

Open Minds, Good Times

In the early stages of romance, Entertainers might delight in the novelty of Analysts' ideas, particularly if these ideas relate to something tangible. They may also enjoy helping Analysts break out of their serious, intellectual shells. With their carefree, inventive mindsets, Entertainers find it gratifying to introduce Analysts to new ways to kick back and have fun.

As their shared relationships progress, Entertainers often appreciate Analysts' lack of concern about conventions and traditions. Entertainers love to try new things and embrace current trends, and they crave partners who won't hold them back in their experimentation. Analysts typically are unconcerned with standard aesthetics, and they likely won't object even when their Entertainer sweethearts gravitate toward the *avant-garde*—whether that means wearing a wild new outfit or performing an edgy song.

Entertainers also appreciate the breathing room likely to be granted by Analyst partners. Analysts go into their own mental world, needing to spend time with their ideas and theories. Entertainers may not want to go along for the ride, but they can use this time and energy to discover more about the world in their way, taking advantage of the latitude and freedom given by their Analyst partners. Nobody will ever accuse an Entertainer–Analyst pair of smothering each other.

Unbalanced Entertainer–Analyst Relationships

Mirror, Mirror

In the dating process, some Entertainers might be turned off by Analysts. All Entertainers have a highly developed aesthetic sense, but occasionally some of them can veer off into superficiality, becoming obsessed with image or appearances. These Entertainers may be embarrassed even to be seen with Analysts, who are hardly known for their sharp sense of style.

If Entertainers try to change Analysts – encouraging them to shop at trendy boutiques, for example – they're likely fighting a losing battle. Analysts have a lot of self-respect, but they rarely see the point of trying to impress other people. They

won't withhold their opinions, either, and Entertainers may be criticized for focusing on appearances rather than more “important” matters.

Criticism and Contempt

In troubled Entertainer–Analyst relationships, partners don't always appreciate how their differences can serve as strengths. As their relationships progress, conversations may regularly spiral downward into criticism or even contempt. Entertainers may occasionally be hurt by Analysts' bluntness. Overly sensitive Entertainers might return fire in ways that hurt their partners much more than they realize from the Analysts' stoic exteriors.

These conversations often follow common patterns. Because Entertainers prefer to focus on actionable matters and the present moment instead of abstractions and hypothetical scenarios, their Analyst partners might accuse them of being shallow, unimaginative, or intellectually incurious. Entertainers might also find themselves targeted for their interest in “frivolous” matters, such as fun, fashion, or receiving attention from others.

This is a two-way street, however. Entertainers may lose patience with their Analyst lovers' need to theorize about everything, which might seem stodgy, boring, or pointless to them. Given Analysts' disregard for nitty-gritty, practical matters, Entertainers may find – to their dismay – that household chores regularly fall to them when Analysts get caught up in their latest obsessions or projects. For both these partners, stress levels can escalate in tandem with domestic chaos, as laundry piles grow, and dirty dishes overflow the sink.

Although Entertainers are generally good-natured, they readily show their feelings – including, at times, their negative judgments. The resulting chronic pain and

frustration on both sides may leave the roving-prone Entertainers to wonder if it's time to move on.

Rebalancing Entertainer–Analyst Relationships

Inviting Analysts Along

Rather than becoming irritated at what they perceive as their Analyst significant others' stodginess, Entertainers can encourage them to come along on one of their adventures. By inviting Analysts into their world of fun and discovery, Entertainers get a win-win: quality time with their partners and the joy of sharing good times with those they care about.

To persuade Analysts to participate in new activities, Entertainers can highlight the benefits or upsides of an adventure – whether that's taking advantage of a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity, seeing a new artist or band before they catch on, or just gaining much-needed stress relief and the resulting health benefits. Analysts think rationally, and they allocate their time and energy accordingly. Without losing their sense of spontaneity, Entertainers can focus just enough on the *why* of an activity to interest their Analyst partners.

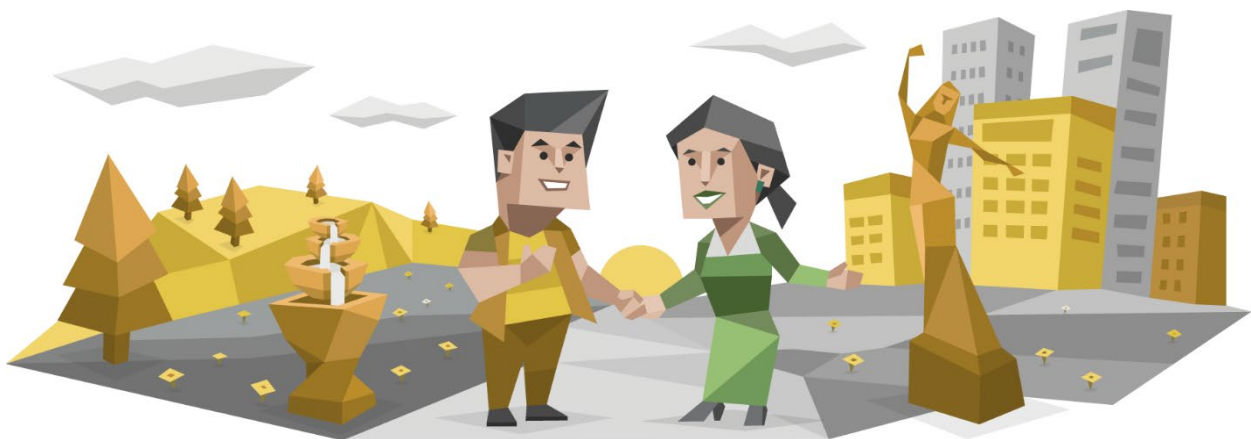
Outsource, Automate, Skip

As their romances progress and these two types move in together, they must find a sustainable way to manage their shared homes. Because hands-on, mundane details hold little interest for Analysts, Entertainers may end up with more than their share of household responsibilities. Entertainers may feel bogged down by chores and duties that cramp their style. They might even be tempted to blow off these responsibilities, leaving their home in a state of chaos. Although this might sound like

a small matter, the division of domestic responsibilities can become a major issue in long-term relationships.

Entertainers should sit down with their partners and – tedious though it may seem – write out a list of all recurring chores, payments, and tasks. Fortunately, the next step is much more fun: identify everything that can be outsourced, automated, or skipped altogether. This may mean budgeting for a cleaning service, setting aside some time to establish recurring bill payments, or even parting with rarely used items that require regular maintenance. By taking these steps, Entertainers and their Analyst lovers can lighten their load of chores and responsibilities, leaving them more time and energy for pursuits that light them up instead.

Entertainer–Diplomat Relationships



While both base their decisions on humanistic, emotional foundations, Entertainers have a bias toward practical action, and Diplomats favor a less concrete approach. Diplomats might be at home reading books on ending poverty and dreaming of material equality in the world; Entertainers might just as likely be out pounding nails along with other Habitat for Humanity volunteers. But romances between dreamers

and doers are often successful. When they fall in love, they sometimes find the dimensions their partners add are just the things they needed in their lives.

Balanced Entertainer-Diplomat Relationships

Free Spirits

When they first date, Diplomats are typically enthralled by their Entertainer partners' free spirits and enthusiasm for living in the moment. Given their curiosity about other people, Entertainers may be drawn to the unusual ways Diplomats express themselves and their almost mystical presence. These two types tend to find a fair amount of shared ground, including mutual desires for freedom and novelty. When these two types date, it can be an exciting time full of energy and anticipation.

As their shared relationships mature, Entertainers and Diplomats can bring out the best in each other. Neither type is a slave to convention, so each will likely grant the other the freedom to pursue unusual interests, seize new opportunities, and grow to their full potential. Adaptable and flexible, they can respond to unexpected challenges as a united front, weathering storms and embracing change when necessary. Over time, Entertainers may find that Diplomats deepen and enrich their lives, helping them to identify and embrace their values without losing their free-spirited spontaneity.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Diplomat Relationships

Drama Ensues

Entertainers live in the moment, expressing themselves and their feelings readily. This can be a wonderful match for Diplomats in the early stages of romance. As time progresses and the stakes get higher, however, Entertainers may inadvertently rile

Diplomats' sensitivity. They're often surprised by the extent of Diplomats' inner landscapes, including the time they spend dwelling on past issues and dreaming about the future. Unbeknownst to Entertainers, Diplomats might be mulling over week-old conversations, putting their partners on pedestals, or planning their future lives together.

When Entertainers levy a criticism – even a mild one – it can suck the wind out of Diplomats' sails, particularly if it affects their visions of the future. Given their future orientation, Diplomats might assume Entertainers are interested in pursuing long-term relationships when they're just enjoying the present moment. Diplomats' typical sensitivity can be heightened in arguments with their Entertainer sweethearts, creating a high level of drama. Entertainers with an unbalanced approach to romance might leave these issues unresolved, escaping such conversations or even bailing on their relationships altogether.

I Love You, Now Change

Independent to the core, Entertainers dislike anyone trying to change them. In unbalanced relationships, however, Diplomats – with their love of principles and possibilities – may try to turn Entertainers into idealistic, metaphysical thinkers. Over time, these Diplomats may grow tired of what they see as Entertainers' superficial need for novelty and good times.

Some Entertainers aren't immune to the temptation to change their Diplomat partners, either. As their relationships progress, they may become annoyed by Diplomats' tendency to live in their heads and dream about ways to help others instead of embracing experiences and taking practical action. Entertainers might also become frustrated when Diplomats – particularly Introverted types – need to stay

home and relax rather than go out and have a good time. Unless they learn to appreciate the differences between themselves and their partners, Entertainers may abandon relationships in search of greener pastures.

Rebalancing Entertainer–Diplomat Relationships

Ease and Plenty

In the early stages of romance, Entertainers and Diplomats can thrive on each other's spontaneous energy and love of possibilities. As time progresses, however, these relationships – like all relationships – need solid, relatively predictable foundations. If they're constantly fretting about financial issues and car maintenance, for example, these couples inevitably struggle to maintain their closeness and mutual respect.

In the long run, it's also important for Entertainers and Diplomats to face financial realities. Many of these tasks can be automated or outsourced, such as automatic contributions to retirement accounts or tax planning. By taking these steps, Entertainers and their Diplomat partners can spend more time and energy on their strengths, forging strong connections rather than fretting over everyday matters.

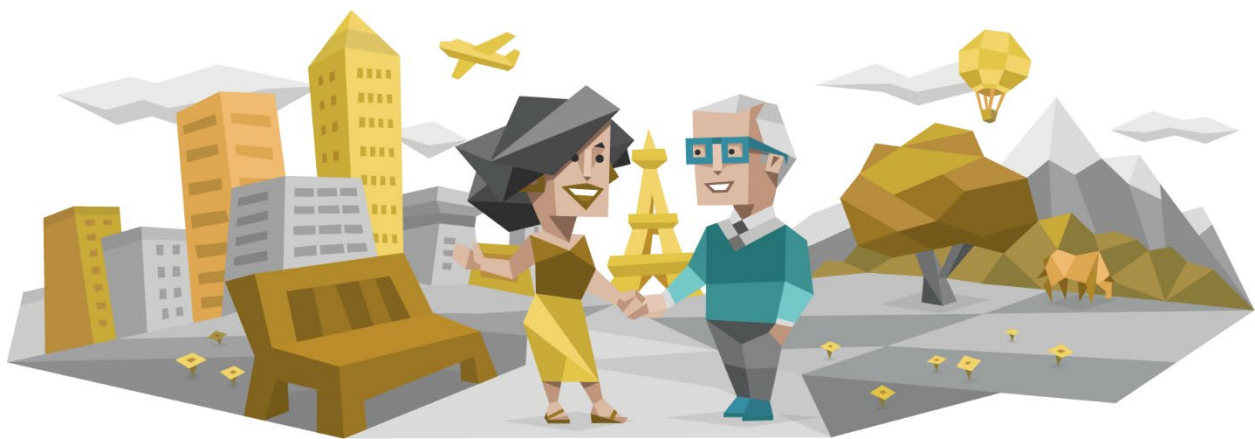
Time Together, Time Apart

Entertainers and Diplomats might dive into relationships headlong, wanting to spend great swathes of time together. As their partnerships progress, however, they need to set aside time to pursue their individual interests. Otherwise, Entertainers may exhaust their Diplomat partners with fun outings and events, leaving Diplomats insufficient time to tend to their ideas and dreams.

By balancing time together with time apart, Entertainers and Diplomats can sidestep the need to change each other. Entertainers can venture to gallery openings, open

mic nights, and parties to their hearts' delight, and Diplomats can nurture their Intuitive trait by reading, journaling, daydreaming, planning, or even setting up discussion groups or book clubs. Once they've satisfied these differing needs, Entertainers and Diplomats can then focus on spending quality time together, doing mutually enjoyable activities.

Entertainer-Sentinel Relationships



While Entertainers and Sentinels might share many of the same preferences, their contrasting Prospecting and Judging traits make all the difference. Like the rudder on a ship decides its direction, these opposing characteristics tend to turn Sentinels right and Entertainers left.

However, both these types enjoy practicality that comes with living in the “real world.” Entertainer-Sentinel couples need not put up with all the theories and abstractions they might need to with Analyst or Diplomat partners. Each likes to live practical lives where they manipulate material things. In sharing this focus, these sweethearts speak the same down-to-earth language.

Balanced Entertainer–Sentinel Relationships

Practical Action

When Entertainers and Sentinels date, they discover a mutual love of quick, practical action. Thanks to the Observant trait, both types live firmly in the “here and now,” focusing on life as it is rather than life as it could be.

Over time, Entertainers and Sentinels can become deeply attuned to each other. This can manifest itself even in the way they communicate. Their conversations often center on specific, actionable issues – not the future-oriented vagaries that those with the Intuitive trait favor. As a result, Entertainer–Sentinel couples can operate as effective teams, solving problems and facing challenges in real time.

Novelty and Security

When balanced, Entertainer–Sentinel couples complement each other, providing a perfect yin to the other’s yang. This might surprise people, given Entertainers’ love of novelty and Sentinels’ love of security. It’s true that Entertainers have a reputation for commitment-phobia, but, fortunately, they’re unlikely to gravitate toward Sentinels until they mature and see the value of settling down. The advantages of a more stable life can help them temper the strong pull toward independence that’s a hallmark of the Entertainer personality type.

During long-term relationships with Sentinels, Entertainers find support, care, and consistency – three things they may not even realize they crave. Many Entertainers weren’t recognized as bright or gifted as children, and the stabilizing influence of Sentinel lovers can help Entertainers restore their sense of self-worth. Meanwhile,

Entertainers get a kick out of exposing their Sentinel sweethearts to new things. Even solid Sentinels crave a little excitement in their lives – if it's not too disruptive.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Sentinel Relationships

Repetitive Roles

In the early stages of dating, Entertainers may be fascinated by the differences between themselves and their Sentinel partners. Over time, however, some Sentinel-Entertainer couples fall into roles that mimic parents and children, with Sentinels managing the responsibilities and Entertainers initiating the fun. At first, Entertainers might not mind this arrangement, but this dynamic prevents them from developing into their full potential and can spark frustration and resentment in their Sentinel partners. If their relationships progress too far in this direction, Entertainers may come to feel smothered, controlled, or even infantilized.

When Entertainers feel overpowered, they often back away from relationships. This can trigger Sentinels, who crave stability and commitment, to attempt to regain control. Some Sentinels may respond to this by redoubling their caretaking efforts, making Entertainers feel even more trapped. All this results in tumultuous, unhappy relationships where neither type feels free to be themselves.

Commitment Mismatch

It's no secret that Entertainers tend to be less keen on commitment than Sentinels. As we've established, Entertainers might not even consider Sentinel partners until they feel ready to settle into long-term relationships. However, Sentinels make up a sizable portion of the population, so statistically, Entertainers are likely to encounter them in the dating pool.

In some challenged Entertainer-Sentinel relationships, Entertainers might feel pushed to make commitments or major decisions, such as defining their relationships or moving in together before they feel ready. They may also feel as if their Sentinel partners are needy or clingy. Meanwhile, Entertainers might struggle to understand or validate their Sentinel partners' natural need for commitment and stability.

Even in other areas of their romance, this disjointedness between Entertainers' Prospecting trait and Sentinels' Judging trait can create tension. Entertainers' spontaneity and changeability can cause stress for their Sentinel partners, who rely on tradition and predictability to feel grounded. Entertainers might not understand why their lovers worry so much about trying new restaurants or changing travel plans at the last minute. Over time, Sentinels' resistance to change can wear on Entertainers, making them feel trapped or confined.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Sentinel Relationships

Appreciation and Affirmation

In relationships with Sentinels – or any personality type, for that matter – it's important for Entertainers to stay true to themselves. When these types feel trapped or stifled, they may indulge their instinct to move on and seek new relationships. Even if Entertainers aren't ready to commit to major transitions such as marriage, they can still offer their partners reassurance and support. This is especially important with Sentinel partners, who, although they rarely ask for it, thrive on recognition and praise.

Entertainers can set themselves the goal of expressing appreciation for their Sentinel partners daily. This can be a verbal thank-you or compliment, but it doesn't have to

be. Entertainers' concrete, spontaneous natures can be an asset here. They can stay on the lookout for creative ways to validate and appreciate their partners – whether it's writing a song for them or treating them to a date night they'll love. When Sentinels receive these consistent affirmations, they can relax, making them less likely to control or smother their Entertainer partners with attention.

R-E-S-P-E-C-T

In unbalanced Entertainer-Sentinel relationships, Sentinels end up taking on nearly all of the household responsibilities. Unbeknownst to Entertainers, their Sentinel sweeties may also keep score in their minds, noting all the ways they do more than Entertainers to keep things running smoothly. The result, unfortunately, is resentment and contempt – not exactly the ingredients for happy relationships.

The solution to this situation is respect: both self-respect and respect for romantic partners. Entertainers, at their best, recognize when the scales of responsibility are tilted too far in their partners' direction. In this situation, Entertainers spot that they're capable of helping out more – a hallmark of self-respect. They then respectfully ask their partners how they can better help out. Entertainers can ask targeted, concrete questions, such as:

- “What tasks do you find the most burdensome?”
- “I have a free hour, so what can I tackle to allow you some time to do what you want?”
- “Are there any chores or errands that we can do together?”

In balanced long-term relationships, both types make consistent contributions, demonstrating their care by sharing responsibilities.

Entertainer-Explorer Relationships



Balanced Entertainer-Explorer Relationships

Someone to explore with – at least, that’s what one might assume is the draw when Entertainers fall in love with other Explorers. But even such a match made in heaven can have nooks and crannies that make them less than perfect under the right circumstances. The Observant and Prospecting combination produces much energy and movement and, when multiplied in a couple, can be exciting. But doubling this characteristic in romantic relationships can also be a drain and subject it to unstable impulsivity. Both types need to understand what commitment means to them and be honest with each other.

Smooth Sailing

Old saws would have us believe that “opposites attract,” as though the human heart were the pole of a magnet. Fortunately, no two people are exactly alike, even if they share the same basic personality traits. There are social and environmental adaptations and nuances that prevent relationships between Explorer types from being the same as looking into a mirror. There can be plenty of the differences that keep relationships interesting – even between individuals of the same type.

In the early stages of such relationships, Entertainers may be exhilarated to be with others who share their craving for novelty. When Explorer types come together romantically, the emphasis is on playful, exciting experiences. Spending time together, they may feel even more alive than usual, creating a flirtatious, vibrant, almost electric energy between them. Because they often share similar views on commitment, Entertainers and other Explorer types can enjoy the moment fully without having mismatched expectations about the future.

As their love progresses, such couples can maintain flexibility not seen among any other paired types. Their partnerships are founded on the “here and now,” and any storms in these relationships tend to pass quickly. Entertainer–Explorer couples sometimes engage in heated exchanges, but they don’t hold grudges. As a result, their occasional arguments don’t compromise the foundation of their shared relationships.

Big Moves, Lasting Adventures

During the dating phase, Entertainers and other Explorers may orchestrate large romantic gestures designed to “wow” their partners. When the mood strikes them, they go big: skywriting, lavish gifts, impromptu vacations, and so on. As their romances progress, these impulses might become less frequent, but balanced Entertainer–Explorer couples still try at times to sweep each other off their feet.

Even as their relationships mature, there are plenty of opportunities for these couples to share novel experiences. To stay connected, Entertainers and their Explorer partners can pursue common interests in arts, crafts, and even business. They can also integrate and expand their social circles in harmony, enjoying contact with all sorts of interesting people. In balanced Entertainer–Explorer romances,

couples continue to embark on shared journeys even as the decades tick by. Such bonding of interests can provide creative stimulation and strong partnerships that last a lifetime.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Explorer Relationships

Conquests and Capriciousness

Explorers are perhaps the most mercurial types when it comes to romance. They may play the field as long as they can, resisting being “tied down” in favor of the chase. Some Explorers bounce from partner to partner, looking for fulfillment in novelty and new conquests. They leave unfinished business in their wake, sometimes breaking off relationships without even trying to explain why.

At some point, usually with age, many Entertainers and other Explorers settle down. However, they don’t always date with such long-term plans in mind. Their decision to commit may be spontaneous and almost impulsive. When romance includes not one but two Explorers, it’s easy to see how their relationships can be intense and unpredictable. Both types might enter their relationships intending to live in the moment and see where it goes, but if one type becomes attached and craves more of a commitment, they may end up deeply hurt or disappointed.

Burnout

In the early stages of dating, Entertainer-Explorer couples might feel giddy about all the things they can experience together: travel, adventure, sports, parties, art exhibits, restaurants, bars, and so on. Alas, even the most energetic Explorers can only bear such intensity for so long before it becomes too much.

Over time, Entertainer–Explorer couples may tire of expending so much energy and experiencing so much excitement. They might not realize this is the issue, however. Instead, they might attribute their feelings of burnout to their relationships, concluding that their partners are responsible for their loss of enthusiasm and *joie de vivre*.

Rebalancing Entertainer–Explorer Relationships

Downtime and Stability

Although it runs counter to their natures, Entertainer–Explorer couples experiencing burnout need to cultivate stability and downtime in their lives. To do this, they can minimize needless stress by automating and outsourcing routine tasks and responsibilities. They might also plan to spend time at home regularly – for example, one or two nights per week. By dedicating this time to recharging their figurative batteries, they can experience their relationships without distractions and stimuli from the outside world. They might even sweeten these evenings at home by establishing quiet traditions, such as watching movies or cooking new dishes together.

It's also important for these couples to give each other some space. It's perfectly fine if one partner wants to go to an art opening and the other wants to have dinner with a friend. If they still nurture some of their shared interests and embark on adventures together, Entertainer–Explorer relationships may actually be strengthened by occasional time apart.

Remembering Why They Fell in Love

The honeymoon phase of a romantic relationship may be sweet, but it isn't sustainable. Over time, even devoted couples can feel restless. Some Entertainers may be tempted to give up on relationships almost on a whim, to the extent that they lose sight of what drew them to their partners in the first place.

It's helpful for Entertainers to remember *why* they fell in love. Before giving up on their relationships, they might want to sit down and write a list of all the qualities that initially appealed to them about their partners. These should be qualities that the partners still embody – for example, their intelligence, their honesty, or their wit.

Entertainers who struggle to remember their partners' good qualities might try looking through old photos, recalling the details of their first dates, or even chatting with a few friends to see what they remember. After drawing up this list, Entertainers might be moved by how many strengths and gifts their partners bring to the relationship. If they'd like, Entertainers can share this list with their partners, but it's fine for them to keep this list as a private reminder of why they fell in love.

Conclusion

Relationships present Entertainers with wonderful opportunities to grow. Normally, people with this personality type feel tempted to bounce from option to option, but love can give them powerful motivation to explore the full range of life with a significant other. This won't happen overnight, but motivated Entertainers can fully harmonize their desire for novelty with the demands of a well-adjusted relationship, appreciating the inspiration and guidance they can gain from someone they love and

trust. Dedicated partners not only brighten Entertainers' days but also offers them a wellspring of care and support.

In balanced relationships, Entertainers push for positive change, enabling both their partners and themselves to reach higher and do more than they could alone. When their relationships are founded on acceptance, honesty, and respect, there's no reason Entertainers can't enjoy lasting and balanced love with any personality type.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your romantic relationships? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

[Get to Know Your Partner](#)

Would you like to get to know your partner a little better? Try this simple, but very fun and effective, game.

[Couple Analysis](#)

A great tool for couples. Learn how your personalities are likely to interact, and how you can connect on an even deeper level.

[Type Guesser \(Romance\)](#)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your partner belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

[Romantic Fulfillment Test](#)

Grasp the roles that confidence and optimism play in your relationships, as well as what makes someone a good match for you.

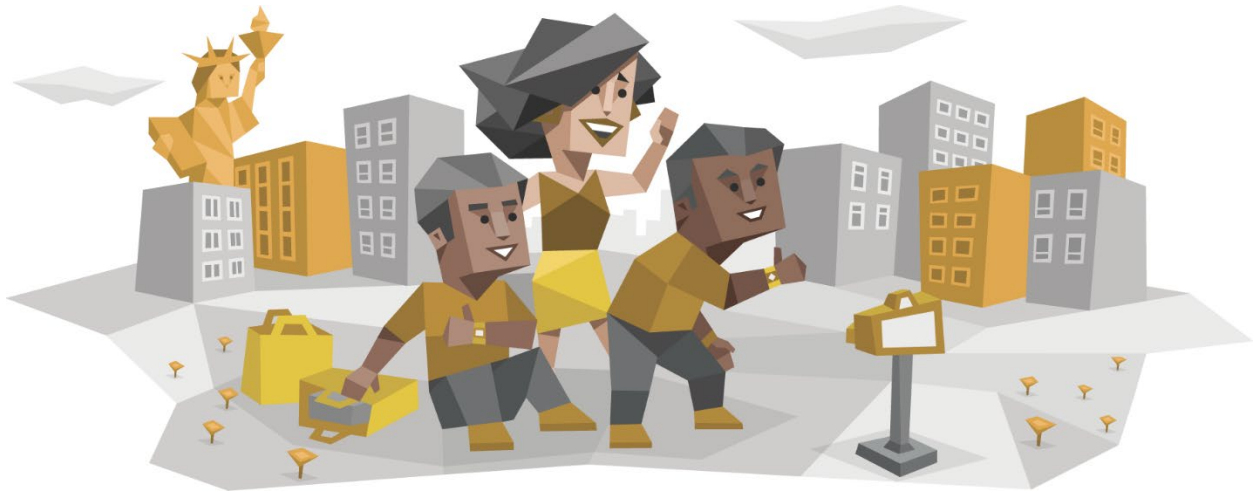
[Intertype Test](#)

Do you have a partner? Do you want to understand your relationship better? Learn more about it with our easy Intertype Test.

Loyalty Test

With this test, you will find out how you build relationships and loyalty in four major areas: Romance, Work, Friendships, and Family.

Friendships



Enthusiastic Friends

As the name may imply, Entertainers are likely to be the life of the party. With an enviable imagination and invigorating sense of spontaneity, people with the Entertainer personality type are rarely boring. They love exploring interesting ideas, both in discussion and by experiencing things for themselves, and Entertainers always seem to have fun activities hidden up their sleeves. They also are easygoing, tolerant, and charming people, which naturally makes them popular.

Entertainers thrive when they have ample opportunities to dazzle the crowd. They typically get along with just about everyone and generally make new friends wherever they go. As a naturally confident personality type (especially the Assertive among them), Entertainers live in the moment with little concern for what others think of them. This trait attracts friends who share their attitude and zest for life.

Entertainers aren't opposed to long philosophical discussions. But they're unlikely to develop friendships around one-on-one conversations about European economic challenges or the role of religion in politics. Debating over the sociopolitical

atmosphere *can* be fun and stimulate their intellect. However, for Entertainers, it doesn't compare to going out and enjoying the craziness of life. For them, life is a party. These people of action prefer to perform rather than talk about the future. The bane of their existence is sitting idle, especially in boredom.

Anyone who befriends these types can expect relationships focused on exploration, excitement, adrenaline, and risk. Entertainers are happy performing for the crowd, but they also tend to encourage their friends to join in. Most personality types might take "Thanks, but no thanks," to such invitations personally, but Entertainers are comfortable with themselves and are likely to shrug their shoulders and move on to those friends who are game for adventure.

Friendships with Other Types

Entertainers are popular, as their open-mindedness, interesting hobbies, and relaxed attitude are attractive to a remarkably broad range of personality types. With so many acquaintances, Entertainers are sure to strike up deeper friendships with at least a few.

Let's examine the challenges and joys that Entertainers are likely to face in friendships with other people belonging to each of the major Roles – Analysts, Diplomats, Sentinels, and Explorers. We'll look at some ways Entertainers can balance their traits to make their friendships more valuable, fair, and fulfilling.

Entertainer–Analyst Friendships



Friends who come from different perspectives are sometimes the best friends to have. When Entertainers (Observant and Feeling) befriend Analysts (Intuitive and Thinking), their balance and counterbalance can be sublime. Entertainers bring spontaneity and passion, and Analysts offer ideas and insights, with each contributing to potentially rich, multidimensional friendships.

Balanced Entertainer–Analyst Friendships

Combining Strategy and Action

The best thing about having Analyst friends is that they can act as rational, insightful, and strategically-minded advisors for highly practical and sometimes impatient Entertainers. Analysts pride themselves in being objective, even with their closest confidants. Friends belonging to this Role would have few qualms about criticizing Entertainers' latest ideas or specific actions.

Being direct themselves, Entertainers are likely to feel at home with Analysts' approach – if their criticism isn't too harsh or too personal. Analysts' penchant for

conceptual thinking may frustrate Entertainers. However, they may eventually appreciate the value of having capable friends willing to look at things from a different perspective.

Entertainers and Analysts also share a desire for efficiency. If the topic is right, otherwise distracted Entertainers may spend hours tinkering with systems or polishing techniques. With Analyst trying to understand the principles behind the functionality, and Entertainers experimenting with the concrete aspects, such partnerships can be mutually rewarding. Their principles and perspectives may not necessarily overlap, but there should be enough common ground for both types to benefit from opportunities to share their thoughts with each other.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Analyst Friendships

Tangible versus Conceptual

Entertainers and Analysts have their fair share of differences and may experience tension in their friendships as a result. The most important difference between them is the way these types absorb information.

Entertainers are grounded, live-in-the-moment individuals. For them, the real and tangible things matter most. Analysts take pleasure in coming up with various concepts and ideas, focusing primarily on what they imagine and deduce. There are ways to combine the two approaches – for instance, while working on a project that requires both planning and execution. But these two thinking styles may turn out to be a major barrier to communication and mutual understanding.

Another important difference is that, unlike Entertainers, Analyst types usually find it difficult to emotionally support their friends. Analysts can have strong feelings, but

they're neither comfortable with, nor experienced in, coping with other people's emotions. If Entertainers aren't familiar with such a trait, it may surprise or even hurt them.

Analyst friends may find it difficult to develop emotional connections. This would likely be difficult for Entertainers who enjoy – and are typically accustomed to – sharing their feelings and developing strong support networks among friends. Entertainers shouldn't take it personally, though, as Analysts are notorious for their focus on logic and rationality – it doesn't matter whose company they're in.

Rebalancing Entertainer–Analyst Friendships

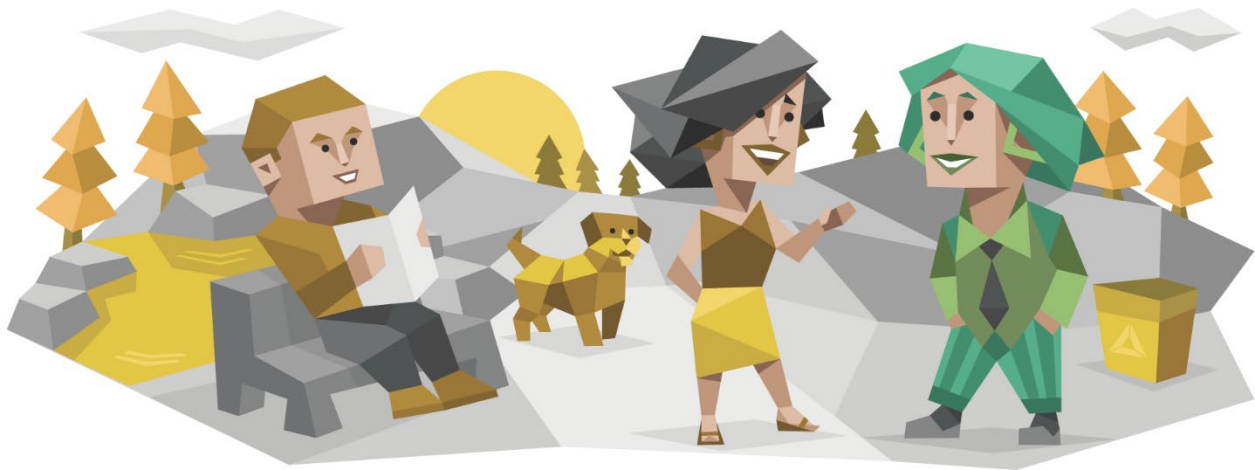
Focusing on Common Ground

While these types may have drastically different ways of exploring, expressing creativity, and thinking about the future, they can rely on their common pragmatism to resolve any differences they have. One characteristic that Entertainers share with Analysts is an appreciation of effectiveness – they both love seeing practical solutions functioning efficiently. This shared appreciation isn't limited to technical areas but also applies to the social realm. For both types, particularly in matters of pure preference (where to eat, for example), it's only practical to compromise occasionally. Such compromise can be the glue that holds their shared friendships together.

When Entertainers and Analysts experience serious friction with each other, both can dial down their sense of superiority and instead focus on finding practical solutions. Resolving their differing methods and preferences can be as easy as opening their minds to the merits of the each other's perspective and trying each other's ideas. Telling friends they're wrong about something only carries hurtful judgement.

However, showing them a better way is a respectful approach that both types can handle.

Entertainer-Diplomat Friendships



When Entertainers befriend Diplomats, there's likely to be a warmth that their interest in other people engenders. Both are passionate in their own way. Entertainers prefer hands-on expressions of their enthusiasm while, in contrast, Diplomats prefer ideas and dreams. If they become friends, it's likely because they value each other's approach to life from the moment they meet. Despite any differences, passion and warmth are the characteristics they have in common.

Balanced Entertainer-Diplomat Friendships

Differences that Inspire

Entertainers can find close Diplomat friends to be very rewarding and very perplexing. They may find each other confusing and mysterious at times. However, they also might come to enjoy their different points of view and the benefits they offer. Both

types share an open-mindedness that allows them to at least consider the validity of another angle.

Diplomats are enthusiastic, passionate, and imaginative individuals. This energy is likely to inspire Entertainers, especially initially, perhaps even giving them exciting new ideas to follow. Diplomats are rare compared to other personality types, and their unusual thinking may be very intriguing to Entertainers. However, that fascination may also include confusion – just like Analysts, Diplomats primarily live in their minds, and this attitude can be foreign to practical-minded, hands-on Entertainers.

Regardless of these issues, Entertainer–Diplomat friendships can be quite inspiring. Empathic and insightful, Diplomats can pull more realistic Entertainers away from their daily concerns, encouraging them to develop their thoughts and ideas. Diplomats tend to have a knack for making people feel relaxed and comfortable, and restless Entertainers can really profit from such company.

Idealistic and often absent-minded Diplomats also benefit from friendship with highly practical and efficiency-oriented Entertainers. People with the Entertainer personality type put their ideas into action, and this amazes Diplomats, motivating them to do the same with their own dreams. As rewarding as brainstorming potentially is, there's often just no substitute for some positive shared experiences.

Unbalanced Entertainer–Diplomat Friendships

Very Different Priorities

Both types are likely to share a certain excitement about discovering and experiencing new things, although what they define as interesting is likely to be

different. Despite this similarity, however, they may also remain enigmas to each other on some level. Diplomats' nearly constant soul-searching is as meaningful to them as experiencing things is to Entertainers. These differences can lead to numerous misunderstandings.

Another issue Entertainers and their Diplomat friends may come across is their shared tendency to neglect day-to-day matters and necessities. Whether Entertainers decide to go on unplanned road trips a week before tax returns are due, or distracted Diplomat roommates forget to transfer the rent money, both types must sometimes deal with unpleasant surprises – especially if such matters affect them both. Although meticulousness isn't always their strong suit, both Entertainers and Diplomats must pay attention to their mutual responsibilities.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Diplomat Friendships

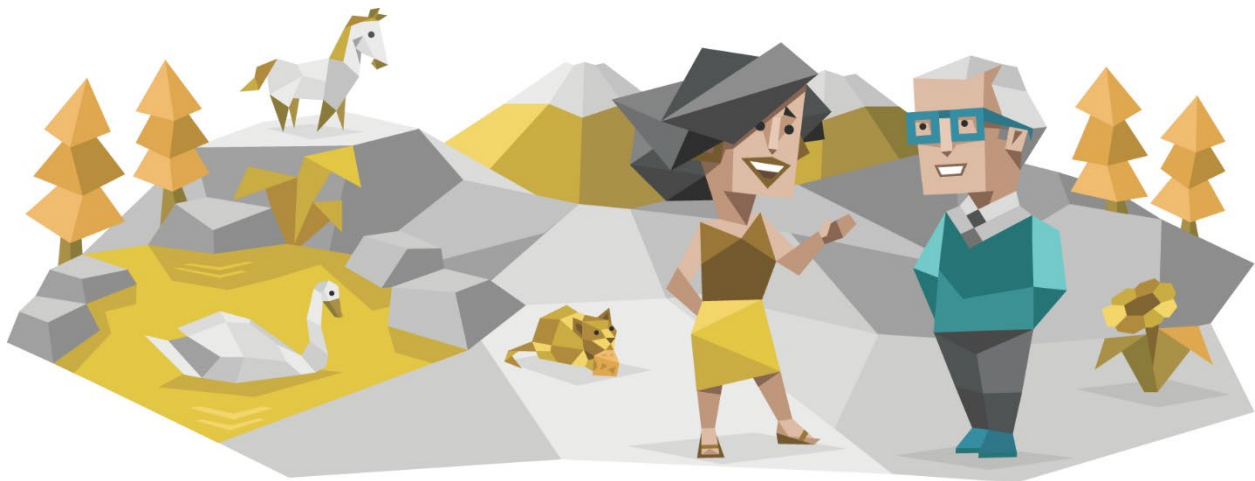
Taking Time to Help Each Other

These types may not be perfectly compatible when it comes to their day-to-day routines. They may, however, find that they enhance the richness of each other's lives when balanced with a little flexibility.

Diplomats maintain a kind of remarkable, principled sincerity that can beautifully balance Entertainers' sometimes-cynical approach to life. With Diplomat friends, Entertainers can connect to social rewards that come from thinking more broadly than just about what directly affects their lives. Entertainers are always seeking exciting challenges and may unwittingly pass right by warmer human connections as a result. But, with Diplomat friends by their side, even such energetic and logical types find time to stop and smell the roses.

Despite their neglectful attitudes toward the mundane parts of everyday life, they can provide balance for each other's respective weaknesses. When it's time to focus on necessities all too dull and ordinary for these types to enjoy, their friendship itself can provide the missing element of amusement. Even the most mundane, uninspired tasks, such as doing chores and running errands, can turn into fun adventures when these friends get together. They can offer each other company, amusing outlooks, and interesting conversation.

Entertainer-Sentinel Friendships



Entertainers and Sentinels may look very similar glancing at the personality type letters, but what a difference a single letter can make. Where Entertainers are spontaneous, Sentinels foster stability. Where Entertainers are pragmatists not always concerned with the rules, Sentinels uphold every jot and tittle of established standards. Luckily, these differences, however pronounced, don't necessarily make friendship between the two types impossible. There's much potential when these opposites attract.

Balanced Entertainer–Sentinel Friendships

Everyday Companions

Sentinels are numerous and probably make up a significant part of Entertainers' social circles unless they're particularly selective. These personality types are likely to be loyal, practical, and down-to-earth friends, always eager to offer advice and support. Sentinel friends can help Entertainers stay focused and realistic when necessary, and their patience, stability, and devotion can be invaluable in situations where Entertainers feel confused or uncertain about their constantly shifting paths.

Both Entertainers and Sentinels tend to be highly practical, with their feet planted firmly on the ground. Both types are likely to focus on activities that engage their senses: sports, going on a hike, or working on a tangible project together may be among them. More freewheeling Entertainers might add to their friendships by convincing Sentinels to let go of their serious attitudes and simply have fun occasionally. For their part, Sentinels can counterbalance Entertainers' occasional devil-may-care approach by helping them structure their lives a bit more.

Unbalanced Entertainer–Sentinel Friendships

Clashing Senses of Responsibility

The main point of contention in Entertainer–Sentinel friendships is likely to be their different understanding of freedom and individualism. Entertainers are famous for their unyielding spirit of independence. They often see rules and traditions as stifling and redundant limitations. To them, freedom of expression is more important than social cohesion or security.

On the other hand, Sentinels scoff at the thought of someone ignoring social conventions just for the sake of individualism – from their perspective, stability and security are topmost concerns. These types are likely to argue that the needs of the many outweigh the needs of the few. These differences may lead to some heated discussions revolving around flexibility and responsibility.

Rebalancing Entertainer–Sentinel Friendships

Truly Respecting Differences

There's little these types can do to rebalance friction in their shared friendships unless they're both willing to acknowledge the virtues of the other's perspective. This doesn't mean they must adopt those viewpoints as their own, but there's a chance they can bridge their differences simply by recognizing that different lifestyles can work for different people.

Entertainers can appreciate how Sentinels enjoy the sense of security that low-risk stability brings. They might also learn to respect that what may seem limited or restricted in the short term to them may be necessary for strong, long-term success for their Sentinel chums. In turn, Sentinels can appreciate that while a spontaneous, risk-taking approach may not be for them, Entertainers can – and do – make it work for their own lives. Sentinels can view their Entertainer friends with supportive amazement instead of dismay – knowing that, win or lose, they'll likely pick themselves up and begin anew.

These friends also do well to accept a degree of input from each other, as they may both be highly capable in their own ways, and equally able to give each other some balance. Sentinels who learn to take measured risks by following in the path of Entertainer friends undoubtedly increase their opportunities in life. And, Entertainers

who listen to the wise advice of Sentinel friends may sidestep some of their own worst mistakes.

Entertainer-Explorer Friendships



“Live for the moment” is the likely motto for Entertainers who strike up friendships with other Explorers. The exhilaration of such spontaneous and active relationships is likely to be heady for both. These individuals are likely asked to conform and slow down in many areas of their lives. Such shared friendships are likely a respite from the demands of others. However, there’s no perfect friendship – and even this seemingly seamless match has hazards to avoid.

Balanced Entertainer-Explorer Friendships

Lively Compatibility

For Entertainers, having close Explorer friends is a bit like looking into a mirror. Because Explorers are practical and inventive individuals, it’s unlikely that such friends will ever run out of things to do. All Explorers prefer to bond over shared activities, so it’s common for them to push each other to explore new hobbies or

immerse themselves more into existing ones. They also are likely to find it easy to maintain their camaraderie, regardless of any difficulties that may develop.

Even though free-thinking Entertainers and other Explorer types are bound to have minor differences as friends, it's likely they feel as if they've found a true mind-mate in each other. Spontaneous, bold, and willing to push limits, they're typically fun and interesting friends who provide each other with plenty of bonding opportunities.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Explorer Friendships

Shared Chaos

A key challenge for Entertainer and Explorer friends likely comes from the same source that fuels their friendship: their similarities. Having friends who are like-minded can be fun and reassuring, but it can also result in creating a bubble, isolating them from criticism and growth. There's a risk that they may convince each other that their behavior and attitude are fine, even if they need to address obvious issues – such as dealing with monotonous, yet essential, tasks.

Another issue that Entertainer-Explorer friends may face is the likelihood of both placing more importance on tangible things rather than imagination and mental exercises. It may be good to encourage each other to find time for intellectual growth and discussions about the future. If Entertainer-Explorer friends fail to stop and think about the long-term picture occasionally, problems can arise.

Rebalancing Entertainer–Explorer Friendships

Embracing New Ideas Together

Entertainers and other Explorers tend to be very open. One way for these friends to avoid being limited by their similarities is to tap into that openness and bring dissimilar kinds of friends into their circle. Entertainers are great at figuring out how unusual pieces fit together and can apply this cleverness to social relationships. Seeking new friends with different viewpoints – people from other Role groups, for example – can be an exciting adventure filled with possibilities.

Including diverse people in their social group can help these friends develop beyond just living for the moment and reaping those immediate pleasures. They can expand into being better strategic thinkers, productive dreamers, and responsible doers. Entertainers and other Explorers all benefit from friendships that encourage them to take an occasional fresh approach to things, balancing out their focus on immediate desires.

Such friends may find that not only does this make their lives more secure, but it also enables them to plan and experience new adventures together. Forethought can open even more amazing opportunities than spontaneity can because it allows these friends to inject some of their own preferences into an outcome – instead of just making do with whatever ends up happening.

Conclusion

Entertainers are energetic Extraverts and that generally means they value outreach and gain some of their energy from their friends. Their bias toward action is likely to bring an extra measure of vigor into the lives of those they befriend, and their

practical creativity tends to broaden or shift their friends' perspectives. Such exciting friendships with unique Entertainers are often things to treasure.

Entertainers are likely to be more anchored and more balanced because of the influence of these friendships. If they find someone who shares their interest, such a partner in crime to bounce ideas and schemes off of is likely to be prized. They may have to give up some of the independence they hold so dear, but the tradeoff may be well worth it.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your friendships? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

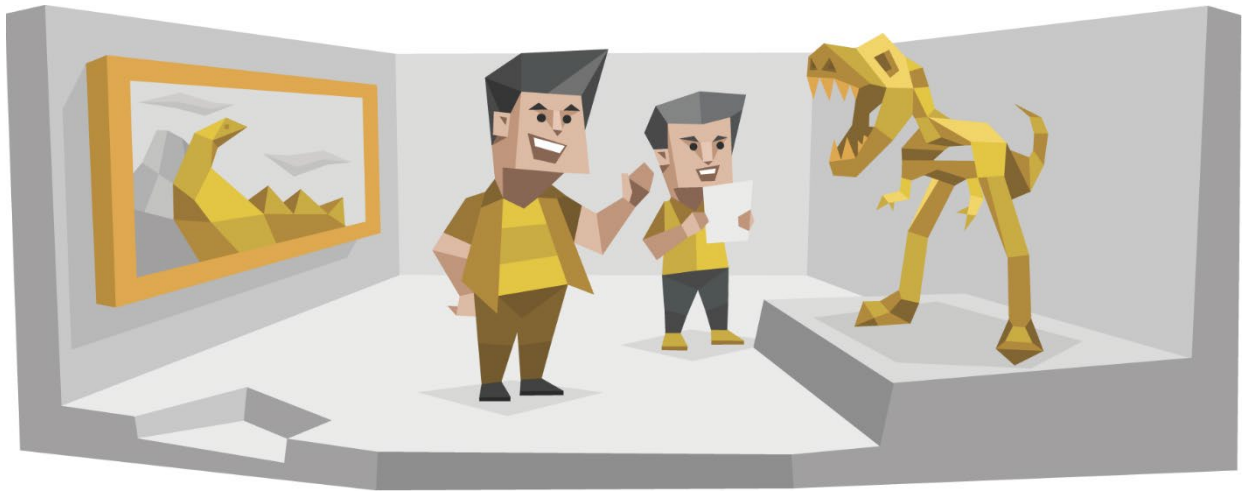
Type Guesser (Friendships)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your friend belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Personal Authenticity Test

Can you be your true self with your friends and family? Let's explore how you feel about your authenticity in those circumstances.

Parenthood



Relaxed and Fun-Loving

Entertainers are some of the most relaxed, fun-loving parents out there. They genuinely enjoy playing with their children and are constantly devising new and exciting ways to spend their time together. From the first moment they hold their babies, Entertainers are taken with the joy and wonder their children experience in everything around them, sharing and encouraging it as much as possible.

Exploration and experiences are key philosophies for Entertainer parents. When their children ask a question, these parents' answer is likely some variation of, "Let's find out!" Overbearing structures and tightly scheduled activities aren't a major part of their parenting style. They'd rather let things unfold day-by-day and let their kids explore life in their own way. This doesn't mean rules don't exist at all – Entertainers are also practical. Nonetheless, their parenting style reflects their approach to living.

People with this personality aren't the most demanding parents. But Entertainers are likely to provide plenty of emotional support. Due mostly to their warm affection and

innate practicality, they take on a nurturing and encouraging parenting style which can fill in many gaps left by their more casual approach.

Entertainers might happily build make-believe spaceships when their children declare themselves future astronauts – and then imaginatively use those declarations later when it's time to focus on schoolwork and goals. After all, successful astronauts must know their math!

Difficulty with Discipline

Discipline is far from Entertainers' strongest suit as parents. Nonetheless, they typically use hindsight and maturity to create standards that prevent their daughters and sons from suffering the same hurts and setbacks they themselves experienced. These parents don't typically instill many rules, but when they do, Entertainers are sensitive people and expect their children to respect and obey those put in place. Unsurprisingly, this can prove to be a point of contention during the teenage years.

Additionally, some Entertainers may be so interested in maintaining the image of "cool" parents that they fail to create or enforce rules for their children. Acting like friends rather than parents is a romantic concept, but the ramifications of this lack of structure and discipline can have long-term negative consequences.

Specifically, children raised in this dynamic are likely to feel entitled to the same treatment from other adults in their lives. Their teachers and friends' parents may react negatively to children who insist on being treated as equals. Entertainer parents who act as "friends" are also less likely to earn their children's respect, and it may be difficult to put down rules once they establish such a buddy relationship with their kids.

Providing Support and Structure

Although it may not come naturally, Entertainers must provide some structure, including discipline, for their children. Using what comes naturally to them – namely their sensitivity and excellent people skills – they can provide the support their kids need in warm and loving ways. Meanwhile, Entertainers can balance this by clearly communicating the rationale for the rules they enforce. This creates a blend of parental responsibility and the traits that make Entertainer parents unique. They need not become someone else to be good parents.

Discipline is a tricky topic for all parents, especially those who must feel “liked” by their kids, but children are more likely to appreciate their parents if they’re given a clear set of boundaries and expectations. Fun can be had. However, fun can be more rewarding for both parents and children within consistent and loving boundaries that make kids feel safe. While they often won’t admit it, kids need structure, and they naturally look to their parents for it – including fun-loving Entertainer parents.

Parent–Child Type Combinations

Using personality types to define children is an interesting proposition. While most see personality as something at least partly genetic and inherent, those influences may only lightly touch a child or only be softly apparent during childhood.

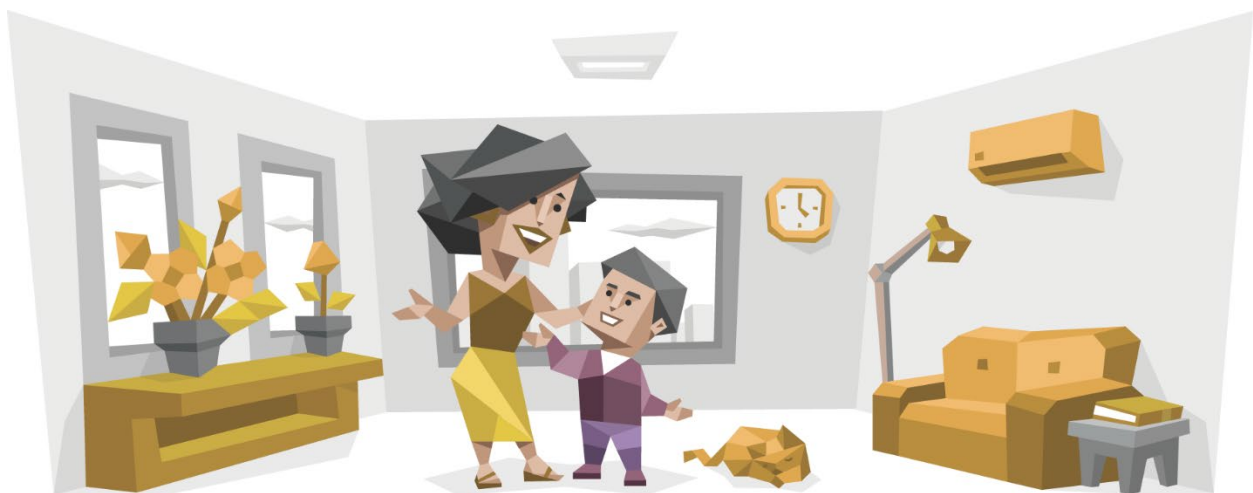
Childhood is about experimenting, learning, and adapting. This means their behavior is often exploratory rather than permanently defining. There may be hints of a personality type, but with so much adapting going on, it may be hard to pinpoint their consistent traits exactly. And since children aren’t self-aware enough to take a

personality test, they don't have the same advantages as adults who can answer questions describing their preferences.

Therefore, when we talk about the Analyst child, for example, we are referring mainly to children who demonstrate a preference for a rational approach, even if the preference is sporadic and uncertain. But we urge caution toward labeling children until they're older and can express their preferences themselves. The job of childhood is discovery. We advocate giving them a chance to explore on their own and in their own time without pigeonholing them in a personality cubby.

But for the sake of discussion, we describe things that Entertainers may want to take note of when parenting children who engage in certain trait behaviors. We do so without presuming these behaviors are either permanent or a temporary phase. We urge readers to do so as well.

Entertainer Parent and an Analyst Child



Curious and Open-Minded

Analyst-leaning children tend to be intellectual, curious, and imaginative. Their creativity and open-mindedness are likely to please their Entertainer parents, who may be intrigued by their sons' or daughters' willingness to explore the unknown and pleased by the similarity to their own penchant for improvisation.

Entertainers and Analysts share an interest in uncovering how things work, which is why these parents have few problems with communication or coming up with interesting activities. Analyst kids also tend to strongly focus on and pursue the things that catch their interest. Entertainer parents may delight in this common trait. It likely thrills them to see their children acting in similarly determined ways.

Practical Parent Versus Theoretical Child

The core engines that drive exploration and curiosity are different in Entertainers and Analysts. Entertainers usually enjoy exploring things simply because they present a challenge, choosing afterward to either move on to something more interesting or spend time honing their skills in that area. Like other Explorers, Entertainers focus on the tangible and the real. In contrast, Analysts primarily work from an intellectual perspective, trying to understand the hidden principles, systems, and patterns behind things, even when that offers few tangible benefits.

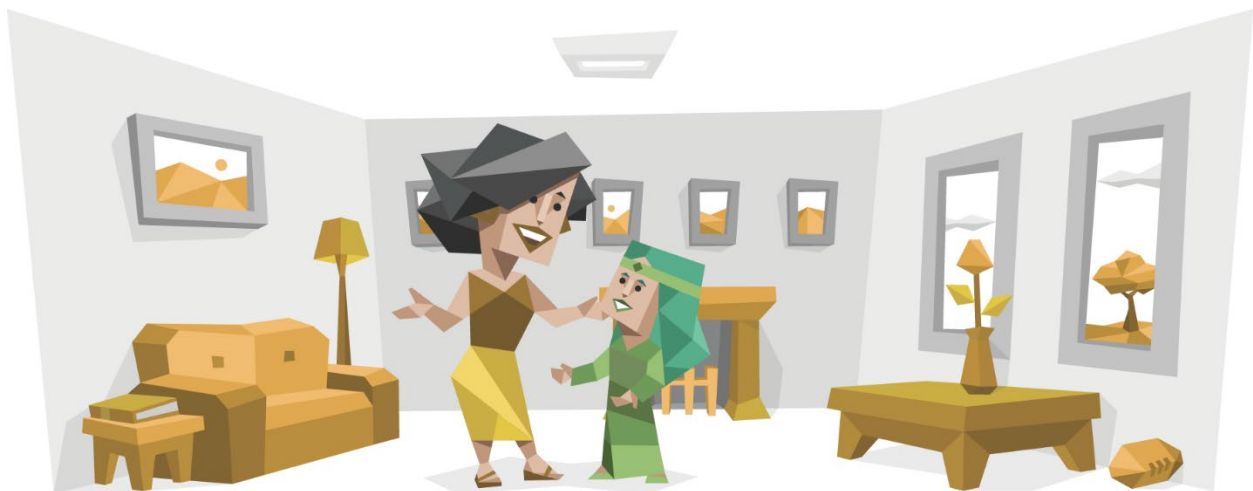
Analyst children may question their Entertainer parents' suggestions or conclusions simply because they're interested in connecting with their parents' thought process. It isn't necessarily because they don't trust them or that they doubt them. Such questions may frustrate some Entertainers, who are likely to see them as a waste of time. "Less thinking and more doing," might be their initial reaction. Entertainer

parents who offer statements like, “Because it works,” or “Because this is the best way,” aren’t likely to persuade their Analyst kids.

Finding Shared Interests

Analyst children tend to require minimal emotional support, which probably seems rather strange for kind, sensitive Entertainers. Analysts often hide and rationalize their feelings and, as Intuitive types, enjoy their own brand of being independent. Entertainer parents can appreciate their Analyst children’s need for independence and can be supportive of their desire for rational communication over emotional interaction, but problems can arise when there is a genuine need to discuss something of an emotional nature. Entertainer parents may need to find ways other than heartfelt conversations to bond with their Analyst children.

Entertainer Parent and a Diplomat Child



Inquisitive and Creative

Although they share some traits in common, Entertainers and Diplomats are also opposite in multiple ways. Both possess inquisitive natures. Both show a willingness

to explore. Both have an inborn desire for freedom and creativity. However, Entertainers also tend to have an excellent grasp of reality, an impressive arsenal of practical skills, and an uncanny ability to focus in the present moment. These aren't typically part of Diplomats' go-to characteristics and may not resonate with Diplomat children who tend to detach from the practical world.

Diplomat kids can typically find something to focus on, even without help from their families. Although this is likely to please Entertainer parents, they should monitor these activities to ensure their children have enough mental stimulation. Diplomats are idealistic and even somewhat poetic individuals, characteristics that may baffle Entertainers. As an example, Entertainer parents may simply see planting trees as a fun, physical exercise. Meanwhile, their Diplomat children may be fantasizing about what would happen if everyone in their city did the same.

Impulsive versus Idealistic

Diplomat children, like Entertainers, tend to value personal responsibility and the need to make their own decisions. But Entertainer parents should be careful to separate this from their own tendency to experiment and push limits. Diplomats typically seek to develop strong inner principles and to pick noble, often too idealistic goals and may respond better to arguments based on values and principles rather than rewards and practical benefits.

This aspect is likely to create any tension there may be between Entertainer parents and Diplomat children. Entertainers tend to be very selective in their interests and show little patience for things outside of a specific category. However, their Diplomat kids prefer to dive deeply in an attempt to uncover something fascinating about almost everything they encounter. Entertainer parents may need to at least feign

interest in their children's musings or find some way to channel their imagination into real-world experiences.

Accepting and Encouraging Differences

Entertainer parents should remember that their Diplomat daughters and sons require a different approach compared to what's natural for them. Further, they shouldn't attempt to "fix" their children's idealism or occasional naïveté. Entertainer parents should try instead to appreciate (and learn from) their children's enthusiasm, open-mindedness, and creativity. Diplomats' abilities are often underappreciated and rejected as offering little practical value. A little encouragement from their families can go a long way.

Such issues are even more important during the teenage years. Thankfully, Entertainers are nonconformists themselves and are, therefore, unlikely to criticize their teens' habits or push them to look for more conventional career paths. Instead, Entertainers are likely to encourage their Diplomat teenagers to pursue something that inspires and motivates them, and then help them along the way.

Entertainer Parent and a Sentinel Child



A Practical and Perceptive Pair

Entertainers share the Observant trait with their Sentinel-leaning children, so communication is relatively uncomplicated between these parents and children. Both types focus on practicality and facts. They prefer to leave theoretical and abstract conversations to Intuitive Analysts and Diplomats. Expectations tend to be straightforward, and Sentinel kids are likely to know exactly where they stand with their parents.

The Observant trait also effects how these types experience their environment. Both Entertainer parents and Sentinel children are perceptive and focus on what's happening around them in the moment. Most Entertainers notice even subtle changes in their children's behavior, allowing them to respond quickly and efficiently to prevent situations from escalating to unmanageable levels.

Not Enough Structure

Sentinel kids are likely to be obedient, trying hard to meet their parents' expectations. They respect family hierarchy and traditional roles, relying on their parents to set up a structured environment with well-defined rules. Sentinels don't like to discover what's acceptable through trial and error the way Entertainers do, and they prefer an up-front and clear understanding of what is and isn't okay. Entertainers rarely share their Sentinel sons' and daughters' orderly view of the world. But these parents typically appreciate their children's willingness to cooperate and to listen to them.

Additionally, Sentinel children seek a safe and stable atmosphere above all else. Spontaneity and fun are secondary to these needs. Entertainers should recognize these different priorities and remember that their Sentinel children are likely to be far more careful, traditional, and methodical in their exploration of the world. In certain situations, the somewhat *laissez-faire* parenting style some Entertainers embrace may not be ideal for these structure-seeking children.

Respecting the Need for Stability

Sentinel children need stability to build trusting relationships with their parents. They desire consistency and structure more than any other personality type, and they struggle with parents who don't provide this type of environment for them. Although they thrive on spontaneity and adventure, Entertainer parents must modify their behavior to best meet the needs of their children, especially in their early years. From keeping a consistent feeding schedule to creating a bedtime routine, Entertainers can establish the sense of security and dependability that their Sentinel children crave.

It's also important for Entertainers to respect their kids' aversion to risk-taking. Sentinels aren't a thrill-seeking type. They're less likely to be interested in riding a roller coaster or trying new foods. Although they certainly can benefit from moving outside of their comfort zone occasionally, it's important to do this slowly and with their approval. Breaking Sentinel children's trust is one of the most harmful mistakes these parents can make.

Entertainer parents may need to start gradually and be patient. Add new spices to food their Sentinel children already enjoy, rather than forcing them to try a completely foreign dish. Take them for a ride on the carousel, and then slowly introduce them to more intense rides. Entertainer parents who allow their Sentinel children to take their time trying new things are likely to discover them more trusting and willing partners in future adventures.

Entertainer Parent and an Explorer Child



An Adventurous and Independent Team

Naturally, Entertainer parents tend to find it easiest to communicate with their children if they belong to one of the Explorer types. Explorer children can be both adventurous and practical. They're often able to come up with exciting activities on their own if they're encouraged and given enough freedom to express themselves.

Their Explorer children's curiosity likely fascinates Entertainer parents. Even from a very young age, Explorer children are apt to feel in tune with the present moment and the world around them, finding enjoyment in things such as nature and sports, reflecting their parents' preferences. Outdoor activities are likely to form a large portion of Entertainer parents' repertoire.

Explorer children and Entertainer parents share the tendency to place a lot of importance on freedom and independence and often insist on being allowed to experiment and do things in their own way. Entertainers cherish seeing their curious, enthusiastic daughters and sons discover something new or exhaust themselves while spending hours on recently acquired hobbies.

Entertainer parents recognize their children's love of freedom. They may be reluctant to discipline them for overstepping boundaries in fear of suppressing what they feel might be the better parts of themselves that they see reflected in their kids. Such an improvisational and laid-back attitude can be a double-edged sword, though. Identifying deeply with their impulses, these parents may neglect to set firm enough limits for these children.

Missing the Bigger Picture

Tangentially, Entertainer parents may also have difficulties teaching their Explorer children to find time for introspection and personal development. All Explorers are far more interested in real, palpable matters than internal discussions or abstract ideas. They would far rather develop concrete skills with visible results. Both types of endeavor have value. But it's easy for Explorers to overlook the broader, far-reaching path of their lives when they always live in the moment.

Finally, as Entertainer parents focus more on improvisation and thinking on their feet, they tend to have difficulties with purely administrative and practical tasks. When unbalanced, this proclivity can lead to serious issues, especially in areas such as finance. Explorer kids are likely to share this weakness. Parents with this personality type should make conscious efforts to teach their Explorer children the importance of being economical, making fact-based decisions, and knowing how to combine that restless curiosity with more practical needs and responsibilities.

Considering the Future

It can be pleasant to live in the moment, but Entertainers do their Explorer children a disservice if they neglect to consider the future. Encouraging their Explorer sons and daughters to view life as a spontaneous adventure seems harmless enough, but when children lack direction or the ability to form a well-thought-out strategy, they can venture into some unsavory situations. Adults who accrue unmanageable debt or have continuous financial problems were often once children who didn't learn to plan well.

To prevent these potential long-term issues, Entertainer parents should be intentional about helping their children appreciate that their present actions affect

their future. Children of all ages (even adolescents) aren't always capable of understanding the potential consequences of their behaviors. It's up to their parents to guide them until they develop that ability, and Entertainers do well to remember that their job as parents includes preparing their children to be adults.

As impulsive individuals themselves, Entertainers may want to explore how their lack of planning or direction may have affected their lives. Anecdotes about rash decisions they made as children (*"I decided to try some beer at a friend's party my sophomore year in high school."*) and the negative outcomes that resulted from those decisions (*"I got really sick, and my parents grounded me for two months when they found out."*) can effectively illustrate the importance of considering future consequences.

Conclusion

Balancing their refreshing spontaneity and somewhat *laissez-faire* attitude with the responsibilities that come with parenthood can be a challenge for Entertainer parents. But if they master the right approach, they not only raise children who are capable and responsible, but there can also be an element of whimsy and adventure built in. It doesn't matter what personality type their children turn out to be. Smart discipline and the teaching of responsibility paired with Entertainers' unique personality style can help their daughters and sons experience the best of two worlds.

Responsible parents always adapt themselves, regardless of their own core inclinations, to raise their children compassionately and intelligently. If Entertainers see parenting as a skill to acquire and try to do so, they're likely to be marvelous, conscientious parents who open unique doors in sometimes unconventional ways.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your role as a parent? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Parenting Styles Test

Whether you have children already or hope to become a parent in the future, this test offers you useful insights into your parenting style.

Type Guesser (Parent)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your parent belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Type Guesser (Child)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your teenage child belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Academic Path



Entertainers are naturally curious individuals who love learning new skills, especially those with practical benefits. They see education as an opportunity to engage themselves in experiences that result in gained knowledge and talents applicable to their interests and activities. Rock-climbing enthusiasts, for example, may pursue a degree in geology to learn more about the formations they're often in such close contact with.

Whatever path they take in their lives, Entertainers benefit from embracing their education and looking for learning opportunities. Whether they're studying medieval history in the classroom or teaching themselves how to build websites in their own home, these types profit from expanding their minds and increasing their skills.

The following paragraphs discuss the best ways for Entertainers to learn throughout their educational careers, and effective ways to improve upon their learning habits. This chapter also discusses the struggles Entertainers may face in the academic environment.

How Entertainers Learn

Balanced Learning Habits

Hands-On and Spontaneous Experiences

Hands-on mastery is the learning process that interests Entertainers most. They learn best in loose and unstructured environments with loose and unstructured curricula emphasizing the experiential. Entertainers respond to high levels of personal involvement in their learning. They're usually restless in lecture hall settings – but, if they discover their niche, such as acting, for example, Entertainers can express their love of performing on a stage in an auditorium, a workshop, or even in a classroom.

Entertainers love to engage and perform in all ways, and they don't respond well to just sitting still and absorbing information. Give them something to do, and they participate. Allow them to express themselves in an amusing and compelling fashion, and they shine. But ask them to memorize and recall a historical timeline, and forget about it. They instantly lose interest.

These types also enjoy balanced coaching and feedback on their performances. Nobody likes criticism, but Entertainers are serious about mastering what interests them. They appreciate any observations that can help them do that. The optimal learning style for Entertainers is to see an instructor modeling a technique and then to perform the same technique immediately themselves. The ideal lesson is complete when they receive competent, constructive feedback on their performance.

Once Entertainers mature and gain mastery, they're likely to put their own spin on their work, but they understand they must first earn the privilege through instruction and practice. Once they gain a passion for something, they typically forego shortcuts. They would rather take the long route if it means someday executing their craft more skillfully – and that's usually the Entertainers' central educational goal.

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Struggling with Traditional Structure

Sentinels are highly represented among teachers and school administrators. Their influence on the academic world is perceived by many as an important contribution to society, and it arguably is. However, that doesn't prevent their approach from causing some real problems for students with different learning styles like Entertainers.

Even the most grounded young Entertainers can struggle in an overly-structured classroom. Unfortunately, many academic settings assume all students gain knowledge in the same manner, and with Sentinels making up most of the population, traditional lectures and drills often rule in the classroom. But not all students react well to old-fashioned educational methods, and Entertainers are typically among them.

Entertainers are, seemingly, the “anti-Sentinels,” but this doesn't necessarily mean they don't like Sentinels or are against them. Rather, it means they work in an almost opposite manner – their styles sometimes even clash. Sentinels are rules-based individuals who like to uphold tradition; they're orderly, think linearly, and favor the predictability of the conventional classroom. Entertainers aren't likely to learn much in such environments.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Finding a Niche

Parents and instructors who want to reach Entertainers and engage them in the learning process must help them find their niche and provide them with opportunities to be spontaneous. They must give them something to work on independently, and offer them some freedom to express themselves.

Because they constantly scan for something novel, Entertainer students respond to instruction that features fresh boldness and spontaneity. They also like to reach decisions or conclusions in their own time, based on what they realize. Once they make a discovery, they may not wait around for others before they implement it. If Entertainers find themselves interested in something, taking action is almost always more important than just thinking about it. Instructors may need to fold a measure of flexibility into their lesson plans to accommodate these students.

It's important to remember that Entertainers tend to take just so much spoon-feeding before they go off on their own. When teachers must give instructions, Entertainers usually respond well to multisensory learning involving media and computers in novel ways. They also enjoy working with others and need a wide range of activities rich in personal involvement. For Entertainers, an effective activity is something physical; an exercise on paper won't likely hold their attention.

Entertainers in High School

Anyone who attended high school need not watch even one of the thousands of films about teenage angst to understand that high school's yards and hallways hold as many lessons as the classrooms. It's hard to talk about secondary education without

discussing the social environment there. With this in mind, let's look at the blend of academic and social life that's likely to be Entertainers' high school experience.

Balanced High School Learning

Energetic and Sociable

Typically, Entertainers are popular among their classmates. They're fun and energetic, and they love drama and excitement. People with this personality type can be a bit gossipy, always broadcasting the latest social news – and in a highly entertaining fashion, at that. For high school students, what's not to like? Entertainers likely receive invitations to all the best parties and attend them just to see what's new.

In terms of learning, Entertainers at their best understand the necessity of attending classes and getting passing grades. They may struggle with traditional structure. But give them hands-on activities, such as building a birdhouse for shop class or participating in a model United Nations project for civics instead, and these lead to greater interest. Then, in turn, such interest inevitably leads to increased learning for these perceptive and practical students.

Extracurricular activities often pigeon-hole modern teens into stereotypical niches; for example, the popular kids sign up for cheerleading, and the nerds join AV Club, and so on. For Entertainers, a club or group may represent more of a structured environment than they typically want. However, their love of people and social interaction may overrule that tendency. They are likely to do well in social organizations, drama clubs, sports teams, and other groups where they can shine as performers.

Unbalanced High School Learning

Out-Of-Sync with the System

Entertainers often have a difficult time academically in high school. Their aversion to the structure of the average classroom might leave the impression they're troublemakers or even lacking in intelligence. Within the traditional system, it's easy to miss a genius of another type lurking below the surface in such students.

Unfortunately, too many teachers and parents don't understand this. They often view Entertainers as troublemakers out to steal the spotlight from the serious business of learning. When people with this personality type bring their expressive, spirited traits to an otherwise quiet and somber classroom, others may misinterpret the Entertainer persona as foolish. It would be a mistake to assume Entertainers are superficial and flighty, though. They notice everything that goes on around them and can be quite clever.

Handling educational differences is uncomplicated. Let other students memorize cold, hard facts or play with ideas, but make sure Entertainers have something practical and tangible to do. Point Entertainers toward music, drama, or other courses based on skill mastery and that offer expressive outlets. These often-capable students just need the right fuel to ignite their intellectual fires.

However, if left to struggle with traditional education, Entertainers are likely to earn poor grades. They may experience painful emotional and psychological distress as a result. The constant message Entertainers may receive from their school environment is that they're out of sync with everyone else. Being popular among their peers may not be enough to suppress the sense that they don't quite fit the mold, and this may damage their self-esteem.

Rebalancing High School Learning

Relating Learning to Personal Interests

Many places are cutting or reducing their arts programs to tighten their budgets, and these cuts can be disappointing for many reasons. They're especially painful for students who perform creatively. If available or reasonable, transferring to a high school specializing in the arts may be an appropriate option for some Entertainer students. They may feel more at home in such an environment, and they may finally receive a healthy dose of the affirming feedback that they sorely need.

There are also many accredited alternative schools that cater to students who feel out of place in traditional settings. They often allow students to create their own curriculum and explore their talents in their own way. These non-traditional schools could be great opportunities for Entertainers and might give these students opportunities not available elsewhere.

When they connect to an activity, skill, or artistic expression, Entertainers not only put in a great deal of effort to master it – they also often tolerate the passive lecture hall a little better. When Entertainer types can express themselves in ways true to their nature, they may find more patience for subjects that wouldn't normally fit their interests. They feel validated, making the traditional educational system easier to swallow and possibly even embrace as a necessary part of life.

Work or College?

While deciding whether to go to college involves many other reasons than personality types, they can have a role in the equation. Recently, most claimed college or university was the quickest path to success and security. Now, some of the

same voices argue against higher education for everyone. They've witnessed some famous college dropouts succeeding on a grand scale – Steve Jobs and Bill Gates quickly come to mind. College may not be considered as necessary as it once was.

There's a niche for everyone and college is just one path to finding it. It's easy to see action-oriented Entertainers chomping at the bit to get out into the world as quickly as possible and start producing. However, their need to master their craft can be as insistent as their need to act. Many Entertainers find sales or customer service fit their personalities well and neither demands a degree. However, some Entertainers need certification or concentrated training for the careers they choose, and, in those cases, higher education may be mandatory.

College would be unappealing to those Entertainers who imagine only lecture halls and books, but if they picture studios, workshops, and practice rooms instead, higher education may appeal to them. Although Entertainers could find apprenticeships in the non-academic world, college provides a “ready-made” opportunity to learn from others. Of course, this primarily depends on choosing the right major at the right college.

Entertainers in College

Balanced Approach to College

Free to Find Their Way

Entertainers who attend a college or university likely feel as though the opportunity has set them free. No longer bound by the rules of high school life, some Entertainers may find an educational model that fits their style of learning at last. Add the fact that

family and parents have less input into the decisions of this independent type, and college offers Entertainers a greater chance to be themselves.

Entertainers' college course choices are likely similar to the subjects they pursued as electives in high school. Any of the performing arts are probably a primary interest for many Entertainer students. However, they shouldn't feel limited to the arts. Courses that lead to activity-based professions that require social skills are also likely to be a nice fit for these students.

Mature Entertainers may want to resist pressure from parents and guidance counselors to choose majors and courses they struggled with in high school. If Entertainers didn't embrace more abstract, theoretical coursework in high school, the chances aren't any better for them doing so in college. Doing the same thing and expecting different results rarely works.

Unbalanced Approach to College

Too Focused on Enjoying the Moment

Some think the purpose of higher education is solely concerned with getting the tools to make a good living. Most Entertainers, however, reject this as the primary reason to get a degree. Convinced that their passion can always see them through, mastery and creativity are the primary motivators for typical Entertainers. They emphasize picking up skills they can use in the present. The future holds only a casual interest for them because they're too practical about the here and now to worry too much about tomorrow.

Like most young people, they delight in the autonomy college offers, and some students even choose their universities based on the school's distance from home.

Entertainers typically fit nicely into campus party life, and it may be a motive to attend college. Their thirst for novelty and outgoing nature may lead them to one sort of revelry followed closely by another. Some Entertainers must exercise caution, as this may become detrimental and result in their social life overshadowing their educational goals.

Rebalancing Their Approach to College

Learning to Deal with Difficulty

College is a time for Entertainers to consider and exploit their strengths and talents in real, concrete ways. Higher education provides students with an opportunity to customize their studies to match their interests more. Many Entertainers may have waited their whole lives for this.

However, life is rarely totally free of drudgery. Most colleges force students to take foundational, prerequisite courses many would rather not if given a choice. (Courses like “Introduction to Academic Writing” come to mind.) These classes often challenge Entertainers because they seem mundane to them. While some “test out” of these prerequisites, such foundational courses can offer tremendous benefits and may prove to be valuable, especially if Entertainers missed some basics in high school.

Learning to cope with dull or overly challenging classes is good disciplinary practice for Entertainers. It won't be the last time they run into necessary tasks they see as meaningless and boring. College can help Entertainers gain a degree of tolerance for that which is less than exciting and prepare them to approach the adult world in a more realistic manner.

Conclusion

In aiming for mastery and exploration that even the name “Entertainers” suggests, this personality type almost naturally embraces the role of lifelong learners in search of novelty and experiences. The initial trick in promoting learning for them won’t involve directly motivating them or pushing them to improve basic skills, hoping their interest ignites after the fact. The trick is to help them find an interactive discipline that grabs and inspires them up front. On discovering such an interest, Entertainers are likely to throw themselves into the process.

Typically, when they find their niche, they look for ways to increase their skill levels on their own. With that focus in place, they may even find education, in a broader sense, more appealing. Entertainers can help themselves gain footing in their learning by understanding how education and training best works for them. Nurturing and indulging their tendency toward curiosity can be beneficial as they search for their passions. Exploring with a purposeful emphasis on discovery can help start them on their educational and, ultimately, their professional paths.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your academic path? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Thirst for Knowledge Test

What is your interest in gaining knowledge? How does your desire for learning affect your life? This tool will help you explore that.

Academic Exploration Test

Do you ever wonder what areas of study might suit your personality? Find out which subjects might be the most satisfying for you.

Perfectionism Test

Perfectionism is a desire to be remarkable and outstanding in everything you do. Let's see what role it plays in your life.

Type Guesser (Academic)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your classmate belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Professional Development



Even though others commonly call Entertainers “party people,” their careers don’t always reflect this sentiment. People with this personality type tend to be independent and resourceful, and these traits help them tremendously on the career ladder. Having an overview can be helpful in making career decisions and establishing the best path, and this section will explore what empowers Entertainers to thrive in their vocations without their falling prey to common pitfalls.

Novelty and Excitement

The most important trait shared by all Entertainers is a pronounced desire for excitement, stimulation, and novelty. People with this personality type seek new challenges, take pleasure in socializing, and always focus on the present, and some of the best careers for Entertainers emphasize these qualities. They’re often among the most noted performers, photographers, event planners, and sales representatives.

Entertainers prefer working in more of a freeform manner. They loathe a strictly scheduled, structured, and monotonous grind. Meticulous data collection and

analysis, theoretical writing, or a nine-to-five administrative job are akin to torture for Entertainers, and careers that fit those descriptions even remotely are likely to be unsuitable for this personality type. Instead, the best jobs are those in which they might express their love for novelty, beauty, and fresh experiences. For example, Entertainers might prefer careers in fashion or interior design, tourism, and trip planning, to name a few.

People-Focused

People are of interest to Entertainers, and this personality type knows how to make others happy, even in difficult situations. They can also be very resourceful when their help is needed. Human contact is crucial for these types, and almost all Entertainers base their career paths on this need. They often channel this preference into becoming counselors, social workers, personal coaches, consultants, and professionals in similar fields.

Very Specific Qualifications

The key things to remember in terms of Entertainer careers are:

- They need a lot of contact with other people, more so than any other personality type.
- Their thirst for new challenges is unquenchable.
- They must feel that others appreciate their work.

Despite being bold and flexible, Entertainers may face unwanted challenges in their careers if they choose the wrong path. Not every job welcomes their improvisational skills and independent ways. People with this personality type tend not to cope well

when a workplace doesn't utilize their traits and talents, and it often boils down to picking a career that matches who they are.

Social and Exciting

Entertainers have a keen eye for detail and tend to give off a laid-back vibe. In addition, they typically are well-liked by their peers and excel in fields that reward social skills. People with this personality type aren't interested in building extensive systems or planning for contingency scenarios. They're largely unconcerned with security and stability. Mostly, they're interested in finding thrilling solutions or presenting engaging material that wins the admiration and gratitude of others.

Entertainers should focus on positioning themselves, so they're able to use their improvisation, influence, and problem-solving skills, while also retaining enough freedom to choose their own methods. This may be a challenging match for many employers. However, smart managers notice quickly that it's useful and productive to have Entertainers on board.

Practical and Efficient

Being practical is a noteworthy trait common among Entertainers. They're likely to be very down-to-earth individuals, with an ability to remain level-headed in even difficult situations. Instead of concentrating on theories and methods, which tend to prioritize plans and ideas above current events, Entertainers concentrate on the reality of the moment. They care little about superfluous information while they're making action-oriented decisions.

Entertainers should try to steer toward careers that reward practicality and efficiency. Perhaps even more importantly, they should look for roles within those

careers that emphasize concrete, factual, and active tasks, rather than abstract matters such as ideas, brainstorming, diplomacy, or planning.

Beyond the Here and Now

While it's a strength to operate from "the here and now," it may be a mistake to neglect developing skills and expanding knowledge if given a chance. Many organizations offer training programs or subscriptions to professional magazines. Since Entertainers absorb knowledge readily, especially when related to social skills like psychology, they should indulge their curiosity by taking employers up on such opportunities when they're available. There's always something to learn. Even if some information doesn't offer immediate benefits, the education may prove useful at some point.

Life is full of opportunities, and Entertainers have a major advantage over other personality types when it comes to mastering different techniques and leveraging them in unexpected circumstances. It may be helpful to keep in mind that no matter what Entertainers do, they're constantly gaining experience and perspective and then filing it away for some later practical application.

Regardless of whether they're employed or not, they might explore learning opportunities loosely connected to their main specialization. Plenty of subject areas utilize Entertainers' tactical thinking and risk management skills. Extending their interests can be an easy way to open new horizons while boosting self-confidence. Taking a skill-broadening class doesn't necessarily require formal admissions qualifications or prerequisites – nowadays, finding independent study material and programs is easier than ever.

If they have an opportunity, they may also want to try a hobby with income-generating potential. This approach is common among Entertainers, especially those already in stable and well-paid jobs that fail to meet their standards for excitement. Taking risks is almost second nature to them. The actual earnings from such hobbies may not matter to them initially, but the chance to do something that inspires and stimulates them may be worth it.

Independent Agents

Entertainers tend only to be satisfied with their career path when they feel confident they have enough freedom to do things their way. These individuals want others to see them as smart, artistic, and audacious. They feel restless if they're restrained by various rules or can't see the results of their work immediately. Unlike some other personality types, Entertainers always push themselves to the limits of their professional environment, regardless of the reward. They do it simply for the thrill of the chase.

Ultimately, everything depends on the flexibility of their place of employment. Few career paths are unsuitable for Entertainers, but there are plenty of positions that might under-utilize their primary skills. If they're in jobs that are incompatible with their personality and needs, the gnawing feeling of being in the wrong place is unlikely to pass. Entertainers aspire to be masters of their fate, utilizing all resources (including other people's skills and connections) to enable them to achieve specific goals.

Front-Line Leaders

Finally, Entertainers fare well in situations requiring they do unfamiliar work under time pressures, and they tend to feel comfortable deciding matters on-the-go and

taking risks where others would falter. As front-line soldiers, Entertainers have excellent leadership skills lurking beneath the surface. This trait can supercharge their careers if they're in the right places at the right time. Entertainers should keep their eyes open if the organizations they're working for are prone to experiencing unexpected turbulence occasionally.

Career Options for Entertainers



Balanced Career Options

This section looks at some specific jobs that Entertainers may find fit them best, but it isn't an attempt to provide a full list of professions. As the world welcomes new and different career options almost daily, it would be impossible to provide a comprehensive collection of job choices. The sampling below is a list of occupations compatible with Entertainer personality traits and added explanations. It can be used as a guideline by Entertainers thinking about their own career goals.

For those who are already employed, this may serve as a confirmation or an explanation for why they might be happy or unhappy in their current positions.

However, this section is in no way intended to be a firm prescription of what Entertainers must do to succeed or be happy.

Business and Sales

Entertainers hold many qualities that fit perfectly with many business careers. They're practical yet also willing to take risks. They're friendly, smooth, and persuasive. And Entertainers have a natural flair for storytelling, which makes "branding" come easily to them. People with this personality type also seek the new and innovative, which puts them on the cutting edge and is a strength in a competitive business field.

Overall, Entertainers work well with others and are popular, and this makes them excellent in commerce and business. As entrepreneurs, they're powerful networkers, a useful skill when building a business. Some possible business positions for Entertainers to consider are listed here.

- Insurance sales
- Investment banking
- Entrepreneur
- Personal money management
- Real estate
- Non-profit fundraising
- Strategic planning
- Sales of any kind
- Advertising and public relations
- Event management

Presentation

With their charisma and storytelling skills, Entertainers make outstanding spokespeople who can leverage their gifts to represent a brand. People with this personality type are master communicators. They embrace interesting and new ideas and can use them to capture the imagination of their audience, whether in an advertising pitch or a boardroom meeting.

Entertainers can be witty, inspirational, and quick on their feet. Even the most scripted presentation sometimes needs improvisation, and Entertainers are naturals at creating spontaneous material. The effective and the unique interest them more than anything traditional or expected, which helps Entertainer speakers who must prevent an audience from lapsing into boredom. Examples of some possible jobs are listed below.

- Actor
- Teacher
- Politician
- Public relations spokesperson or press agent
- Seminar facilitator
- Investigative reporter (broadcasting over publishing)
- Cleric (not too tradition-bound; missionary zeal over attachment to the liturgy)
- Lawyer
- Sales
- Motivational speaker

Practical Strategy and Coaching

To use an overworked phrase, Entertainers prefer “thinking outside of the box.” This makes them outstanding strategists. This trait can be useful in business; however, Entertainers often use it in a coaching sense. They can apply this skill by helping individuals or groups of people move forward, especially when they’re stuck.

When Entertainers combine their practicality with their love for shaking up the status quo, they can find unique ways to break bad habits and transform old patterns. Their genuine regard for others provides them with enthusiasm for this work. Here’s a partial list of jobs where such skills might come in handy.

- Social worker
- Life coach
- Behavioral therapist
- Consultant
- Sports coach
- Nutritionist
- School guidance counselor

Unbalanced Career Options

In today’s world, individuals not only spend a great deal of time at work, but they also tend to allow their work to give them meaning. Entertainers must be careful not to get stuck in job situations that don’t suit them, as they risk dealing with many difficulties when the roles they’ve chosen aren’t a good fit.

Working Alone

Entertainers aren't likely to be comfortable in cubicles doing solitary work unless it involves phone sales or other outreach. Even then, they yearn for more solid human interaction. Isolated in a cubicle, working with lifeless data or paperwork is deadly to Entertainers. They need people, and they're often the ones in the front of the room leading and encouraging their teams. Energy from other humans nearly defines them on the job.

Mundane and Repetitive

Entertainer types crave activities that involve novelty and spontaneity. Repetitive work of any kind loses their interest and fails to meet their expectations. Unless they can use their improvisational skills, Entertainers become bored, so a level of unpredictability in their job description is nearly required.

Restrictive Environments

If their workplace structure and rules are too rigid, Entertainers feel stifled and unfulfilled. They like to experiment and explore new ideas. They're problem-solvers and innovators. When Entertainers can't exercise those passions, they're unhappy and may even lose their edge. Furthermore, people with this personality type are risk-takers, which others may frown upon in an office with an emphasis on rules.

Alternative Options

Self-Employment

Many people find self-employment scary. However, the days when someone spent twenty years working at the same company with ensured employment are over. Job security belongs to the past, except in specialized fields like the military or medicine. Working for oneself may be a more secure and viable option, which also comes with the ability to plan one's time, see the tangible results of one's own work, and be one's own boss. Entertainers value freedom and self-reliance and being self-employed gives them an opportunity to enjoy these qualities at work.

Self-employment can side-step one of the major hurdles that Entertainers are likely to encounter in the corporate environment: forced compliance with numerous rules. As self-employed individuals, they may choose which tasks they want to perform and which they want to delegate or outsource. This self-determination can relieve them of any mundane administrative work. They can avoid following irrational orders they disagree with. Self-employment offers many major benefits to Entertainers, especially in today's global and always-connected environment. People with this personality are likely to succeed as their own bosses.

Entrepreneurship

Entertainers are likely to feel comfortable creating their own businesses. Building an enterprise presents a risk – a challenge Entertainers are typically eager to take. Plenty of “entrepreneurs” give up because they fear jumping into a pool full of what they perceive as sharks, but Entertainers embrace risk and treat any negative

consequences of taking them as just another challenge to meet. People with this personality type understand the life of the typical entrepreneur because they've been pursuing new and chancy things throughout their lives.

Without a suitable idea, however, no business can succeed. Entertainers who desire their own ventures must consider interesting ways to fulfill the existing needs of others (or create needs) and nail them better than their competitors. If they start with a strong concept, they're likely to manage the rest with ease.

Getting on the Career Ladder

Entertainers tend to be very adaptable. Even at school – often a source of frustration for many with this personality type – they're likely to improvise, experiment, and cope with daily challenges in ways that perplex and amaze others. Entertainers typically decide their actions on the spot and dislike planning and preparing for contingencies. Once they discover a niche that allows them the freedom to choose their preferred course of action or to manage and influence other people, though, Entertainers are unstoppable. The biggest challenge is in finding such opportunities.

Making Contact

Entertainers love socializing and networking. Their naturally social tendencies can enhance any job-hunting efforts, especially in tough job markets where their energy and outgoing nature can distinguish them from the herd. Entertainers typically possess a keen eye for detail, a solid grasp on reality, and the gift of persuasiveness. These skills can help them get their foot in the door.

Relating Outside Interests

Entertainers usually pursue many activities that they can add to their resumes or rely on during job interviews. Their hands-on approach is consistent in all that they do, so Entertainers likely have examples of activities that emphasize their skills and energy handy at all times.

Some activities that Entertainers who are entering the job market might use to enhance their applications could include volunteer work, community theater, competitions, local neighborhood initiatives, small businesses, or a web presence such as a blog or other relevant social media activity. Also, the more activities in their history, the more likely there is to be breathing space during interviews. Answering a question like, “Describe a situation where you’ve used your problem-solving skills,” is much easier if there are plenty of real-life experiences to refer to in the answer.

As an example, citing acting skills alone won’t be very useful if not accompanied by examples to share. Had they received accolades, like winning regional competitions, for instance, listing them on their CVs could be the deciding factor in landing the job. Interests and experiences enthusiastically pursued says a lot about a candidate. Since passionate endeavors are hallmarks of Entertainers’ lives, they’re likely to give them an edge in interviews.

Preparing for the Interview

Entertainers may find it easy to show their prospective employers they’re very dedicated, capable, and trustworthy. However, they may want to make sure they’ve covered all their bases before meeting with them. That probably won’t be their first impulse. They should put aside their tendency to “wing it” and, instead, carefully plan which aspects of their lives they wish to put in the spotlight. By making this extra

effort, they can present their skills in ways that thoroughly distinguish them from other candidates.

Entertainers may realize their strong social skills and enthusiasm consistently carry them through many situations. However, they shouldn't rely too heavily on these traits when interviewing for jobs. Being prepared is the key. Besides highlighting their experiences, it never hurts to prepare for common interview questions to avoid a surprise. Some interviewers find it easier to recite a standard list of uninspired questions, like, "What would you say is one of your weaknesses?" It would be a shame to lose opportunities because overconfident Entertainers hesitate too long on one of the basics.

Workplace Cooperation Between Types

It's useful to have something in common when working with someone else. Starting with a resounding "yes" rather than a stubborn "no" can make any conversation more productive. The next section covers pairings of type groups, including brief overviews of potential synergies and obstacles, and some tips that may help Entertainers navigate these sometimes-tricky waters.

Entertainer–Analyst Cooperation



Both Entertainers and Analysts enjoy the search for solutions, although their style and scope of doing so are different. If they recognize they're both seeking improved ways to accomplish goals, this commonality can make any discussions more productive. Should they grasp this concept early in their shared professional relationships and start to work together despite any differences in their approaches, they might realize that their motivations and objectives are fairly similar. Their desired outcomes may be more alike than is suggested at first glance.

Balanced Entertainer–Analyst Cooperation

Different Paths to the Same Goal

Entertainers focus on concrete, practical matters, while Analysts attend to overarching systems that favor the conceptual over the tangible. Analysts don't always see their ideas to the end. On the other hand, Entertainers often execute theirs swiftly – often failing to check in with others or get necessary permission. One is deliberative, but the other tends to be rash. For solving real-world problems, few

outperform Entertainers. For understanding a system, deconstructing it, or building it better on paper, nobody matches Analysts.

When Entertainers and Analysts work together and become better acquainted, they may learn to collaborate, each contributing to a two-step process. Analysts can create their systemic models. Entertainers can follow up by expertly assembling the real-time, concrete pieces that make Analysts' prototypes work. Each has high-quality things to stir into the pot and Entertainers and Analysts who understand this can create powerful working relationships.

Consider *Apollo 13*, the movie and real-life event that brought us the iconic phrase, "Houston, we have a problem." After a mechanical mishap, three U.S. astronauts had to operate a crippled spacecraft, even while knowing they were in danger of not making it back to Earth alive. In this comparison, the Analysts would be ground control in Houston. They calculated the numbers, ran analyses, and worked out a trajectory that could get the astronauts home.

Clearly, the astronauts represent Entertainers. They were the problem-solvers doing the hands-on work and manipulating the details that brought about the swing around the Moon and eventually brought the capsule home. Communication between ground control (Analysts) and the astronauts (Entertainers) proved vital to the successful rescue. This metaphor loosely demonstrates how different functions and styles can collaborate to fulfill the same goal.

Unbalanced Entertainer–Analyst Cooperation

Diverse Focus

Initially, Entertainers might feel as if Analysts ignore important details and focus instead on vague, impractical ideas and hypothesizing. It can be tempting for Entertainers to dismiss Analysts as having their heads in the clouds and not understanding the practical side of, well, anything. In return, Analysts might judge Entertainers as reckless or narrow-minded. With such assessments, communication and collaboration may grind to a halt.

Analysts can be condescending if they don't feel someone is able to skillfully play in their playground of lofty notions and complex systems, and they may wrongly react to the focus Entertainers place on the concrete. They might simply write their practical colleagues off as uninspired. Meanwhile, Entertainers are just as likely to ignore Analysts' "intellectual nonsense" as they move ahead and complete the work. The result of discounting each other's value is that they both quit communicating with each other. That's a pitfall these coworkers may wish to avoid.

Rebalancing Entertainer–Analyst Cooperation

Sharing New Perspectives

Analysts become bored with too many minute details, but it doesn't mean they have no use for them. However, they don't feel the need to line up all the facts or dig into the minutia as their Entertainer coworkers do to gain an overview.

It's important for Entertainers to understand this and then call upon their Analysts coworkers to give them feedback from their unique perspective. It may surprise them at how a bigger picture focus can help them define the tasks they're doing and

provide a richer, broader outlook. A new viewpoint might save them from going off course, especially if they habitually ignore their organizations' larger visions.

Entertainers may want to be careful and avoid dismissing Analysts and their theories too quickly. They should remember that, despite all their lofty ideas, Analysts want the same thing they do: the successful resolution of problems and challenges. Both are puzzle solvers, but each has a different technique. It may help communication if Entertainers learn to ask their Analyst coworkers more “why” questions.

Entertainer-Diplomat Cooperation



Entertainers, with their practical approach to life and problems, and Diplomats, with their more idealistic bent, seem likely to conflict with each other rather than cooperate. However, if, instead of thinking of these traits as opposing, they see them as complementary, there may be much potential for Entertainer-Diplomat cooperation. They quickly find common ground when they tap into each other's passion and desire to bring about improvement. Idealism guided by realism can have profound results.

Balanced Entertainer–Diplomat Cooperation

Sharing Common Ground

The common ground between Entertainers and Diplomats is somewhat intangible, but they share similar attitudes. Both enjoy a sense of moving forward. Entertainers and Diplomats also both want to bring about change and improvement.

For Entertainers, this means finding novel, interesting solutions to specific problems. They can look at a tangled mess of a situation and figure out how to make it work – often in unique and fascinating ways. Diplomats, however, take a broader view involving personal growth, moral development, and well-being. They often flip a fixed social idea and create a new perspective.

Despite their differences, both types respect flexibility; rules and traditions don't bind either type too tightly. Entertainers are much more practical and utilitarian compared to Diplomats' idealistic pursuits of values, but it's easy to imagine them sharing a common appreciation for innovation and change.

Combining Vision with Craft

If Intuitive types and Observant types are open to each other's differences, partnerships between the two can blossom. Diplomats, as Intuitive types, grasp, create, and transform broad ideas. Details can bore Diplomats while they fascinate Entertainers. Entertainers manipulate each little piece of life's puzzles and use them to create something concrete and better. For "visions," call on Diplomats. For realizing these visions in practical, innovative ways, call on Entertainers.

As an illustration, suppose a Diplomat realizes that an organization must create a greater sense of community and camaraderie. Communication is poor. The Diplomat

observes that interpersonal connections are almost non-existent among their clients and coworkers. An Entertainer might then step in to address this insight by creating an email newsletter, a phone chain, a podcast, monthly coffees, or lunchtime activities, for example. They would create a brand around the organization that says “community” and, in doing so, also create a team effort between the Diplomat and the Entertainer collaborators.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Diplomat Cooperation

A False Dichotomy

Established standards or rules bind neither Entertainers nor Diplomats as tightly as they might Sentinels. Nonetheless, Diplomats have unique codes by which they live. Their values – usually connected to their sense of empathy and compassion – are strong forces in their lives. Entertainers aren’t amoral as a rule, but values aren’t always as prominent in the ways they handle business.

For instance, Entertainers like people and are usually friendly, outgoing, and fun. However, occasionally, they may see solving a problem as more important than taking care of a colleague or addressing a client’s feelings or general satisfaction. They may also take risks, cut corners, or cavalierly develop plans that might have a negative impact on others. Entertainers sometimes trust their instincts a little too much, doing something on their own without taking other people’s opinions or standards into account. Such occasions might create conflicts between Entertainers and Diplomats.

The Doer and the Dreamer

Diplomats may see Entertainers as shallow, and Entertainers may regard Diplomats as impractical dreamers. Entertainers tend to live in the present while Diplomats live in the infinite time of imagination and thought. Diplomats are more likely concerned with long-range results while Entertainers show more interest in immediate actions and solutions.

Let's use a hospital metaphor here. Diplomats would be the case managers equipped to handle patients' long-term well-being and creating holistic treatment plans. Meanwhile, Entertainers are down in the emergency room doing triage and reattaching limbs. These two views, distinct interests, and styles can create communication issues; however, someone running a hospital wants both types around to save lives in the long- and short-term.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Diplomat Cooperation

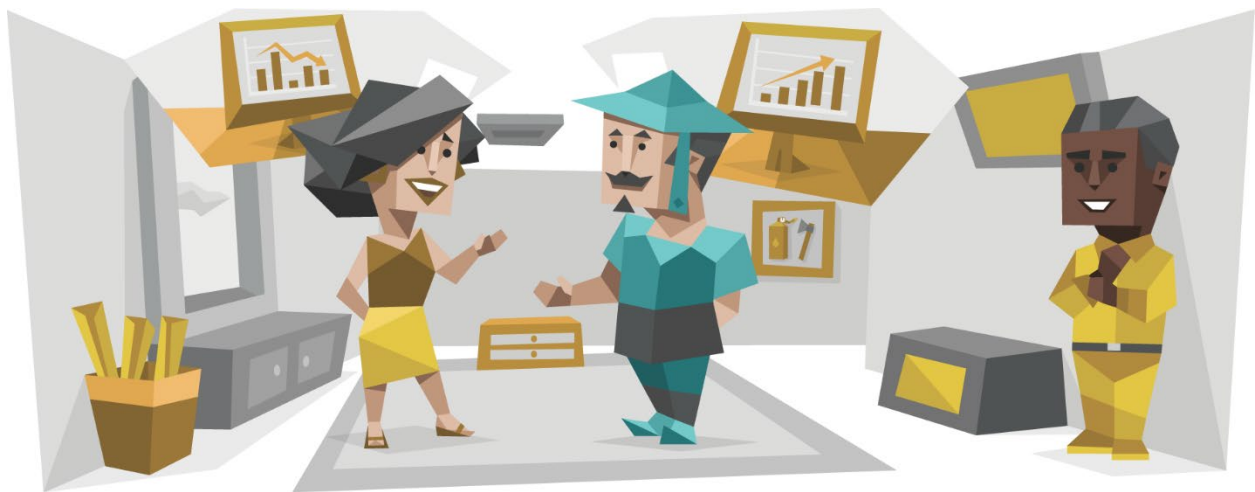
Discovering Motivations

If Entertainers want to discover what motivates Diplomats, they must learn about their values first. These coworkers are likely to extend their principles and ideals into their work lives as far as they reasonably can. The optimal way to communicate with them involves carefully limiting details or methods in the discussion. These things hold little interest for Diplomats, who prefer talking about broader ideas. To determine their common ground, Entertainers may want to begin with questions that start with, "What if?"

As with all pairings of distinct types, Entertainers and Diplomats work best together when they learn to appreciate their differences. There is an economy of personality

types which suggests that learning how to relate to different types can create complementary and beneficial relationships. Each type potentially rounds out all other types. For Entertainers, this may mean paying attention to Diplomats when they share their values and humanistic insights. These insights and perspectives can potentially help Entertainers should they let outcomes become more important than other people.

Entertainer-Sentinel Cooperation



It's easy to get the impression that Sentinels and Entertainers are opposites. They often approach things differently, but they aren't without commonalities. They both prefer to gather information directly from the world around them instead of filtering it through internal mechanisms – abstract theories hold little interest for either of them. Entertainers are more in touch with things that are spontaneously evident, whereas Sentinels usually judge their experiences through the lens of tradition and are sticklers for rules and structures that support that perspective. Explorers relish the exciting; Sentinels favor the stable.

Balanced Entertainer-Sentinel Cooperation

Coming to the Rescue

Entertainers and Sentinels most often complement each other when things go wrong. In this modern world, outdated approaches often stop working. This can be disconcerting to predictability-loving Sentinels, but a compelling situation for Entertainers. They quickly embrace change and adapt to it speedily, and they can lend support to Sentinels as they adjust more slowly to the onslaught of progress.

Entertainers possess an impulsive drive to act and can easily veer off-track when they “wing it” in search of new experiences and solutions. Sometimes, the best answer when a situation goes awry is to retreat to a known starting place. Sentinels like to spend their time in those places. They can help Entertainers “come home” when they’ve gone astray, figuratively speaking. Sentinels usually know how to repair a situation, or they know someone who does. This can come in handy when Entertainer colleagues wander too far off in the wrong direction.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Sentinel Cooperation

Clashing Styles

Certain things about Entertainers can drive Sentinels crazy. Entertainers usually go with the flow and don’t allow others to bother them very much, so the dynamic is different for them. Sentinels, however, may find their problems with headstrong Entertainers fiercely disturbing.

Entertainers have no problem cutting corners when necessary, but Sentinels usually dedicate their lives to guaranteeing those corners remain intact – as they’ve always been. Sentinels prefer things to be orderly and predictable, whereas Entertainers

have a freer attitude and love everything new and interesting. These differences can trigger tension and disagreement.

As a non-work-related example of their different approaches, Sentinels might prefer a favorite restaurant they go to regularly, but Entertainers are more likely to sample all the latest dining experiences available in town. At work, Entertainers can seem reckless and unruly to their Sentinel coworkers. In turn, they might perceive their Sentinels colleagues as boring and bland. These opinions of each other are usually more reactionary stereotypes than accurate assessments, but such impressions can hinder trust and open communication.

Varied Regard for the Status Quo

Keeping the status quo strongly in place is essential to Sentinels, but their Entertainer coworkers have little problem disregarding “how it’s always been done” and doing whatever they deem necessary to solve a problem, no matter how unconventional. For Sentinels, the tried-and-true leads to a stable, predictable end. Entertainers only want a successful outcome, and they aren’t always picky about the means they take to get there.

Sentinels may view Entertainers as being at cross purposes with them. They may devote a massive amount of time trying to persuade Entertainers to walk in a straight, rules-based line. Meanwhile, Entertainers often ignore these Sentinels and do whatever they feel they must do, whether that’s walking in a straight line, a serpentine line, or any other direction that helps them master a situation. The possibilities for conflicts between the two are nearly endless.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Sentinel Cooperation

The Value of Protocols

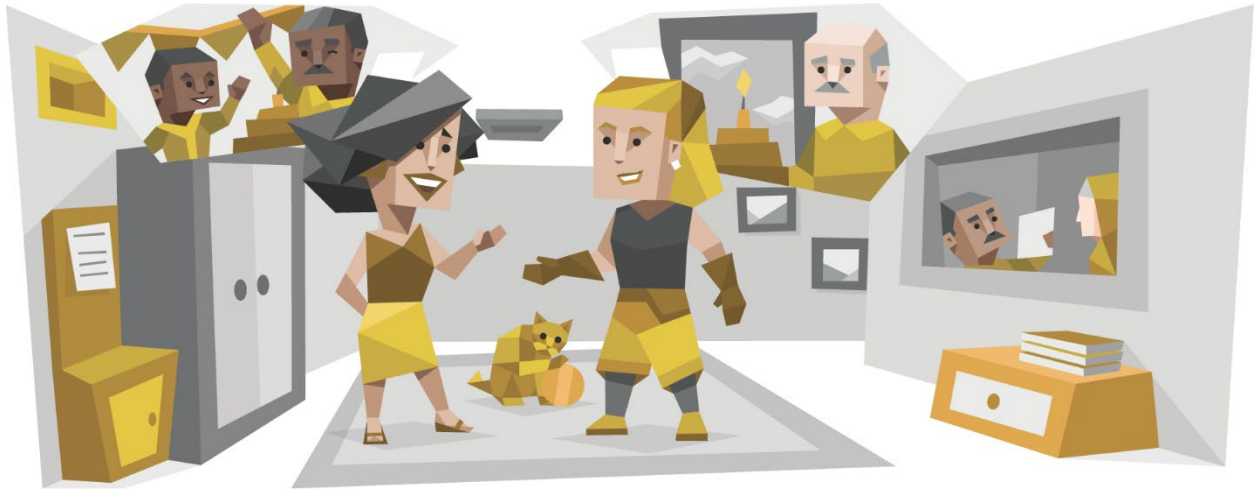
Poet and philosopher George Santayana wrote, “Those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it.” Entertainers might be too quick to dismiss Sentinels’ attachment to the past and settled protocols, as much can be learned from their adherence to tradition and set standards. Entertainers shouldn’t be afraid to ask why they should do something in a particular fashion. Meanwhile, Sentinels may want to avoid answering and justifying an act or decision by saying anything that resembles, “Because we’ve always done it that way.”

Mutual Learning

For Entertainers, accepting Sentinels’ counsel may help avoid problems. Entertainers may feel Sentinels somehow limit their options. It may even be true, but it’s unlikely that Entertainers will permanently lose their spontaneity and edgy creativity if they play by the rules occasionally. Relying on their Sentinel coworkers’ sensitivities to the rules and standards may help them stay around in a job to create another day.

When their counsel proves to be sound, Entertainers should take a moment to acknowledge their Sentinel friends. Sentinels may never ask for it, but they’re always happy when someone shows appreciation. Doing so may be a way to create stronger work relationships between Entertainers and Sentinels.

Entertainer-Explorer Cooperation



Entertainers and their fellow Explorers typically find themselves “speaking the same language.” Theoretical and conceptual problems, which thrill Analysts, are annoying to both. Conversations about solving problems or mastering skills or situations are of greater interest. People with these personality types gain boldness and further motivation from acting, and there’s likely a lot of energy around Entertainer and Explorer colleagues. People with these personality types relish conversations that reveal how they overcame a problem and saved the day.

Balanced Entertainer-Explorer Cooperation

Whatever Gets the Job Done

When working together, Entertainers and other Explorer types want to discover the best way to do the job, and they may bypass rules, standards, or traditions that hinder their focus and strategies. Because of this spontaneity and independence, others often view them as risk takers.

Together, Entertainer and Explorer colleagues may enjoy discussing the new and the different if these discussions focus on tangible matters. They're unlikely to stray into the arena of abstract theories. They might appreciate talking about the capabilities of the new iPhone but show less interest in a discussion of "the sociological impact of constant digital communications worldwide," for example. They might share a sense of satisfaction if they figure out a unique use for the phone, dismissing discussion of its global implications as "just talk."

Practical Innovation

Entertainers and Explorers brought together as a team are likely to become a brainstorming powerhouse. They'd resolve problems, innovate, and add to their company's growth – but only as it affects practical methods. The harnessed energy of Entertainers and other Explorers who bounce ideas off each other would be an asset to any organization. Entertainer and Explorer coworkers are likely to make their joint discoveries on the run and are more likely to do it by applying their hands to the problem rather than drawing out diagrams and steps on a whiteboard.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Explorer Cooperation

When Entertainers and other Explorer types talk to each other, they have no trouble finding common ground and mutual understanding. As a result, though, they may become stuck in their thinking style and lose the benefit of insight from those who think differently. In business and life, it's good to have varied personality types around to give balance.

But at What Cost?

On the off-chance work becomes too “Explorer-heavy,” there are several factors that can be problematic. To illustrate this, consider Grace Hopper, the late computer scientist and United States Navy Rear Admiral who famously said, “It’s much easier to apologize than to get permission.” Entertainers and other Explorers often take this quote to heart and then end up in hot water as a result. Their willingness to take risks and follow different paths to find unique solutions can be an asset in the workplace; however, this risk-taking tendency shouldn’t go unchecked.

The often-complex relationship of Entertainers and their fellow Explorers with their coworkers may need tempering. While they typically enjoy other people, they often put practical solutions ahead of the feelings and concerns of others, often coming across as having a brusque disregard for their coworkers. It’s not that they don’t like their colleagues, but they do tend to place people below solutions on their list of priorities. “It can’t be helped” would be the excuse shared between an Entertainer and his Explorer accomplice – if they even discussed such matters.

Solutions with a Small Perspective

Entertainers and Explorers might also find their actions don’t align with the larger vision of an organization. Because both types are detail-oriented and think in the present, they may disregard the big sky view of a company’s overall objectives and focus. Just as it takes only one degree of a compass to send a ship hundreds of miles off course, a small, misguided solution can disrupt a company’s larger goals.

The immediacy of the Explorer mindset can potentially create the kind of tunnel vision that ignores greater matters if not adjusted for and kept in check. Even if other

Explorers think Entertainers are offering reasonable solutions, their supervisors may believe they're thumbing their noses at the vision and values of their company.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Explorer Cooperation

Appreciate Commonalities

When Entertainers and Explorers work together, they may want to take advantage of their camaraderie and enjoy their time together by brainstorming new and better ways of doing things. Entertainer and Explorer coworkers likely already enjoy simply spending time talking to each other, but the experience goes up a notch if they find something to tinker with while they're chatting.

Getting a Second Opinion

When two types are so similar and comfortable with each other's great ideas, a second opinion from someone with a more "mainstream" perspective might be useful. Every personality type can benefit from the balance provided by other types. Even Entertainers and their Explorer teammates can grow as individuals and as colleagues when they expand their comfort zones by exploring different approaches.

Asking "Why?"

Entertainers and Explorers who work together may find that they're quite comfortable exploring the "how" questions involved in finding a solution. To rebalance their efforts and keep the relationship beneficial, learning to ask "why" may be just as essential. This may again require a second opinion from someone who's more in touch with the bigger picture.

Conclusion

Entertainers need to exercise their independence and must feel autonomous. This is essential to their happiness and motivates them to produce and succeed. If a job presents only overstructured conformity that demands unskilled behaviors, Entertainers won't be able to access that part of themselves that responds in healthy ways to challenges.

To thrive in a job, Entertainers must find a niche of their own. Most are good at this, having practiced it while dealing with school systems focused on more conventional things than they, as young people, could relate to. While not always good at commitment in any traditional sense, once they find their niche, they're usually all in for the duration. This allows them to become highly skilled and often specialized – making them valued workers and professionals in many fields.

Additional Tools and Tests

Want to dig even deeper into your professional development? If you have access to the toolkits area of the website, we offer a variety of additional tools and tests to help you explore.

Job Preferences Test

Among the most important things you decide in life is how you're going to make a living. Discover which job fields fit you best.

Job Burnout Test

We've all heard the term "burnout." But what does it mean to you? This test will guide you as you take a look at how burnout affects you.

Career Values Test

What should your job look like for you to call it "ideal"? What aspects matter most to you? This tool will help you answer these questions.

Leadership Styles Test

What is your leadership style? There is no right or wrong answer to that question. This test will help clarify your preferred approach.

Leadership Styles II Test

The second part of our Leadership Styles test will explore your desire to be a leader and willingness to delegate power.

Motivation Test

On average, we work for about 90,000 hours over our lifetime. With that in mind, it's helpful to figure out exactly what motivates you.

Ambition Test

How eager are you to succeed, and at what cost? Ambition can be a double-edged sword – explore how it works in your case.

Professional Authenticity Test

When at work, are you acting in a way that is consistent with your true self? Explore difficult questions about authenticity with this test.

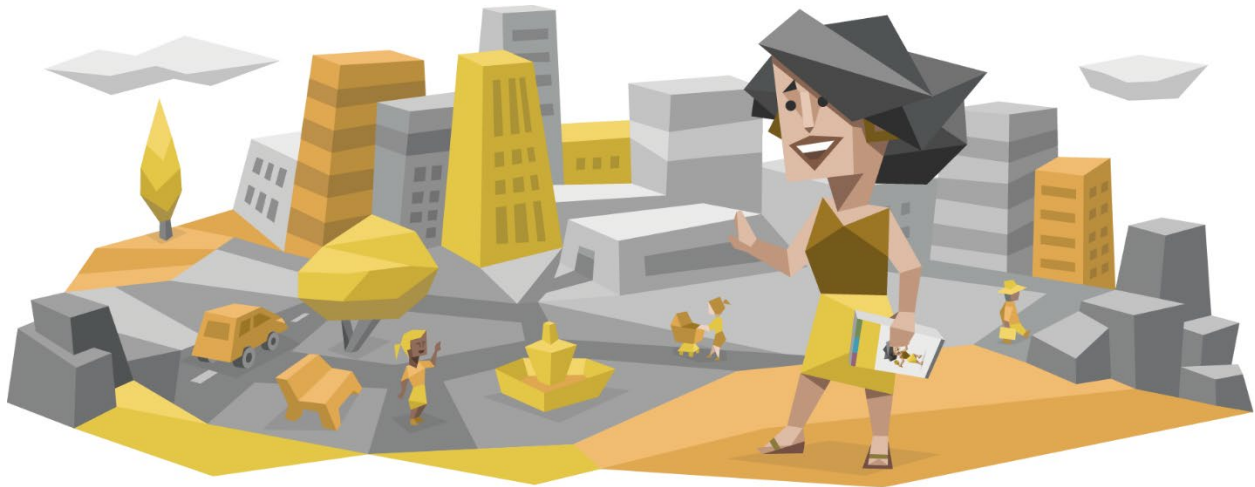
Goal Orientation Test

What's the underlying motivation you feel when confronting a challenge? See which of the Goal Orientations influences you most.

Type Guesser (Workplace)

Are you trying to figure out what personality type your coworker belongs to? You may find that this simple tool helps.

Final Words



If, as Shakespeare contended, “All the world’s a stage,” then Entertainers are surely at home on the planet. These high-energy individuals are always “on,” and their parties never wind down. They live for the moment, and their presence can make even the stalest of get-togethers feel fresh. Cataloging their signature qualities, it’s easy to paint Entertainers as frivolous, flighty, and even irresponsible beings – but who would resist their idea that life is better when it includes a measure of lightheartedness? Entertainers genuinely cherish people and have exceptional social skills. In simple words, they offer joy and beauty while promoting tender feelings.

But then there’s the inevitable flipside of the coin – the more mundane side – which Entertainers often neglect. The above catalog of characteristics isn’t necessarily wrong. Entertainers *can be* frivolous, flighty, and irresponsible. Offsetting the joy they bring against meeting their obligations is a challenge they wrestle with constantly. In addition, they aren’t known for having strong boundaries that keep them out of trouble. Meeting their obligations and being responsible without losing their unique qualities is the balance Entertainers most likely must attain if they are to grow.

What's Next?

We've covered many different topics in this profile, and we hope that the chapters have offered insight and answered questions about the Entertainer personality type. We hope that readers will now find it easier to understand other people and their perspectives. This profile isn't meant to be read just once. When trying to understand another person better, or struggling to understand oneself, another read-through can offer fresh insight.

Furthermore, spend some time on our [website](#) – for example, by exploring our [articles](#) or [additional assessments](#). If you lead a team, our [Team Assessments](#) can help you understand its unique dynamics. There is a wealth of inspiring advice and information on the website, and we strongly recommend that you take a look. If you have some spare time, consider lending us a helping hand by taking additional [surveys](#) or simply [sending us a message](#) and sharing your thoughts about this profile or the website in general. We would love to hear from you.

We wish the best of luck to all Entertainers. What matters most in Entertainers' lives is that their paths through life reflect who they are, deep within. Reflecting on values, dreams, and ideals often reveals the right path through life by clearing out superficial distractions. Our lives are often too full of troubles, conflicts, and worries. By working to better understand each other, we can make our relationships, communities, and world more aware, more genuine, and more peaceful.

Until next time.

Addendum: The Puzzle of Personality

Often the very first question people ask after completing our personality test is “What do these letters mean?” We are of course referring to those mysterious acronyms like INTJ-A, ENFP-T, or ESTJ-A. As you may have already learned from the Type Descriptions or articles on the website, the five letters of these acronyms each refer to a specific trait, with certain trait combinations forming various types and type groups. But before we discuss those traits in depth, let’s explore their historical foundations.

The Historical Detour

Since the dawn of time, humans have drawn up schematics to describe and categorize our personalities. From the four temperaments of the ancient civilizations to the latest advances in psychology, we have been driven to fit the variables and complexities of human personality into well-defined models. Although we are still some time away from being able to do that, the current models account for our most important personality traits and can predict our behavior with a high degree of accuracy.

Personality is just one of many factors that guide our behavior, however. Our actions are also influenced by our environment, our experiences, and our individual goals. On our website, we describe how people belonging to a specific personality type are likely to behave. We outline indicators and tendencies, however, not definitive guidelines or answers. Significant differences can exist even among people who share a personality type. The information on this website is meant to inspire personal

growth and an improved understanding of yourself and your relationships – not to be taken as gospel.

Our approach has its roots in two different philosophies. One dates back to early 20th century and was the brainchild of Carl Gustav Jung, the father of analytical psychology. Jung's theory of psychological types is perhaps the most influential creation in personality typology, and it has inspired a number of different theories. One of Jung's key contributions was the development of the concept of Introversion and Extraversion – he theorized that each of us falls into one of these two categories, either focusing on the internal world (Introvert) or the outside world (Extravert). Besides Introversion and Extraversion, Jung coined the concept of so-called cognitive functions, separated into Judging or Perceiving categories. According to Jung, each person prefers one of these cognitive functions and may most naturally rely on it in everyday situations.

In the 1920s, Jung's theory was noticed by Katharine Cook Briggs, who later co-authored a personality indicator still used today, the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator® (MBTI®). Briggs was a teacher with an avid interest in personality typing, having developed her own type theory before learning of Jung's writings. Together with her daughter, Isabel Briggs Myers, they developed a convenient way to describe the order of each person's Jungian preferences – this is how four-letter acronyms were born.

Of course, this is just a very simplified description of the Myers-Briggs theory. Readers interested in learning more should read *Gifts Differing: Understanding Personality Type* by Isabel Briggs Myers. As we define personality traits and types differently in our model, we will not go deeper into Jungian concepts or related theories in this article.

Due to its simplicity and ease of use, the four-letter naming model has been embraced by a number of diverse theories and approaches over the last few decades, including frameworks such as Socionics, Keirsey Temperament Sorter, Linda Berens' Interaction Styles, and many others. While the acronyms used by these theories may be identical or very similar, however, their meanings do not always overlap. One of the reasons behind such a lengthy introduction is that we want to make it clear that there is no single definition assigned to these type acronyms – each theory defines them in their own way and it is entirely possible that if you meet five people who all say “I am an INFJ”, their definitions of what INFJ means are going to differ.

Types vs. Traits

Regardless of its structure, any type-based theory will struggle to describe or characterize people whose scores lie near the dividing line. A different way to look at personalities is through the lens of a trait-based rather than a type-based model. What do we mean by that? Instead of creating an arbitrary number of categories and attempting to fit people within them, a trait-based model simply studies the degree to which people exhibit certain traits.

You may have heard the term Ambivert, which is a perfect example in this case. Ambiversion means that someone falls in the middle of the Introversion-Extraversion scale, being neither too outgoing nor too withdrawn. Trait-based theories would simply say that an Ambivert is moderately Extraverted or moderately Introverted and leave it at that, without assigning a personality type.

A trait-based approach makes it easier to reliably measure correlations between personality traits and other characteristics – for example, political attitudes. This is why trait-based approaches dominate psychometric research, but that's more or less

the only area where these approaches are dominant. Because they don't offer types or categorizations, trait-based theories don't translate as well as type-based theories into specific recommendations and takeaways. Assigned categories such as Extravert or Introvert may be limiting, but they allow us to conceptualize human personality and create theories about why we do what we do – something that a more scientifically reliable but colorless statement, such as you are 37% Extraverted, simply cannot do.

Our Approach

With our NERIS® model, we've combined the best of both worlds. We use the acronym format introduced by Myers-Briggs for its simplicity and convenience, with an extra letter to accommodate five rather than four scales. However, unlike Myers-Briggs or other theories based on the Jungian model, we have not incorporated Jungian concepts such as cognitive functions, or their prioritization. Jungian concepts are very difficult to measure and validate scientifically, so we've instead chosen to rework and rebalance the dimensions of personality called the Big Five personality traits, a model that dominates modern psychological and social research.

Our personality types are based on five independent spectrums, with all letters in the type code (e.g. INFJ-A) referring to one of the two sides of the corresponding spectrum. You can see where you fall on each scale by completing our free personality assessment, NERIS Type Explorer®. This approach has allowed us to achieve high test accuracy while also retaining the ability to define and describe distinct personality types.

Five Personality Aspects

This section will describe five personality aspects that, when combined, define the personality type: Energy, Mind, Nature, Tactics and Identity. Each of these aspects should be seen as a two-sided continuum, with the “neutral” option placed in the middle. The percentages you would have seen after completing the test are meant to show which categories you fall under, and how strong your preferences are.

Let us now go through the personality aspects one by one:

Introverted vs. Extraverted

More Than People Power

When considering people who are Introverts (I) and Extraverts (E), it's natural to go straight to the more social aspects of these personality traits. However, they are more than this. These traits are also defined by their broader response to their environments, which includes other people but isn't exclusively about them.

Introvert (I) Personality

Strength in Reserve

Introverts are well-suited to many situations. A tendency to be reserved helps these personality types to pace themselves. They're likely to listen to others more carefully. Very introspective, Introverts enjoy more focused “alone time” – leading to more and deeper insights. And, while sometimes too sensitive to their environments, this often helps them pick up cues more quickly, making them great at reading many situations.

However, this same reserve means that Introverts tend to find outside stimuli like noise, motion, or intrusive lighting frustrating. Some of this can be an invigorating change of pace – too much unsettles them and drains their energy. These personality types often prefer to be in their own space where they can adjust their environments. Add a human factor to this sensitivity – for example, insistent conversations where they're expected to be just as insistent – and it can exhaust them. They need time alone to regather their energy and restore their calm.

Introverts' reserved, more solitary nature presents challenges, as many societies favor Extraverts and their bolder approach. But it helps Introverted personality types to take things slowly, cautiously, and with less fanfare. Fortunately, if they're willing – and create the time to recharge on their own – most Introverts can handle society's strenuous demands.

In fact, many successful leaders and entertainers come from their ranks, often remaining humble and avoiding an unnecessary spotlight in fame. The Introversion personality trait never needs to disqualify those who possess it from pursuing a goal.

Extravert (E) Personality

The Power of Engagement

Extraverts are interested in engaging with their environment, and they feed off the responses of the people and events around them. They enjoy pushing limits and seeing what the world can do. This all depends on many other factors and life's natural limitations, but Extraverted personality types lean toward taking the initiative and relying on the world around them for validation.

While all of this is noble and often admired in society, it can also become unbridled. Extraverts may put too much value in their engagement with those around them. Being with others can be so important to these personalities that they often find it difficult if they're stuck alone. Boredom comes too easily. This can lead them to do things simply for excitement rather than thinking through more subtle but important considerations. Becoming the center of attention – at any cost – might be too appealing.

However, when they suitably address these challenges, Extraverts are forces to be reckoned with. People with this personality trait tend to advance projects important to them quickly, whether personal or professional. They often choose to lead when given a chance – and can be dynamic in that role. Their outgoing energy can be vital to a social gathering, and their liveliness can be contagious. And there always remains a sense that people are important to them.

Intuitive vs. Observant

Thought at Every Scale

Our second personality scale includes the Intuitive (N) and Observant (S) styles. These traits describe what people are more likely to do with the information gathered from the world around them. Intuitive personality types rely on imagining the past and future potential of what they see. Those with the Observant style are more interested in observable facts and more straightforward outcomes. They prefer to avoid layering too much interpretation on what they see.

Being Intuitive doesn't mean someone can't be practical, and being Observant doesn't mean a lack of imagination. They both use their minds and their physical

senses well. The difference is the spin they put on their experiences – it's where their thinking goes after an encounter with their environment. If Intuitive personality types appreciate Observant types' practicality, and Observant personality types appreciate Intuitive types' imaginative perspective, they can complement each other in ways that make for unbeatable partnerships.

Intuitive (N) Personality

Eyes on the Horizon

People with the Intuitive trait prefer to exercise their imaginations as they seek new ideas and possibilities. They live their day-to-day lives just like any other personality type. But while that's happening, their minds tend to point inward while at the same time gently focusing somewhere beyond the horizon. Their lives are ones of questioning, wondering, and connecting the dots in the "bigger picture," and they love the theoretical. They often ask, "What if?" and ponder the possibilities the future might hold.

But Intuitive people aren't always the most practical, preferring instead to give things deeper meaning. There may be a long wait as these personality types allow their imaginations free rein. They may also leap in too quickly to more complex matters. An entire theory can come together in moments, leaving others confused. In either case, they can appear out of touch to the Observant individuals in their lives. For some Intuitive folk, there may be some truth to this observation.

That said, when there's a need for innovation or a different perspective, people with Intuitive personality types can usually step up and provide a new direction. Practicality can sometimes be overrated, especially when a situation calls for serious change and "coloring outside the lines." This is where Intuitive people shine. They

bring interesting dimensions to life beyond everyday ideas – and take those who decide to go along with them.

Observant (S) Personality

Do What Works

The phrase “real-time” was created with Observant individuals in mind. They’re most in touch with what occurs in front of them, in the present. This doesn’t mean Observant personality types have no regard for the past and future. But they view both from the perspective of how each influences their present actions. This makes them focused and practical people. They mostly root their thinking in the actionable, tangible, and useful. But make no mistake, these personalities can be creative within that realm.

One challenge people with the Observant personality trait may face is a too-narrow perspective. They may reject far-reaching solutions in favor of something more obvious. By continuing something that appears practical at arm’s length but doesn’t fit the bigger picture, they might reduce their hard work to busywork.

People with the Observant trait are often a steadying force that tends to get things done. Their energy is very “hands-on” in the sense of working on real things in real-time. While they’re often smart people, spending a lot of time sitting around and pondering possibilities doesn’t cut it for Observant personality types. They want thoughts and talk to lead to action.

Thinking vs. Feeling

How to Think and Feel About the Thinking and Feeling Traits

Our third, Nature scale reveals the extent to which we value emotions or rationality more when considering options. Does a person tend to use the Thinking (T) personality trait, which relies on the head, or the Feeling (F) trait, which relies on the heart?

But let's not oversimplify. Think of it instead as you might your hand preference: A left-handed person leans more heavily on their left hand, but they still use their right hand, albeit less. We can apply the same approach to a person with a dominant Thinking trait or a dominant Feeling trait – they aren't without some qualities of the non-dominant trait.

Thinking (T) Personality

"How Does This Help?"

When presented with a decision, people with the Thinking trait typically lean on objective information. Knowledge is their indispensable tool. Once these personality types gather the facts, they test their alternatives against logic and reason to see which decision, by those standards, proves the most effective or realistic. They generally manage their relationships by employing fairness and effectiveness as their primary method of dealing with others. Their passions are born of respect.

Whatever value people with the Thinking personality trait place on relationships, they can still dismiss emotional responses, either their own or those of others. This is often because of their discomfort with emotions, which don't always follow the rational path they value. Sometimes, emotions just puzzle them. But that doesn't

mean they have hearts of stone. They often feel in deep, profound ways – they would just rather not decide matters from that place. And, perhaps unfortunately, they may see those who do as weaker decision-makers.

Personality types with the Thinking trait are likely to evaluate things almost relentlessly. This isn't as bad as it sounds. They aren't satisfied if they believe something is not well thought out – they revel in the brilliance of an elegant plan. This makes them great to have around when critical thinking and impartiality of any kind is the focus, and this makes them immensely helpful for sorting out ideas and methods. Their primary filter is, *"How does this help?"*

Feeling (F) Personality

"Who Does This Help?"

People with the Feeling (F) trait follow their hearts and emotions – sometimes without even realizing it. They may show it to different degrees and in different ways, but however they do it, Feeling personality types tend to be caring, compassionate, and warm. These concerned people can be highly protective of those they care about – whether that is their immediate family or remote populations in need.

However, people with the Feeling personality trait often find they become excessive in their concern for others. They may easily burn out – or cause others to – when they become too involved. These emotionally aware individuals can become depressed if they feel they haven't been as selfless in life as they imagine they should be, or if those they have helped seem to fall down regardless.

Feeling personality types' concern for others typically affects all their endeavors. This can be practical and close, as with family, friends, and colleagues. Or it can be broader, as with world peace, ending hunger, and giving the disadvantaged a boost.

But this reliance on feelings doesn't mean there is no logic – theirs is just a different logic. They see that emotions can't simply be waved away, so feelings and the welfare of others shape their lives more than stark facts and cold objectivity. Weighing things this way makes these personalities valuable to have around when the big question is, “*Who does this help?*”

Judging vs. Prospecting

Crossing the Finish Line (By Whatever Means)

The Tactics scale, which includes the Judging and Prospecting personality traits, reflects how people plan and deal with the options they have. But this definition doesn't just concern what individuals write in their day planners. It's much broader. These traits answer questions like, “Do you prefer spontaneity or certainty?” “Do you feel more comfortable acting only with all your ducks lined neatly in a row? Or does a certain amount of flexibility or chaos excite you and prove motivating?” “Do you need more choices or fewer?”

Judging (J) Personality

Making Things as They Ought to Be

People with the Judging (J) personality trait feel most comfortable when the course ahead is well-marked. They would rather come up with five backup plans than deal with events as they come. Preferring to consider their options ahead of time,

personality types with this trait prefer clarity and closure, sticking with the plan rather than going with the flow. It's as if Judging types always keep a mental checklist. When they cross something off their list – or even start an item on their list – they consider it complete and not open to reconsideration.

The downside is, if they take this too far, those with the Judging trait sometimes come across as rigid. However, most are not unreasonably stubborn. It's important to remember their need for structure always is a preference and reality often calls on them to respond in unforeseen ways. Too many surprises in a row can leave these personality types frustrated and stressed. When this happens, they can still be relied on to develop a plan (and a contingency plan), but however well they handle the unexpected, they rarely enjoy it.

Judging individuals tend to have a strong work ethic, putting their duties and responsibilities above everything else. To them, rules, laws, and standards are the key to success. They can be too dependent on these measures, whether applied to themselves or others. But the intent is almost always one of fairness and results.

Prospecting (P) Personality

Figuring Things Out as They Go

Prospecting (P) individuals are much more flexible when it comes to dealing with unexpected challenges. This flexibility helps them seize unexpected opportunities as well. These personality types tend to react to their environments rather than try to control them, helping them to make their own luck in whatever the world delivers. People with this trait hold that life is full of possibilities.

All this opportunism can lead to impulsive decision-making, though. At the same time, they can be overwhelmed by the sheer number of options on their radar. People with the Prospecting personality trait can be slow to commit to something because of uncertainty or the potential of everything else. If they don't moderate this trait, indecision or a lack of conviction can be a problem. They can seem unfocused. What was important to them one week may be forgotten the next.

Despite those concerns, this personality trait can offer a great deal of creativity and productivity. Theirs is almost a stream of consciousness quality. In many ways, it's like these types are constantly brainstorming as their minds create a web of options. This can be a powerful tool for finding solutions. And if they aren't satisfied with something in their lives, it's easier for them to let go of it and choose something else. This can lead to serial passions that keep Prospecting individuals stimulated as they explore the buffet of choices always before them.

Assertive vs. Turbulent

Confidence, Achievement, and You

The Identity scale, made up of the Assertive and Turbulent personality traits, affects all other scales and indicates how confident we are in our abilities and decisions. Identity triggers the way we react to the things life constantly throws at us. How do we respond to success and failure? Criticism or feedback from other people? Unexpected events that suddenly change many things or everything? Even the unknown future?

Assertive (-A) Personality

Calm in the Storm

Assertive individuals are self-assured, even-tempered, and resistant to stress. They don't worry too much, but this is different from apathy. They aim for goals and want successful results, but they typically won't let nervousness color the path to their accomplishments. They're unlikely to spend a lot of time thinking about their past actions or choices. According to Assertive personality types, what's done is done.

However, problems may arise for them if their confidence turns into overconfidence. Assertive individuals may gloss over problems or details that can interfere with their goals and desired results. They may lean toward assuming all will be positive. Assertive people also sometimes presume they are free to do much more than others would allow or tolerate. If overconfident, these personality types may come to believe their confidence overshadows what others want.

But their confidence remains. It can help them move forward where others might hesitate. People with this personality trait report more satisfaction with their lives. They feel more assured of their abilities to handle the difficult and the unexpected. Through this lens, they often create the kinds of success that matter to them.

Turbulent (-T) Personality

Power of Stress, Activate!

Turbulent individuals are success-driven, perfectionistic, and eager to improve. They are always trying to counterbalance their self-doubts by achieving more. Just as they push themselves to become better, they're as likely to push their projects or efforts

in the same direction. Turbulent personality types tend to notice little problems and often do something about them before they become larger ones.

There are potential downsides to all this attention and achievement. Always feeling the need to do more, to have more, and to *be* more, Turbulent individuals can also get caught up in endless thoughts of criticisms, slights, or regrets. This can either bog them down or motivate them to do better. Their sensitivity to potential problems can be useful – unless that’s all they think about and the problems clutter their attention. Turbulent personality types may compulsively scan for what might go wrong instead of keeping their eyes on more positive targets – on what could go right.

Careful and attentive people are always important to society and keep it safe. At the same time, a fear of stagnation can bring about great change. Turbulent individuals beautifully cover both. When these personalities balance their worries and concerns with positive action, they’re likely to prove themselves to be of great value.

Type Groups

Now you know what each type consists of. But how do they fit together?

Our system has two layers: the first (inner) one defines our Roles, the second (outer) one – our Strategies.

Roles

Personality theory is a study of similarities among people with shared traits and how these traits might be expressed through behaviors and attitudes. Traits are the most fundamental part of our framework and include characteristics like Introversion or

Thinking. The next level contains personality types, in which four of the traits are combined and sorted to create 16 personality types. Roles, simply put, are the next level. At the Role level, the 16 types are divided into four groups.

Which personality types belong to each Role depends on two shared traits that they have in common. While all traits influence behaviors and attitudes, the two traits that determine a Role are shared by only four personality types and instill in them some unique, matching characteristics.

Those with the Intuitive trait (Analysts and Diplomats) are paired with the Thinking/Feeling traits because the Intuitive trait focuses on internal processes like thinking and feeling. While they may ultimately play out in the external world, they are primarily inward-looking.

In like manner, those with the Observant trait (Sentinels and Explorers) are paired with the Judging/Prospecting traits. Judging and Prospecting, while they have their internal aspects, are more likely to be played out in the external, concrete world of action and doing. Sentinels with their Judging trait are likely to bring order to their worlds, while Explorers with their Prospecting trait are likely to instill spontaneity into all the actions they perform.

The four Roles are primarily used when they are more likely to explain concepts in a clearer, less complicated way than involving all 16 personality types might. Using Roles this way is particularly warranted if the topic consists of a trait or traits that are a prominent part of the core traits of the various Roles – such as when Intuitive or Observant have a greater influence. But use is not limited to just that. They're like shorthand when Role commonalities suffice in talking about a subject.

In summary, Roles are just another level of the same theory, with each of the four containing four personality types. Those within a Role share a combination of two prominent traits and, therefore, share some similar characteristics.

The Role layer determines our goals, interests, and preferred activities. There are four roles:

Analysts – Intuitive (N) and Thinking (T)

Thinkers, Not Robots

The personality types in the Analyst Role – Architects (INTJ), Logicians (INTP), Commanders (ENTJ), and Debaters (ENTP) – are known for their love of rationality. Because they share the Thinking trait, these types often aim to make decisions with their heads rather than their hearts. But Analysts are far from being robots. Their Intuitive personality trait energizes their imaginations, helping them to come up with creative strategies and motivating them to explore things deeply – whether that’s an intellectual pursuit, a new interest, or even a crazy scheme or thought experiment.

These personalities are driven to understand and create. They have no problem switching between speculative musing and tactical problem-solving. Of course, these broad abilities need to be honed – and, when appropriate, they need to lead to action. Otherwise, Analysts’ active minds can give them a false sense of accomplishment.

These types often love ideas and speculation more than the realities of follow-through. As a result, they risk being outpaced by those who simply sit down and do the work. This can earn these types a reputation for being “armchair analysts” – and, at times, Analyst personalities may forget that they actually need to test their ideas in the real world.

Driven by Curiosity

Analysts are innately curious. This helps them to ensure that their ideas are workable, rather than just clever. These personality types have a strong drive to learn, and they want to find out things for themselves rather than accept received wisdom. These types may be found stockpiling books, questioning teachers, spurring debates, or driving conversations in forums across the Internet.

Analysts are also relentless self-improvers. Once they've recognized a flaw, they apply all of their rationality, imagination, and desire for results to make it right. Especially when it's balanced with self-understanding, this drive can enable Analyst personalities to push the boundaries of what's possible – no matter what anyone else may think.

Socially Selective

Analysts can have a reputation for being lone wolves. These personality types don't necessarily care about befriending everyone they meet, and they definitely don't surround themselves with random people just for the sake of having some company.

Given a choice between spending time with someone incompatible or spending time alone, many Analysts would choose the latter. And they may not be so subtle about it. 71% of people with Analyst personality types say they're good at shutting down unwanted conversations – far more than any other Role. This brusqueness can make Analysts seem rude, unapproachable, or antisocial, particularly to types that value social harmony.

That said, it's important to note that only 17% of Analysts actually describe their ideal social life as “mostly by myself.” Much greater numbers – 30% and 41% respectively

– say they’d prefer to have a few good friends or a partner and a few good friends. As a result, it’s inaccurate to view these personality types as antisocial.

Instead, it makes sense to view Analysts as socially selective. Like other types, they crave social connection. But these personalities won’t feel socially fulfilled by spending time with just anyone. They want to surround themselves with people who really get them – even if it takes effort to find those people. That might be why 46% of Analysts say they actively seek new friendships – which is more than any other Role except Diplomats.

Independent Minds

Analysts have little patience for following in others’ footsteps. 58% of these personality types describe themselves as “very independent” – far more than any other Role. Independence isn’t just a characteristic of these types – it’s an important part of their self-image.

This mindset shows up vividly in how Analysts approach academic and professional settings. These personality types are questioners, reluctant to take anything on faith. And “anything” includes what their teachers or bosses say.

From the outside, this might look like a lack of respect. In our Teachers Survey, Analysts were far less likely than other Roles to say they admired their past teachers. And this mindset persists in the professional sphere as well. 43% of Analysts in the workforce say they would be better than their boss at their boss’s job – again, far more than any other Role. Analyst personalities are also far less likely than other Roles to express admiration for their bosses.

But does this represent a lack of respect? Maybe – but this choosiness might well have other roots. Analysts tend to hold themselves to high standards, and they often hold the people around them (bosses and teachers included) to these high standards as well. In addition, Analyst personality types tend to care a great deal about learning and professional success. 85% of Analysts say they have a strong desire to be an important and successful person.

It makes sense, then, that these personality types hold their teachers and bosses to rigorous standards. After all, an Analyst with a poor teacher or boss may be less likely to become successful. Of course, Analysts – just like anyone – will almost certainly find themselves faced with a less-than-stellar teacher or boss. As a result, figuring out how to navigate these situations is an important part of their development.

Problems? What Problems?

You know who talks a lot about their problems? Not Analysts. In fact, 83% of Analysts say that most people complain too much about their problems.

But that doesn't mean that people with these personality types don't *think* about their problems, and they certainly don't shy away from challenges. 61% of Analysts say they're excited by the idea of being responsible for solving problems, and 85% say they enjoy tackling difficult challenges.

A core strength of Analysts is their faith in their problem-solving abilities. Analyst personalities tend to express the highest intellectual self-confidence of any Role, and this gives them the willingness to try their hand at things that may be hard. Taken too far, this can turn into cockiness – which is rarely an asset, whether in relationships or in other spheres. But as long as Analysts balance their intellectual self-assurance

with their innate curiosity, these personality types can find success and even enjoyment in the face of challenges both large and small.

Diplomats – Intuitive (N) and Feeling (F)

Longing for Connection

Diplomat personality types – Advocates (INFJ), Mediators (INFP), Protagonists (ENFJ), and Campaigners (ENFP) – care about helping and connecting with others. They prioritize being kind and generous, and in general, they'd rather cooperate than compete. Empathy seems to come naturally to these personalities. It can almost seem as if their hearts and minds resonate with other people's emotions.

These types aim to understand themselves and others. They often have deep insights into human nature, and they can use these insights to influence the people around them. Fortunately, Diplomat personality types tend to do this with care. They are sensitive to other people's feelings, and they want to nudge the people around them in positive directions.

Striving for Change

Diplomats have a deep belief in the ideals of humanism – altruism, compassion, and understanding. These personality types believe it is possible to create a kinder world, and they strive to do so every day.

The Intuitive trait fuels this optimism. Paradoxically, though, it also makes these types hyper-sensitive to wrongdoing. This sensitivity provides Diplomat personalities with the motivation they need to tackle injustice, which is important. If left unchecked, however, this personality trait can trigger self-righteousness or single-mindedness.

In general, Diplomats are motivated by principles rather than practicality. This helps them to stay true to their big dreams and ideas. That said, these types may have trouble enacting plans that are pragmatic rather than passion-driven. Diplomats can be tempted to ignore day-to-day tasks in favor of their big dreams and ideas. As these personalities mature, however, they often learn to balance these necessary tasks with the big-picture thinking they enjoy.

A Higher Purpose

Among friends and family, Diplomat personalities can range from quietly caring to brightly gregarious. Unfortunately, their open hearts can make them vulnerable when others are inconsiderate. That said, these types wouldn't have it any other way. Someone must trust first, and Diplomats will almost always volunteer.

These personality types see magical beauty where others see the humdrum of daily life. This trait attracts many Diplomats to creative expression. These types can be passionately inspired by music, writing, cuisine, theater – or many other creative pursuits.

Diplomats want to bring progress and beauty to the world around them. These types are led by a sense of higher purpose, and they care about serving the greater good. As a result, activism, spirituality, healing, and volunteering are common interests for these personality types.

The Need to Belong

For Diplomats, authenticity and connection aren't just buzzwords. These concepts – which might seem vague or wishy-washy to other types – form the bedrock of

Diplomats' lives. This explains why relationships matter so much to these personality types – and not just *any* type of relationship, but rather real, meaningful bonds.

When asked about their ideal social life, only 8% of Diplomats would like to spend most of their time alone. Instead, the majority of Diplomats express a desire for a partner and a few good friends. These personalities may also worry more about loneliness than other types, with nearly two thirds of Diplomats saying they worry about being lonely in their old age.

For many Diplomats, a central challenge of their lives is to balance their need for authenticity with their need to belong. More than any other personality Role, Diplomats say that the need to belong often motivates them to do things they otherwise wouldn't. This sort of behavior might not bother other types, but it poses a real dilemma for Diplomats. Being fake can feel literally painful to these types, who long to be loved and accepted for who they are, not for their ability to fit in.

For Diplomats, an important part of self-development is learning to be real – even if they fear that doing so won't make them popular. The irony is that many Diplomat personalities only feel a deep sense of belonging and connection once they learn to approach relationships as their whole, true selves.

What is Success, Anyway?

If your life goals are to earn pots of money, land an impressive job, buy a fancy car, and be better than everyone else – well, you're probably not a Diplomat.

But that isn't to say that Diplomats don't have their own type of ambition. 85% of Diplomats say it's important to them to make a lasting impact on other people, outside of their family and closest friends. In other words, these personality types

want to make a lasting difference in the world – which is no small feat. This might explain why Diplomats are second only to Analysts in saying that they sometimes set impossibly high standards for themselves.

Perhaps because they have such a lofty view of success, Diplomats are the Role least likely to consider themselves successful. It's important to note that the great majority of people with these personality types still say they'd be upset if they never became successful. As a result, many people with these types may feel as if they're constantly striving toward ideals and expectations that they'll never meet.

To address this sense of inadequacy, many Diplomats find they must let go of comparisons to other people. 79% of Diplomats say they consciously compare themselves to others either often or very often. By releasing these comparisons, Diplomats can free themselves to do things their own way, in their own time – rather than fretting over whether they're successful yet.

Time to Leap

You know that expression, “Leap and the net will appear”? Diplomat personality types can fall into the trap of thinking they've leapt – metaphorically speaking – when they're actually still perched at the ledge. Because these personalities have such active mental lives and imaginations, they can forget that thinking about starting a business isn't the same as actually starting a business, or that watching videos of dancers isn't the same as throwing themselves into a pirouette.

For many Diplomats, the secret to tackling their greatest challenge is simply to take action. Of course, that's easier said than done. The majority of Diplomats say they overthink simple tasks – so you can only imagine how much they might overthink major life decisions or their most precious dreams.

Fortunately, Diplomats tend to have a deep intuitive sense of what is right for them. Many of these personality types find that by tuning into this wisdom – and honoring it – they can find satisfaction and meaning in their everyday lives, no matter what challenges arise along the way.

Sentinels – Observant (S) and Judging (J)

Character and Competence

Sentinels – Logisticians (ISTJ), Defenders (ISFJ), Executives (ESTJ), and Consuls (ESFJ) – are cooperative, practical, and grounded. They feel comfortable with who they are, and they take pride in their good character and their competence. These personality types seek order, security, and stability, and they tend to work hard to maintain their way of things. This leads to a deserved reputation as the cornerstone of any group or organization, from family to church to the office and the factory floor.

Careful and consistent, Sentinel personalities tend to be self-motivated. This means that they rarely need external inspiration to be productive and focused. They work hard and aim never to let anyone down, and they expect other people to embrace this same ethic as well. Given a choice, these personality types prefer to collaborate within a clear set of rules. Following proven methods makes more sense to them than swanning around in search of innovation. Their motto is, “If it works, don’t break it.”

Steady Progress

That said, Sentinels are hardly unimaginative. They simply take inspiration from the past rather than the future. These personality types remain loyal to established best practices and traditions, whether that’s the best way to make a pizza crust or the

most efficient way to write an algorithm. This enables them to make steady, consistent progress – which is exactly what they enjoy. Sentinels would much rather guide a single project to completion than start (and abandon) a flurry of interesting ideas.

Sentinel personalities thrive in environments that have clear hierarchies and rules. Whether or not they're in a formal leadership role, they care about setting a good example, and they gain great satisfaction from guiding a well-functioning group. This can make them excellent teachers, managers, and community officials, as well as caring parents and hosts.

Guidance and Wisdom

In their personal lives, Sentinels want to offer stability and wisdom to others. They see it as their duty to give their families safe, happy lives that prepare them for the real world. An appreciation of strong relationships allows these personality types to share generously with those they respect and love. Sentinels feel bolstered by having reliable people in their lives, and they make sure they hold up their end of the bargain. Birthdays, dinner parties, and camping trips are delightful events under their enthusiastic direction.

These personality types are happiest without drama – though they can occasionally be stubborn. In particular, inconsistent people can test Sentinels' patience. It can be difficult for Sentinel personalities to accept people who lack their conscientiousness. Fortunately, they often serve as engaged and caring mentors to those who wish to grow in that direction.

Love and Care

Sentinels are the personality Role least likely to say they fall in love easily – but don't let that fool you. Sentinels may not spout love poems, but they do express affection and admiration – they just do it a little differently than other personality types. Sentinels often show their love in practical ways, such as checking the tires on their partner's car or making them a nutritious dinner. To other types, these actions might not look romantic, but Sentinels do these things with love and care.

In all of their relationships, Sentinels want to make contributions. This attitude informs how they treat not only their nearest and dearest but also their acquaintances, neighbors, and coworkers. These aren't the personality types who neglect their responsibilities or leave the office kitchen a mess – in fact, they're often the types who quietly clean up other people's messes, both literal and metaphorical.

Of course, Sentinels wouldn't *mind* being recognized for the ways they help others, but these personalities rarely demand attention. Instead, they work behind the scenes to make everyone's lives run as smoothly as possible, even if that means taking on unglamorous tasks like remembering to buy toilet paper or handling their family's income taxes. They may not be obvious with their feelings, but Sentinels do care and care deeply – you just have to know how to spot it.

Due Diligence

Sentinels have a core set of principles that they bring to their academic and professional pursuits. These principles include diligence, honesty, and respect. The result is that Sentinel personality types tend to work hard, striving to meet deadlines, and generally get things done. This can be seen even from a relatively young age –

Sentinels are far more likely than other Roles to say that they developed productive work habits in school.

These personality types have a clear vision of what it means to do things “right,” and they take great pride in living up to these standards. Sentinels are rarely willing to cut corners and do shoddy work – even if doing so would help them get ahead. They are less likely than any other Role to say that they could compromise some of their principles to advance their career.

Above all, Sentinels stand out for their ability to stick with their work until it’s done – even if the work is tedious or rote. These personality types are far less likely than others to say that they often abandon work in favor of doing something more interesting and fun, and they’re also less likely to say that they get distracted from what they’re working on. For Sentinels, productivity is a bit of a superpower – and they get great satisfaction from exercising their ability to get things done.

Planning Ahead

Sentinels know the value of a well-made plan. Compared to other Roles, Sentinel personalities are far more likely to say they’d rather prepare for problems rather than tackle them as they arise. And Sentinels aren’t afraid to think up every contingency that might arise – as long as they can do something to avert disaster, that is.

Of course, we can’t prepare for everything – although if anyone could, it would be a Sentinel. Like everyone else, these types must occasionally face unforeseen problems. Learning to roll with the punches, so to speak, is an important part of their personal development. Over time, Sentinels can learn to distinguish between when they should stick with their plans and when they’d do well to change course. And

when they do so, these personality types can press through even the most challenging of circumstances, bringing together determination and adaptability.

Explorers – Observant (S) and Prospecting (P)

On the Fly

Explorers – Virtuosos (ISTP), Adventurers (ISFP), Entrepreneurs (ESTP), and Entertainers (ESFP) – tend to be self-reliant and quick-thinking. These personality types don't mind handling uncertain situations on the fly – in fact, they live for those types of situations. Explorers' flexibility helps them to adapt to the moment, even if they don't feel particularly prepared.

These types tend not to be obsessed with precise detail – unless they're really in the zone, in which case they can muster a level of precision and focus that would make a seasoned engineer blush with envy. Usually, they prefer workability and usefulness to perfection. Explorer personalities enjoy learning different tools and techniques, from rotary saws to sheet music to emergency response strategies.

Living for Change

Explorers can change their minds with minimal regret or second-guessing. People in this Role dislike monotony, and they may stray from their obligations in order to try new things. If these personality types sometimes leave business unfinished, let clutter build up, or misplace important things – it's because they've moved on to something fresh.

These types enjoy being free of obligations, where they can indulge themselves or their interests on their own time. They love delving into something interesting, but their interest tends to wane as soon as something becomes "mandatory." An

Explorer personality might design and build their own dream house, but end up procrastinating on simple repairs after a few years.

Social Ingenuity

This free-form attitude can make Explorer personalities socially dynamic as well. Their spontaneity draws them to appealing strangers and interesting experiences. When things get in the way of a good time, they apply their ingenuity to get around it. Explorers want to see what happens next!

Explorers enjoy being on the leading edge of things – whether that means having the latest technology, trying out fashion trends, or checking out the newest restaurant in town. Many Explorer personalities enjoy sharing these findings with others, and they take pride in introducing their friends and loved ones to the latest and greatest things. The result is that time spent with Explorers is almost never boring or repetitive – and Explorers wouldn't have it any other way.

Explorers in Love

Explorer personality types have a reputation for constantly being on the move – and some people might wonder whether this restlessness applies to their romantic relationships as well. According to our research, however, relatively few Explorers (32%) say they're easily bored by romantic relationships that are stable and predictable. In fact, Analysts and Diplomats are significantly more likely to agree with this statement.

So, what *are* Explorers like in romantic relationships? First, Explorers are slightly less likely than other Roles to say that falling in love scares them. These personality types thrive in unpredictable situations, and what is falling in love if not unpredictable? The

early phases of a relationship are energizing for these types – full of new experiences and fresh discoveries.

It's true that Explorer personalities are somewhat more likely than other Roles to avoid commitment. Still, the majority of Explorers – 63% – say they usually seek commitment in their relationships. And overall, Explorers are slightly more likely than average to say that intimate relationships have increased their maturity more than anything else. So, while Explorers might have a reputation for being commitment-phobes, it's clear that these personality types see the deeper value of long-term relationships – and, more often than not, this is exactly what they're looking for.

Doing the Work

Explorers are highly spontaneous, connecting with their environment in a way that's almost childlike in its wonder and sheer fun. But when they need to work on something that's frustrating or unexciting – well, that can prove something of a challenge.

This may show up in how Explorer personality types approach their academic and professional lives. Explorers are slightly less likely than other Roles to say that they developed productive work habits in school. They're also less likely to say that it was easy for them to do well in school. Many school environments are relatively prescriptive, filled with required courses and standardized curricula. As a result, Explorer personalities often find themselves forced to sit through classes that just don't excite them – which, for these types, can be unmotivating. Unfortunately, this can persist in their professional lives as well – after all, most jobs require at least some degree of routine, unglamorous work.

This isn't to say that Explorers are slouches – far from it. When they're working on something they're passionate about, these personality types can move heaven and earth. And, over time, they often find ways to deal with the necessary evils – in other words, the unexciting tasks – that make work and life run more smoothly.

Perhaps it's most accurate to say that Explorers look for ways to balance work with leisure. They're the Role least likely to say they make themselves finish all of their tasks before they allow themselves to relax. While some personality types might brand this behavior as laziness, this isn't necessarily the case. Explorers' ability to balance work with fun can help them avoid burnout. Ultimately, this can help them to enjoy more fulfillment – and yes, a surprising degree of productivity – in their lives.

The Power of Risk

51% of Explorers say they take risks simply for the fun of it – far more than any other personality Role. This might sound reckless, and indeed it can be. But, done responsibly, risk-taking can be one of the best ways to learn new things, solve tricky problems, and grow as people. As Explorers know, we can only make so much progress in life if we stay in our comfort zones.

As long as they temper this trait with a degree of self-control, comfort with risk can be one of Explorers' greatest strengths. It can motivate them to open up in their relationships and empower them to seek out new academic and professional opportunities.

These personality types don't resign themselves to the "lives of quiet desperation" that Henry David Thoreau famously wrote of in *Walden*. Instead, Explorers can use their own brand of bravery to free themselves from conventionality and create lives that work for them.

Strategies

The word “strategy” suggests a course of action. In our use, Strategy describes how personality types act in response to the world around them and how they might choose to accomplish things.

Strategies express themselves primarily in two ways: social style and resistance to stress. Social style entails how other people factor into an individual’s Strategy and to what degree. One example might involve whether a person prefers working in a team or alone.

Resistance to stress includes the degree of impact that a stressful situation might have on an individual and their efforts, as well as how resilient they might be when trying to restore themselves after a challenging event. An example of this might involve whether a person quits after a jarring setback or presses forward.

The Energy aspect (Introverted/Extraverted) brings to each combination a social piece. When individuals pursue their goals or satisfy their needs and wants, to what degree will they involve other people? Do they want to achieve things independently, or are they collaborators and team players? Extraverted personality types often wish to have more people around, and Introverts tend to prefer doing things more independently.

But the Energy aspect also speaks to risk and taking leaps of faith. Extraverts tend to be more adventurous, and they are brimming with enthusiasm for the activities in their lives – especially if they involve other people. Introverts feel a pull toward lone activities and are usually calmer and quieter, preferring quiet and solitude or smaller, more intimate groups when possible. Introverted personality types are not as interested in adventures as their Extraverted counterparts.

The Identity aspect (Assertive/Turbulent) describes levels of confidence and resistance to stress. It helps us understand what might motivate someone. Are they being pulled along by their self-confidence, or are they pushed to excel because they are perfectionists focused on preventing mistakes and failures?

Assertive personalities are much less likely to worry about things – even results. Their motivation may involve boldly realizing the potential that they assume they have. They are less concerned with the opinions of others and may stand up to their critics – not to impress them but to “correct” them. Turbulent personalities are self-conscious, cautious, and perfectionistic. They may go one of two ways. They may push themselves to high levels of success to avoid disappointment in themselves, or they may opt out of doing something because of the potential for stress and the chance of failure.

In summary, Strategies combine the Energy aspect and the Identity aspect. Together, they describe how individuals respond to life and reflect their preferred ways of doing things. When merged, the Energy and Identity personality traits influence many areas of life, including social preferences, confidence, stress, and risk-taking, to name a few.

The Strategy layer shows our preferred ways of doing things and achieving goals. There are four strategies:

Confident Individualism – Introverted (I) and Assertive (-A)

Substance Over Superficiality

Confident Individualists tend to trust in themselves. They enjoy their own company and don't mind spending time alone to pursue their interests. Over time, this can give these personalities an impressive range of skills and interesting ideas.

But these types take pride in their skills for their own sake, not to impress others. They tend not to see the point in social displays and bragging. While they're proud of who they are, these personality types don't always feel the need to prove themselves to anyone else. They prefer substance to superficiality and personal honesty to playing along.

Confident Individualists are motivated by their inner world rather than outside expectations. They're opinionated, but they aren't excessively worried about what others think. These personality types express their thoughts unapologetically. They're rarely pressured into agreeing with others – even if agreeing would be more convenient.

Self-Assurance and Self-Reliance

If left unchecked, this relaxed self-assurance can lead to complacency. These personality types' live-and-let-live attitude goes both ways: They don't push others to change, and in return, they don't particularly want anyone to push them to change. At times, Confident Individualists may miss information and opportunities that challenge their views because they simply don't place much importance on others' approval.

In their personal relationships, these types tend to be strong and honest. Their loyalty and affection are genuine rather than forced. These personalities only express respect and care if they really feel them. Fortunately, if they do feel them, they see no reason to hide how they feel.

No matter how strong their relationships, these types also value self-reliance. They can handle difficult situations well because they tend to be emotionally secure and resistant to stress. Although these personalities rarely seek the spotlight, their quiet examples of determination and honesty can be nothing short of inspiring.

Confident Individualists in Love

Confident Individualists tend to be a bit choosy about their closest confidants. This is especially true when it comes to finding a romantic partner. Perhaps because Confident Individualists know how to find contentment and fulfillment even when they're single, they're in no rush to settle for a partner who's less than a good match.

These personality types may also be less likely to stay with a partner who lets them down. Confident Individualists are less likely than any other personality Strategy to say they often give second chances to those who fail to fulfill commitments to them. Again, perhaps because of their strong intrinsic sense of worth, these types don't necessarily feel compelled to stay in a relationship that isn't working out.

Confident Individualists are the Strategy least likely to say they believe in soulmates. They're also the least likely to say they know a lot of couples whose marriages they envy, or would aspire to have. And it might not come as a surprise, then, that they're the most likely to say they don't want to get married.

It would be inaccurate, however, to assume that Confident Individualists are lone wolves with no interest in committed intimate relationships. The majority of these personality types – 79% – *do* express an interest in getting married. A similar percentage say they're unafraid of being committed to a single partner for the rest of their lives. It's true that Confident Individualists are independent, and they probably won't get into a relationship just for the sake of being in a relationship. That said, these types often do have an interest in romantic connection – they just want to find the right person before they become attached.

Unlikely Leaders

Confident Individualists bring their love of independence into their academic and professional pursuits. They're more likely than any other Strategy to say that learning as part of a group is distracting rather than helpful. As you can imagine, group projects can be frustrating for these personality types – whether at school or in the workplace.

This isn't to say that Confident Individualists *can't* work well with others – far from it. But if given a choice, these types would prefer to operate independently and figure things out on their own. At school, these personalities may be drawn to independent study opportunities. At work, they may try to develop a specific area of expertise that allows them to make their own decisions and do most of their tasks on their own.

From this description, Confident Individualists might not sound like natural leaders, but that isn't necessarily the case. Just over half of these personality types say they're inclined to seek out leadership and management roles. This is well less than their Extraverted peers, but it's still a majority. In addition, nearly 70% of these types say

they have excellent leadership skills. A quick look at famous Confident Individualists includes real-life leaders (Bill Gates) as well as fictional ones (Gandalf).

Confident Individualists tend to hone their ideas and skills on their own, and they often prefer to work alone. That said, these personalities may be willing to take up the reins of leadership if that's what is necessary to turn those ideas and skills into real-world progress.

The Right Mindset

Confident Individualists are more likely than any other personality Strategy to say that control over their mindset is the most important factor in determining their happiness. On average, they rank their mindset as a more significant factor in their happiness than their financial situation, their friends and family, their job, or their health.

This statistic reveals a great deal about Confident Individualists. These personality types believe in their personal effectiveness and their individual worth, and they know how important it is to maintain this mindset. As long as they balance this self-conviction with a willingness to learn from others, Confident Individualists' positive mindset can become a self-fulfilling prophecy, helping these personalities to not only achieve great things but also find lasting happiness.

People Mastery – Extraverted (E) and Assertive (-A)

Bold and Confident

Personality types with the People Mastery Strategy are known for their ability to handle stress. This helps them to act boldly and maintain confidence, even in the face of challenges or criticism.

Thanks to this confidence, people with this Strategy feel energized and at ease in social situations. They seek social contact as well as stimulating and challenging experiences. These personalities like traveling to see things, people, and places, and trying something new – even things they don't end up liking can be exciting for them.

Nothing to Prove?

If they don't keep themselves in check, though, People Masters can become too confident. These personality types tend to be insulated against self-doubt and the need to prove themselves. As a result, they don't always test, or even consider, their own limits or ambitions.

Taken to the extreme, this can create a pattern of comfort-seeking. They may even roll their eyes at people who chase more intimidating goals. At the other end of the spectrum, these personality types can ignore sensible caution, landing themselves in extraordinary and dangerous situations.

At times, People Masters may not be considerate to those who aren't able to maintain such a comfortable boldness. But this doesn't have to be the case, by any means. By taking others into account, these personalities can actually help to draw other people out of their shells in a way that's energizing and empowering.

Finding Balance

Fortunately, most People Masters fall somewhere in the middle. Ideally, they embrace healthy ambition while finding social fulfillment and connection. Social interaction plays a big part in People Masters' happiness. Although these personality types are self-confident, they still appreciate praise and recognition. They don't need

people's approval, but they still crave friends and loved ones with whom to share their lives.

These types may be opinionated, but they don't always worry about having others agree with them. This can help these personalities to be moderate even in disagreements because their ego and confidence aren't at stake the way they often are for Turbulent Strategies. People Masters are not fond of grudges, and at heart, they want to bring people together to make things happen.

These types often stand out for their charisma and self-assurance. As long as they don't use their talents to steamroll or put down others, these personality traits can be quite appealing. These types have little fear of rejection, and they love including others. This can make these personalities wonderful friends, loved ones, and colleagues, who always aim to energize those around them.

People Masters in Love

According to our research, People Masters seem to fall in love a bit more frequently than the other Strategies. They're also less likely to say that falling in love scares them. It's easy to imagine why this is the case – People Masters' Extraversion leads them into situations where they're likely to meet new people, and their Assertive personality trait helps them to feel confident about the prospect of new relationships.

Some might wonder whether this would make People Masters less reliable than other personality types when it comes to being a good partner. Is it possible that these types' self-assurance would make them complacent or uncommitted once they're actually *in* a relationship? Not necessarily: About half of People Masters say it's necessary to go out of their way to please someone they love, and this response

puts them on par with other types. In addition, People Masters are the Strategy least likely to say that long-term commitments make them anxious.

In other words, although People Masters' confidence and social ease might make them sound like players, these types can be as committed and eager to please their partners as anyone else. And being in a relationship with a People Master can be a wonderful thing – even for people who are completely different. After all, People Masters' social energy and their can-do take on life can be infectious in the best possible way.

Speaking Up

People Masters don't tend to filter their opinions. These personality types say what they think, and they think what they say. As with nearly any trait, this can be a strength or a weakness.

People Masters are often seen as straight-shooters who can be trusted to speak honestly. In academic and professional settings, many teachers, classmates, colleagues, and managers appreciate this quality. After all, if used appropriately, candor is a powerful way to connect with other people. The “what you see is what you get” nature of a People Master personality can be refreshing, whether in the classroom or the workplace.

But there's a difference between being candid and being rude – and at times, People Masters may toe that line. In academic settings, this can put them at odds with their teachers and classmates. And in professional settings, these personality types may gain a reputation for being inconsiderate, arrogant, or even ruthless.

Learning to speak honestly *without* speaking over other people is a step on many People Masters' path to personal development. Fortunately, once they master this balance, People Masters can unleash the many gifts they bring to their schooling and their work. In particular, People Masters can excel at dealing with awkward or tense interpersonal situations – whether that's getting a group project back on track or delivering bad news to a customer in a straightforward but considerate way.

Going for It

79% of People Masters say they see problems as opportunities. These personality types trust themselves to tackle hard problems – *and* to gain insight and experience from the process. Ideally, this conviction becomes a self-fulfilling prophecy, with People Masters taking on ever harder challenges and learning important lessons along the way.

What sets People Masters apart isn't just their confidence, however. It's also their willingness to team up with others. These personalities know that we tend to be more effective when we collaborate and ask for help. People Masters can be especially good at creating opportunities for the people around them to use their strengths. And that may just be one of the secrets to People Masters' success.

Constant Improvement – Introverted (I) and Turbulent (-T)

Sensitive Souls

Constant Improvers tend to be sensitive and introspective. They are often deep individuals who enjoy having their own space and freedom. In general, these personality types feel more comfortable on their own than mixed up in the judgment of the real world.

This may be because they share the two personality traits most representative of sensitivity to their environment – Introversion and Turbulence. As a result, they may find it stressful to deal with tense environments or new situations. In these moments, Constant Improvers can be deeply uncomfortable – although they may not want to let on how they really feel. In reaction, these personalities might retreat inward, react defensively, or try to escape the situation altogether. Alternatively, they might give up their own wants or needs in an effort to keep the peace.

Driven by Doubt

Constant Improvers tend to experience self-doubt. They have a strong drive, but it comes paired with a strong fear of failure. These personality types invest a great deal of their identity in their successes. As a result, even a minor misstep or embarrassment can be crushing.

On the upside, this vigilance offers these personality types a knack for sensing trouble. This can be quite useful in situations that need to balance risk and reward – whether a financial investment or a romantic opportunity. When faced with a potential risk, these types look for ways to prevent problems. Although it slows them down in the short term, this approach can prevent longer-term issues.

Constant Improvers direct much of their attention toward their personal interests. They strive to master hobbies, careers, or new means of self-expression. This level of dedication can create impressive, beautiful results.

People with Constant Improvement personality types can be perfectionistic, dedicating tremendous time and energy to their pursuits. Unfortunately, if they put too much pressure on themselves, this approach can backfire. For example, Constant

Improvers may feel forced to abandon an endeavor because a single detail doesn't line up right.

Reality and Romance

At times, Constant Improvers may experience a nagging feeling that something is missing from their lives. It's worth noting that often this really is just a feeling, not a reflection of reality. These personality types have it in their nature always to be seeking something more – even if their lives actually are going just fine.

But as Constant Improvers assess their lives, wondering what might be missing, they may find themselves focusing on their romantic relationships – or lack thereof. These types are significantly less likely than their Assertive counterparts (also known as Confident Individualists) to say that they enjoy being single. And these personalities are more likely than Confident Individualists to say they often construct an ideal partner in their heads when they're single.

Although Constant Improvers may find themselves longing for romance, they don't necessarily find it easy to start up a relationship. They're less likely than other personality Strategies to say that they usually take the initiative in asking someone out. This makes sense, given that Constant Improvers can feel hesitant about putting themselves out there – and asking someone out is an incredibly vulnerable position to be in.

This might sound like bad news, but it doesn't have to be. As they grow and mature, Constant Improvers often learn how to transform their feeling that something is missing into positive energy – and by doing so, they not only discover gratitude for the good things in their lives, but also become proactive about making helpful

changes. This mindset shift can empower these personality types to find fulfillment in their relationships – as well as in every other aspect of their lives.

The “Right” Career?

Constant Improvers’ longing for “something more” extends to their professional lives. Just over a quarter of these types say that their career is a great fit for them – a rate of agreement that is less than the other Strategies.

This doesn’t necessarily mean that Constant Improvers are in the wrong careers for them – although they might wonder if they are. More than half of these personality types say they often think about switching careers, and they’re more likely than the other Strategies to say that they feel stuck in their current job.

This restlessness doesn’t have to be a bad thing. In fact, restlessness can be an incredible motivator to do great things. The trouble comes when Constant Improvers feel trapped: wanting to make a change, but suspecting they’re unable or helpless to do so. This feeling can have a number of roots, such as self-doubt or a general worry that other people don’t “get” them.

As in other areas of their lives, Constant Improvers who pursue personal growth often discover that their feeling of helplessness is exactly that – a *feeling*. This can be a powerful discovery. In its wake, these personality types are better able to harness their personal and professional strengths and deal with their feeling of “stuckness.” This may take the form of finding a new career, or it might involve advocating for themselves in their current workplaces so that they get more of their needs met. Either way, Constant Improvers often find that they have more agency in their professional lives than they’d realized.

The Strength of Sensitivity

In general, Constant Improvers care a great deal about what others think of them. This can trigger insecurity, to be sure, but when kept in balance, it can create some truly wonderful traits. These personalities are often curious about and sensitive to others' feelings. This can make them excellent listeners, friends, confidants, and partners.

Some types might think that sensitivity is synonymous with weakness, but Constant Improvers know that isn't the case. These personality types often exemplify how sensitivity and vulnerability can be hidden strengths. Their attunement to their own struggles and insecurities can help them to bond deeply with others. It can also motivate them to act with kindness and compassion.

Although they may not always realize it, Constant Improvers offer the world a wealth of gifts. Once they learn to trust themselves as much as they trust others' opinions, these personalities can shine.

Social Engagement – Extraverted (E) and Turbulent (-T)

Boldly Sensitive

Those with the Social Engagement Strategy are an interesting group. In some ways, Extraverted and Turbulent personality traits conflict with each other. Extraversion leads to risk-tolerance and boldness, and Turbulence leads to self-doubt and sensitivity.

This can mean that Social Engagers tend to do what comes naturally first and think about it later. In this way, they are almost an exaggeration of their underlying personality traits. This may sound like a bad thing, but it doesn't have to be.

Social Engagers venture into the world with enthusiasm. They enjoy being the center of attention and enjoy social status. At times, this may mean that they hide their true selves to impress other people, pretending to be someone else in order to be liked. Fortunately, Social Engagers' genuine interest in others often shines through, helping these personality types to create authentic connections with the people around them.

Social Engagers in Love

Romantic relationships aren't always the easiest – hence Shakespeare's observation that "the course of true love never did run smooth." You might think that Social Engagers' self-doubt would cause them to play it safe when it comes to the rough waters of love, but that isn't the case. These personality types tend to dive headlong into relationships – they're more likely than any other Strategy to say they fall in love easily. And they're also less likely to say they enjoy being single.

Social Engagers are far from passive about their romantic lives. These personalities care deeply about pleasing their partners – in fact, they're the Strategy most likely to believe they need to go out of their way to please the people they love. Social Engagers are deeply devoted, willing to pour all of their affection and care into their partner.

But not everyone is willing – or able – to do this in return. Social Engagers may feel it acutely if their partner doesn't seem equally affectionate or devoted. This can be especially challenging because these personality types care so deeply about receiving praise and admiration. As a result, they might feel hurt by a partner who is reserved in expressing their affection.

As they go through life, many Social Engagers discover that not everyone is as expressive as they are – and that's okay. These types may need to use their social

acumen to connect with the ways their partners *do* share love. For example, they may realize that their partner expresses affection through physical touch, spending time together, or even helping out around the house. Once they attune themselves to the ways other personalities demonstrate their love, Social Engagers can find incredible fulfillment and joy in their romantic relationships.

Working It

Social Engagers may find themselves drawn to lines of work that involve plenty of human interaction. The service industry can be a natural fit for these personality types, as can nearly any job that involves helping customers solve problems. Social Engagers are energized by the opportunity to talk with others, and they're especially invigorated when they can tell that they've actually made someone's day a little better.

This isn't to say that Social Engagers are anything less than ambitious. In their own way, these personalities do care about being successful. Everyone has a unique definition of "success," of course, but many Social Engagers feel especially successful when they receive recognition, such as awards, promotions, or positive feedback on their work. These types tend to be motivated by a desire to impress and please others – not only because they enjoy praise, but also because they genuinely value the good opinion of their bosses, coworkers, and customers. And of course a salary increase is always nice, too.

Social Engagers' ambition and desire to please can make them wonderful employees and colleagues. At times, however, these personality types often discover a need to pause and make sure they're being true to themselves as well. Their personal development path may lead them to consider their own values and needs – and make sure that their professional lives line up with these values and needs.

That said, these types know that their career is just one aspect of their lives. 74% of Social Engagers say they're always looking for new hobbies to get into – more than any other personality Strategy. Whether those hobbies include volleyball, viticulture, or volunteering, these types care about being well-rounded. Paradoxically, this well-roundedness can help them to find more enjoyment in their careers as well as in other aspects of their lives.

The Highs and the Lows

Social Engagers can experience highs and lows – sometimes within a matter of minutes. Their Extraversion can push their Turbulent need for success into overdrive. Meanwhile, their Turbulent personality trait can trigger almost instant self-doubt. Although these types are capable of taking quick action in a way that seems decisive, they may find themselves plagued by uncertainty afterward.

As they grow, many Social Engagers learn how to use this unusual combination of traits to their advantage. Their Extraversion can help them move past the self-doubt that comes with the Turbulent trait, enabling them to expand their comfort zones even when it isn't easy. Meanwhile, their Turbulent trait can help them to be more considerate in their boldness. The result is that these personality types can hold many contradictory traits in harmony, being both fun and responsible, active and reflective.

This push and pull can be stressful, but it's part of this Strategy's charm. These personality types chase their goals relentlessly, but they also indulge their desires and seek out fun. Thanks to this balance, they can lead happy and fruitful lives – sharing adventures and accomplishments with others whenever possible. Whatever direction these personalities pull, they are sure to pull the crowd with them.

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